The Complete Catechism Kit

150 Extra Activities

Crafts, coloring pages, games, prayers, and short skits to celebrate every season and feast of the Church year with kids

Advent · Christmas · Lent · Easter · Pentecost · All Saints · Feasts of Mary

The Whole Liturgical Year · Ages 4-12

A Note for Grown-Ups

This book gathers 150 activities to accompany children ages 4 to 12 through the whole liturgical year, in a religious education class, at school, or at home.

The activities follow the order of the liturgical year, which begins on the First Sunday of Advent. The feasts of Mary are gathered in Part 4, and the group activities in Part 5.

At the top of each page, three labels tell you the liturgical season, the type of activity, and the suggested ages. A page can also work for a younger child with a little help.

Print the pages on Letter paper (8.5 × 11 in); most of them work in black and white too. For the crafts, have safety scissors, glue, and crayons or colored pencils ready. The youngest children will need an adult's help with cutting.

Seasons and Feasts	Activities	Pages
Part 1 · Advent and Christmas Time		
Advent	16	pp. 3-18
Christmas	14	pp. 19-32
Epiphany	6	pp. 33-38
Presentation of the Lord (February 2)	5	pp. 39-43
Part 2 · Lent and Easter Time		
Lent	16	pp. 44-59
Palm Sunday	6	pp. 60-65
Holy Week	10	pp. 66-75
Easter	14	pp. 76-89
Ascension	5	pp. 90-94
Pentecost	9	pp. 95-103
Part 3 · Ordinary Time and Its Feasts		
Corpus Christi	5	pp. 104-108
Assumption (August 15)	5	pp. 109-113
Back to Religious Ed	8	pp. 114-121
All Saints' Day	8	pp. 122-129
Part 4 · Mary Throughout the Year		
Marian Feasts	9	pp. 130-138
Part 5 · In a Group: Team Games and Skits		
Group Activities	14	pp. 139-152

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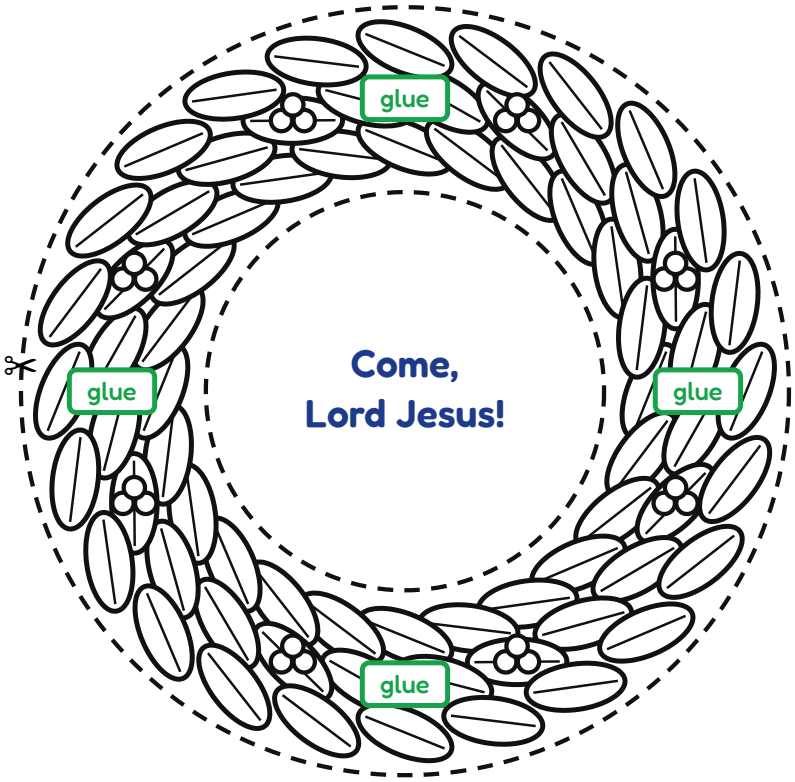
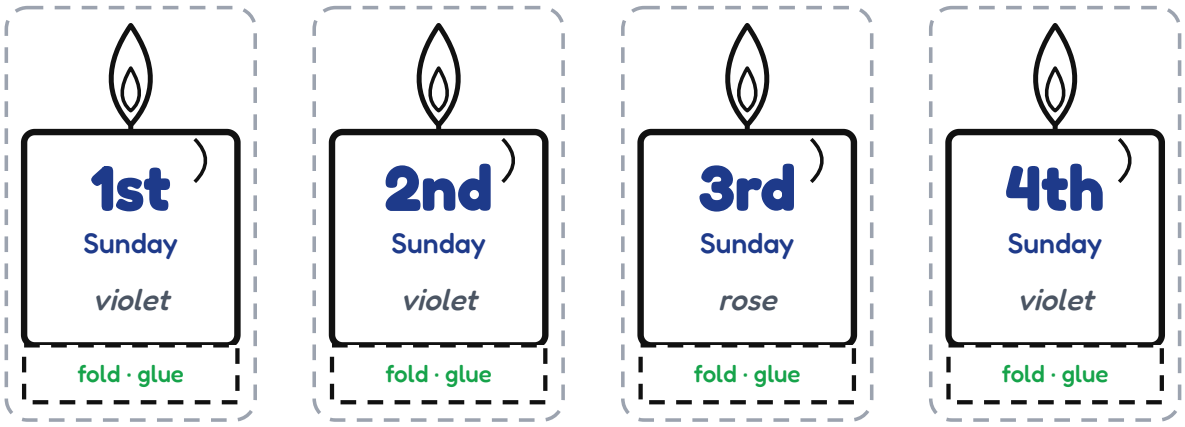
Advent · Cut-Out · Ages 4-12

The Advent Wreath to Cut Out

Color the wreath green and the candles: three violet and one rose. Each Sunday of Advent, color the flame of that week's candle!

Name: _____





1 Cut out the wreath along the dotted lines, then cut out the circle in the middle.

2 Cut out the 4 candles and fold their tabs back.

3 Glue each tab onto a "glue" box: your wreath is ready!

Advent | Craft | Ages 7-12

The Advent Calendar: 24 Doors to Open

Cut out the 24 boxes. Each day of December, open the box for that day, read the good deed, and do it. Then glue it in your notebook: your path to Christmas grows!

Name: _____

1 I say hello with a smile	**2** I clean my room without being asked	**3** I pray for my family	**4** I make a drawing for my grandparents
5 I set the table	**6** I say thank you three times today	**7** I lend a toy	**8** I say a Hail Mary
9 I help a classmate	**10** I don't argue today	**11** I give away clothes or a toy	**12** I think of someone who is alone
13 I read a page of the Bible with a grown-up	**14** I forgive someone	**15** I listen without interrupting	**16** I give someone a compliment
17 I set up the Nativity scene with my family	**18** I pray for people who are sick	**19** I help with the grocery shopping	**20** I call a relative who lives far away
21 I offer to help before I'm asked	**22** I sing a Christmas carol	**23** I prepare my heart: I say sorry	**24** I pray at the Nativity scene

Advent | Calendar | Ages 4-8

The Advent Coloring Calendar, One Box a Day

Every morning in December, color the picture in the box for that day. On December 24, your whole calendar will be full of color: Jesus is about to be born!

Name: _____

1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24

On December 25, draw and color a big Christmas star next to your Advent calendar!

Advent Coloring Ages 4-6

The Four Advent Candles

Color the wreath green. Color three candles violet and one candle rose: the rose candle is lit on the Third Sunday, the Sunday of joy!

Name: _____

Advent Prayer Ages 7-12

A Prayer for Lighting Each Candle of the Wreath

Each Sunday of Advent, at home or in a religious ed class, light one more candle and say the prayer for that week.

Name: _____

First Sunday · One Candle Is Lit

Lord Jesus, a little flame is shining.
Teach me to stay awake and wait for you.
Come into my heart. Amen.

Second Sunday · Two Candles Shine

Lord Jesus, John the Baptist tells us to prepare your way.
Help me open the door of my heart. Amen.

Third Sunday · The Rose Candle of Joy

Lord Jesus, you are very near!
I want to share my joy with those who are sad. Amen.

Fourth Sunday · Four Candles: Christmas Is Coming

Lord Jesus, Mary said yes to God.
With her, I say to you: come, Lord Jesus! Amen.

Advent Game Ages 7-9

The Advent Path to Bethlehem (Board Game)

Play with one die and one game piece for each player. Follow the path square by square. The first one to reach Bethlehem tells the others the story of Jesus' birth!

Name: _____

1 Start: First Sunday of Advent	**2**	**3** You light the first candle: move ahead 2	**4**	**5** You forget to pray: go back 1	**6**
12 You argue: lose a turn	**11**	**10** You help at home: move ahead 3	**9**	**8**	**7** Isaiah announces the Savior: roll again
13	**14** John the Baptist prepares the way: move ahead 2	**15**	**16**	**17** The rose candle: roll again!	**18**
24 You clean up without grumbling: roll again	**23**	**22**	**21** The angel Gabriel visits Mary: move ahead 2	**20**	**19** You pout: go back 2
25	**26** No room at the inn: go back 3	**27**	**28** The shepherds arrive: move ahead 1	**29**	**30** Bethlehem: Jesus is born!

Blue squares: good news. Yellow squares: watch out! To win, you must land exactly on square 30: if your roll is too high, move back the extra squares.

Advent | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Advent Words

Find the 12 Advent words in the grid. Check off each word you find in the list.

Name: _____

L	G	C	W	G	P	K	A	N	O	O	A
T	G	N	A	I	R	S	T	A	R	L	E
C	A	N	D	L	E	I	S	A	I	A	H
T	F	W	V	N	P	P	E	D	R	C	G
R	J	C	E	T	A	P	R	W	W	E	W
K	O	W	N	A	R	S	Y	A	I	U	R
T	Y	N	T	B	E	N	H	I	B	V	E
W	A	T	C	H	O	H	H	T	A	U	A
V	T	P	R	O	P	H	E	T	W	U	T
F	M	A	R	Y	U	O	V	U	S	N	H
H	D	O	Y	S	I	L	B	N	K	R	C
M	V	W	E	G	E	J	O	S	E	P	H

- ☐ Advent
- ☐ wait
- ☐ prepare
- ☐ candle
- ☐ wreath
- ☐ prophet
- ☐ Isaiah
- ☐ Mary
- ☐ Joseph
- ☐ star
- ☐ watch
- ☐ joy

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Advent · Riddles · Ages 4-8

Who Am I? The People of Advent

Read each riddle and write the name of the person. The answers are at the bottom of the page, upside down.

Name: _____

1. I am a prophet. Long before Jesus was born, I wrote: "...the young woman, pregnant and about to bear a son, shall name him Emmanuel." Who am I?

   _____

2. I am an angel. God sent me to Nazareth to speak to a young girl. Who am I?

   _____

3. I said yes to God: I will be the mother of Jesus. Who am I?

   _____

4. I am a carpenter. An angel spoke to me in a dream, and I took Mary into my home. Who am I?

   _____

5. I am Mary's cousin. When she came to visit me, my baby leaped for joy. Who am I?

   _____

6. I live in the desert, I eat locusts and wild honey, and I tell everyone to prepare the way of the Lord. Who am I?

   _____

Answer Key: 1 Isaiah · 2 the angel Gabriel · 3 Mary · 4 Joseph · 5 Elizabeth · 6 John the Baptist

Advent | Coloring | Ages 4-8

The Angel Gabriel Brings the Good News to Mary

The angel Gabriel comes to tell Mary that she will be the mother of the Son of God. Color the scene.

Name: _____

"Hail, favored one! The Lord is with you."
Luke 1:28

Advent · Matching · Ages 4-6

Match Each Candle to Its Color

Draw a line to match each part of the Advent wreath to its color.

Name: _____

The candles for the First, Second, and Fourth Sundays	green
The candle for the Third Sunday, the Sunday of joy	yellow
The evergreen branches	violet
The little flame	rose

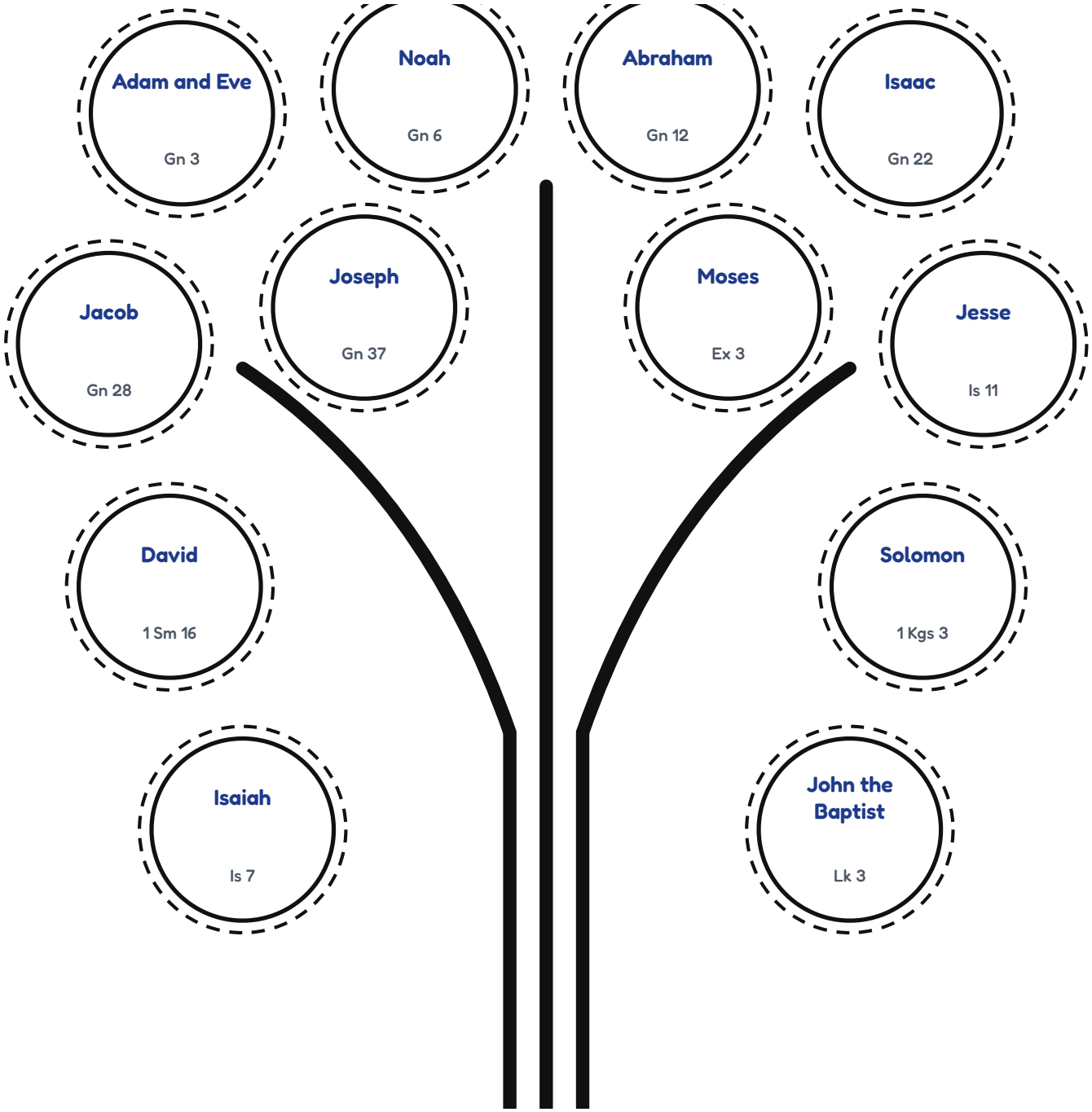
Answer Key: candles for Sundays 1, 2, and 4: violet · candle for the Third Sunday: rose · branches: green · flame: yellow

Advent | Craft | Ages 7-12

The Jesse Tree and Its Ornaments to Cut Out

The Jesse Tree tells the story of the family and the people who prepared for the coming of Jesus. Each day, draw the symbol of one person in an ornament (a rainbow for Noah, stars for Abraham, a harp for David...), then color it and cut it out to hang on your tree or on the wall.

Name: _____



Advent | Coloring | Ages 7-9

St. John the Baptist Prepares the Way of the Lord

John the Baptist, Jesus' cousin, calls everyone to change their hearts to welcome the Savior. Color him by the Jordan River.

Name: _____

Advent Craft Ages 4-8

The Advent Good Deeds Paper Chain

Cut out the strips. Each time you do a good deed, glue its strip into a ring and link it to the one before: your paper chain grows longer until Christmas!

Name: _____

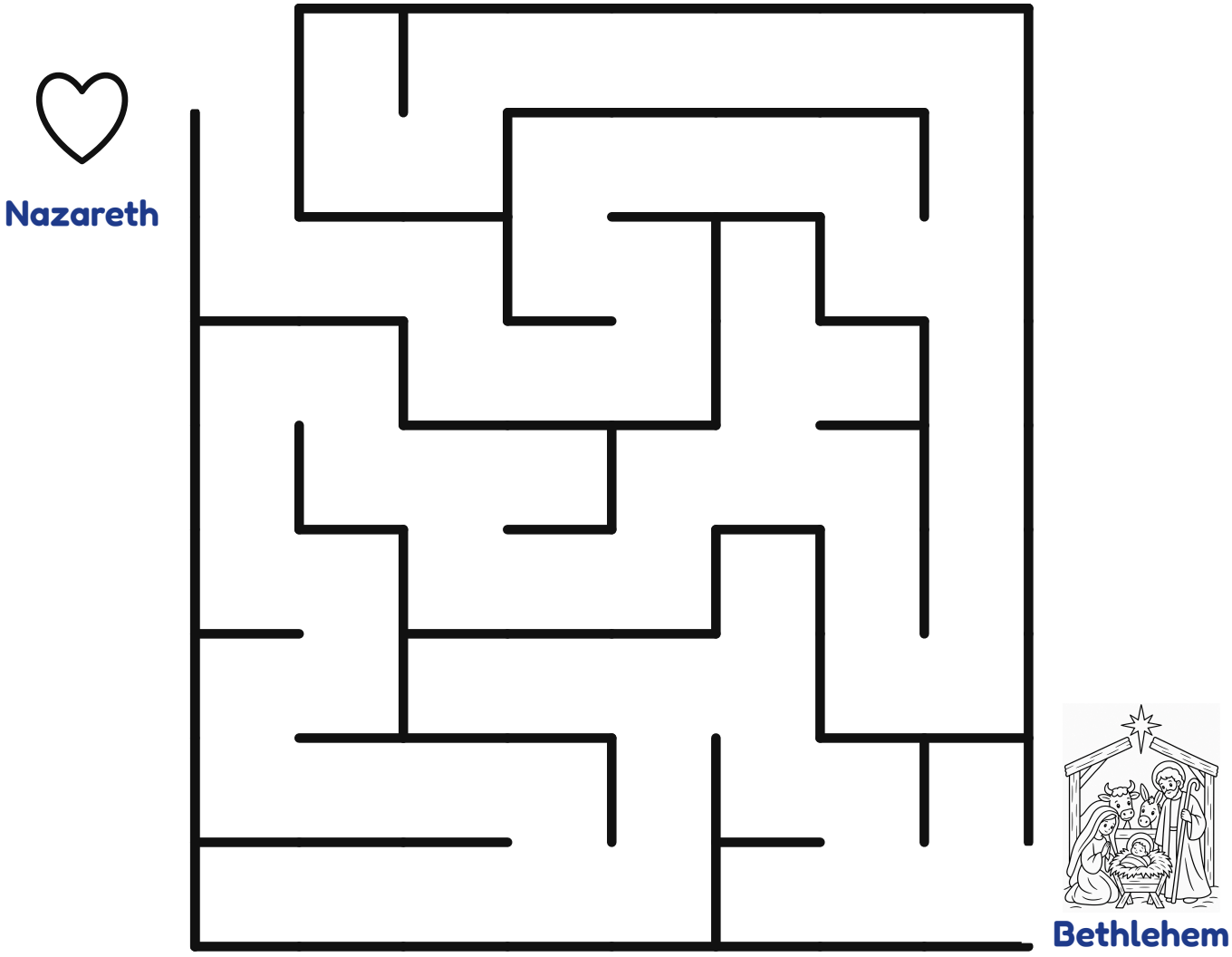
glue ♡ I say hello to everyone	glue ♡ I help set the table
glue ♡ I pray for someone	glue ♡ I share my snack
glue ♡ I say sorry	glue ♡ I put my things away
glue ♡ I listen to my parents	glue ♡ I comfort a friend
glue ♡ I say thank you to God	glue ♡ I give someone a hug
glue ♡ I help without grumbling	glue ♡ I smile at someone new

Advent Maze Ages 4-6

Help Mary and Joseph Reach Bethlehem

Mary and Joseph leave Nazareth for Bethlehem. With your pencil, trace the path that leads them to the stable.

Name: _____

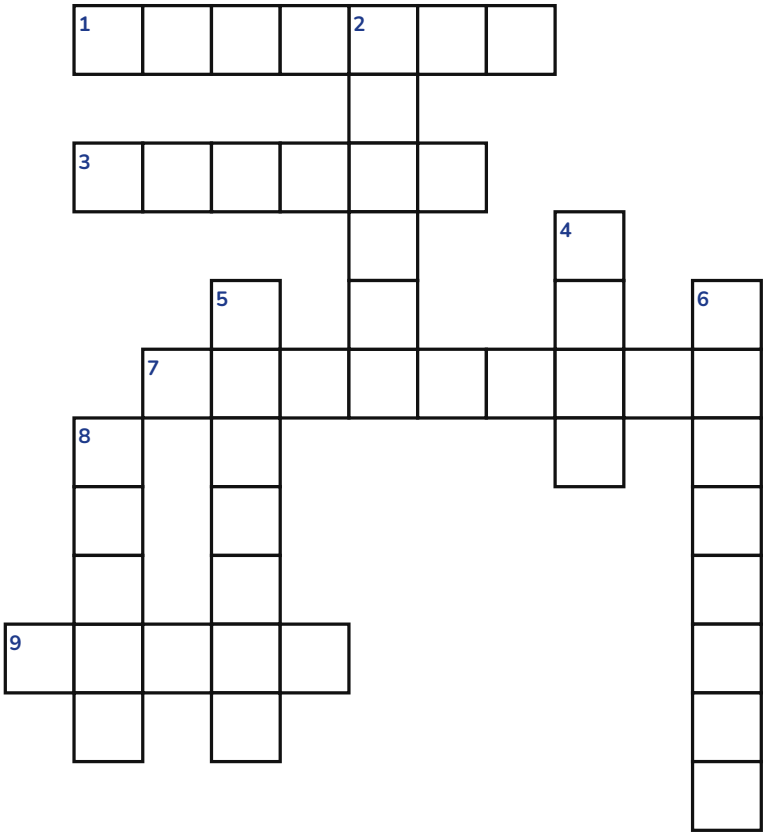


Advent · Crossword · Ages 10-12

The Prophets Announce the Messiah

The prophets announced the coming of the Messiah. Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

1. Advent is a time of ... and getting ready.

3. River where Jesus is baptized.

7. Small town in Judea, the town of King David.

9. Prophet who announced that the Messiah would be born in Bethlehem.

Down ↓

2. Prophet who announced the sign of Emmanuel.

4. Name of Jesus' cousin, the Baptist.

5. The one God promised to send to save his people.

6. Name that means "God is with us" (Matthew 1:23).

8. King of Israel, son of Jesse and ancestor of Jesus.

Answer Key: 1A WAITING · 3A JORDAN · 7A BETHLEHEM · 9A MICAH · 2D ISAIAH · 4D JOHN · 5D MESSIAH · 6D EMMANUEL · 8D DAVID

Advent · Prayer · Ages 4-12

My Little Advent Prayer Booklet

Cut out the four pages, fold them in half, and staple them to make your little booklet. Each week of Advent, read the prayer and draw in the frame.

Name: _____

Week 1 · I Watch

I draw someone I love.

Lord, keep my eyes open to see the little acts of love around me. Amen.

Week 2 · I Prepare

I draw my home waiting for you.

Lord, help me prepare your way by being gentle and patient. Amen.

Week 3 · I Rejoice

I draw what makes me happy.

Lord, you are coming soon! Fill my heart with your joy. Amen.

Week 4 · I Say Yes

I draw Mary waiting for Jesus.

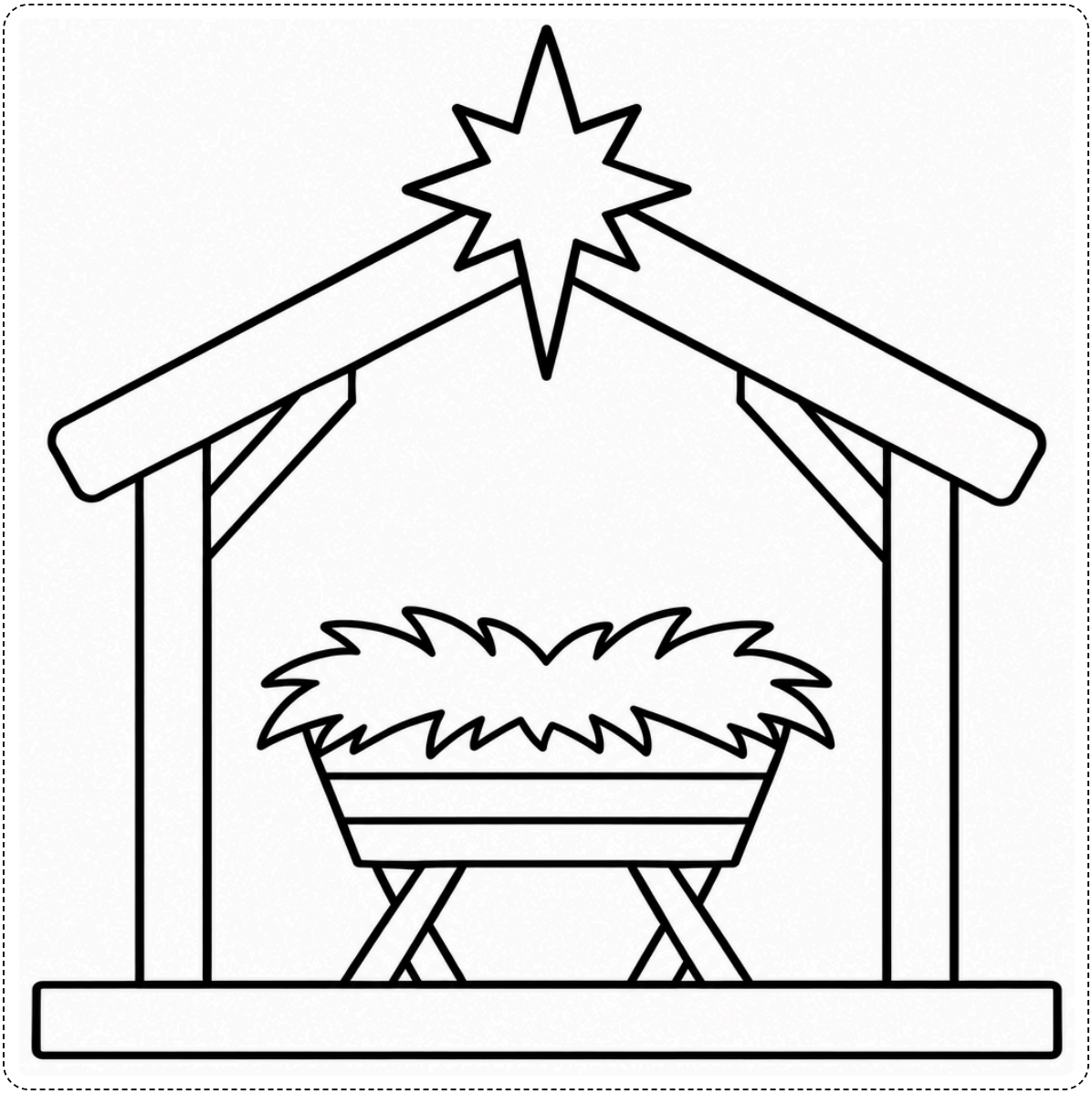
Lord, like Mary, I want to say yes to you with all my heart. Amen.

Christmas | Cut-Out | Ages 4-12

The Nativity Scene to Cut Out (1): The Stable and the Manger

Here are the stable and the manger for your Nativity scene. Color them, then cut them out. The next pages give you the figures.

Name: _____



1 Cut along the dotted lines.

2 Glue the page onto cardstock to make it sturdy.

3 Fold the little base back so the figure can stand up.

Christmas | Cut-Out | Ages 4-12

The Nativity Scene to Cut Out (2): Mary, Joseph, and Baby Jesus

Color Mary, Joseph, and Baby Jesus, then cut them out. Keep Baby Jesus aside and place him in the manger on Christmas Eve!

Name: _____

1 Cut along the dotted lines.

2 Glue the page onto cardstock to make it sturdy.

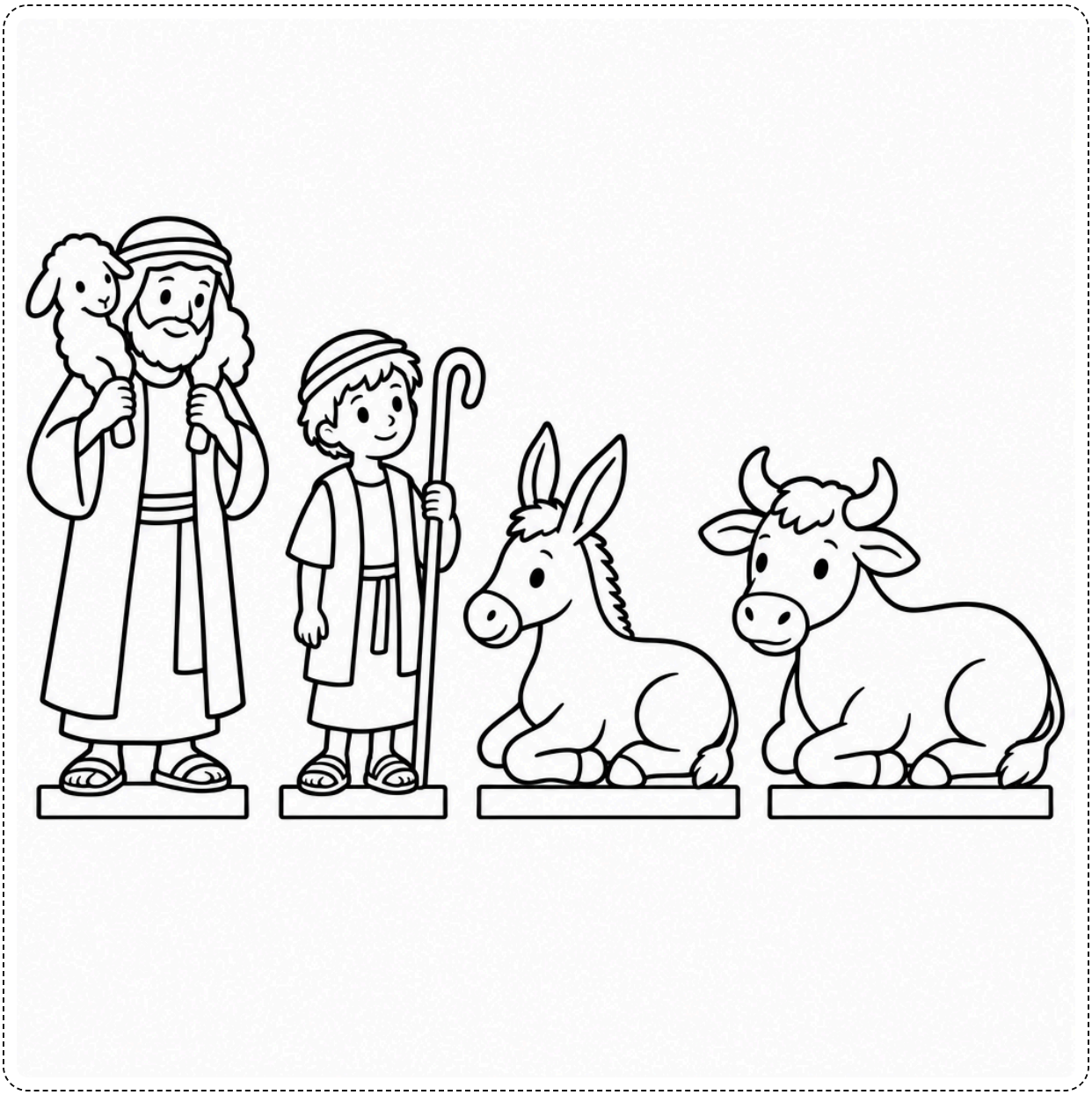
3 Fold the little base back so the figure can stand up.

Christmas | Cut-Out | Ages 4-12

The Nativity Scene to Cut Out (3): The Shepherds, the Donkey, and the Ox

Color the shepherds, the donkey, and the ox, then cut them out. Place them around the manger.

Name: _____



1 Cut along the dotted lines.

2 Glue the page onto cardstock to make it sturdy.

3 Fold the little base back so the figure can stand up.

Christmas | Coloring | Ages 4-6

Baby Jesus in the Manger

Jesus is born in Bethlehem! Mary and Joseph look at him with love. Color the Nativity scene with your favorite colors.

Name: _____

Christmas | Coloring | Ages 7-9

The Angels Sing: "Glory to God!"

On Christmas night, the angels bring the good news to the shepherds. Color the angels and the starry sky.

Name: _____

"Glory to God in the highest
and on earth peace to those on whom his favor rests."
Luke 2:14

Christmas Craft Ages 4-8

The Christmas Star to Hang

Color the star yellow or gold. Cut it out, ask a grown-up to punch a hole in the little circle, and thread a string through it to hang it on the tree.

Name: _____

1 Color the star and add glitter if you like.

2 Cut along the dotted lines.

3 Punch a hole in the little circle and thread a pretty string through it.

Christmas | Craft | Ages 7-12

My Folding Christmas Card for My Family

Color the card, cut it out, and fold it in half on the green line. Inside, write a short message for your family.

Name: _____

fold

Made with love by

_____

Merry Christmas!

Message idea: *"Jesus is born! I wish you a Christmas full of joy and peace. I am praying for you."*

Christmas · Bingo · Ages 4-8

Christmas Bingo

Each player takes a card. The leader reads a word from the list: if you have it, cover it with a marker. The first one to fill a card shouts "Christmas!"

Name: _____

Card 1		
Mary	ox	Bethlehem
sheep	gift	candle
manger	straw	Wise Men

Card 2		
stable	star	gift
shepherd	sheep	Joseph
straw	candle	donkey

Card 3		
stable	gift	Jesus
Joseph	ox	sheep
Mary	Wise Men	straw

Card 4		
straw	shepherd	donkey
star	angel	Bethlehem
sheep	Joseph	candle

Words to call: Jesus · Mary · Joseph · star · angel · shepherd · sheep · donkey · ox · stable · manger · straw · Bethlehem · Wise Men · gift · candle

Christmas · Riddles · Ages 7-9

Nativity Riddles

Read each riddle and write the answer. The answers are at the bottom, upside down.

Name: _____

1. I was in a stable, and I became the bed for the baby. What am I?

   _____

2. I shine over the stable and guide the Wise Men. What am I?

   _____

3. I was watching my sheep at night when an angel spoke to me. Who am I?

   _____

4. I am the town where Jesus was born. What am I?

   _____

5. I told the shepherds not to be afraid and brought them good news of great joy. Who am I?

   _____

6. I carry Mary on my back during the long journey. Who am I?

   _____

Answer Key: 1 the manger · 2 the star · 3 a shepherd · 4 Bethlehem · 5 an angel · 6 the donkey

Christmas | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Christmas Words

Find the 12 Christmas words in the grid.

Name: _____

B	E	T	H	L	E	H	E	M	I	O	I
L	S	T	A	B	L	E	B	K	M	C	N
N	V	N	Y	C	R	P	C	C	A	W	S
F	T	R	S	D	U	W	L	H	N	J	H
J	E	K	B	I	N	U	S	R	G	E	E
O	L	A	R	A	H	N	T	I	E	S	P
S	S	I	F	N	S	I	R	S	R	U	H
E	T	W	G	G	H	W	A	T	H	S	E
P	A	K	R	E	F	D	W	M	E	H	R
H	R	R	V	L	U	C	M	A	R	Y	D
C	H	E	K	C	V	D	B	S	A	O	M
M	E	B	K	T	E	B	I	R	T	H	E

- ☐ Christmas
- ☐ Jesus
- ☐ manger
- ☐ shepherd
- ☐ angel
- ☐ star
- ☐ stable
- ☐ straw
- ☐ Bethlehem
- ☐ Mary
- ☐ Joseph
- ☐ birth

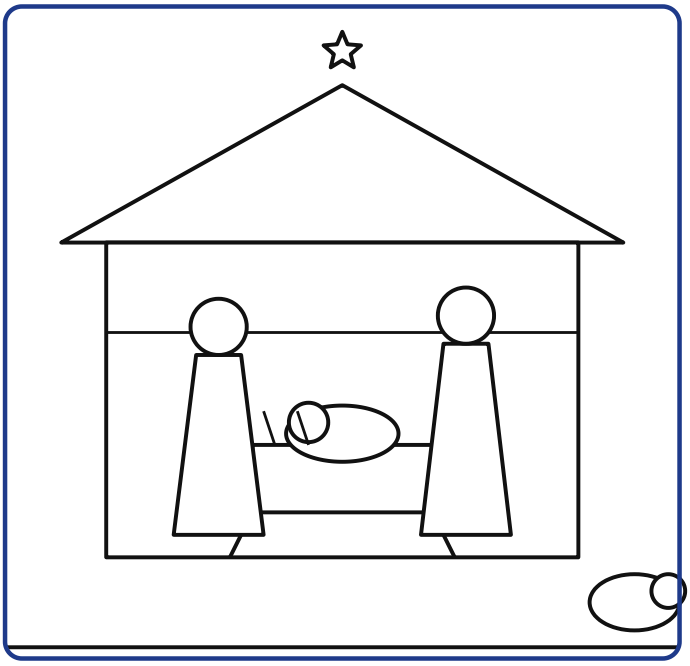
Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Christmas Game Ages 4-6

Spot the Seven Differences in the Nativity Scene

Look closely at the two Nativity scenes: there are 7 differences. Circle them in the bottom picture, then color both pictures.

Name: _____



Answer Key: the star · the baby's halo · Joseph's staff · where the sheep is · the moon · the flower · the straw

Christmas Prayer Ages 4-12

My Prayer at the Nativity Scene

On Christmas Eve, stand in front of the Nativity scene with your family and say this prayer softly.

Name: _____

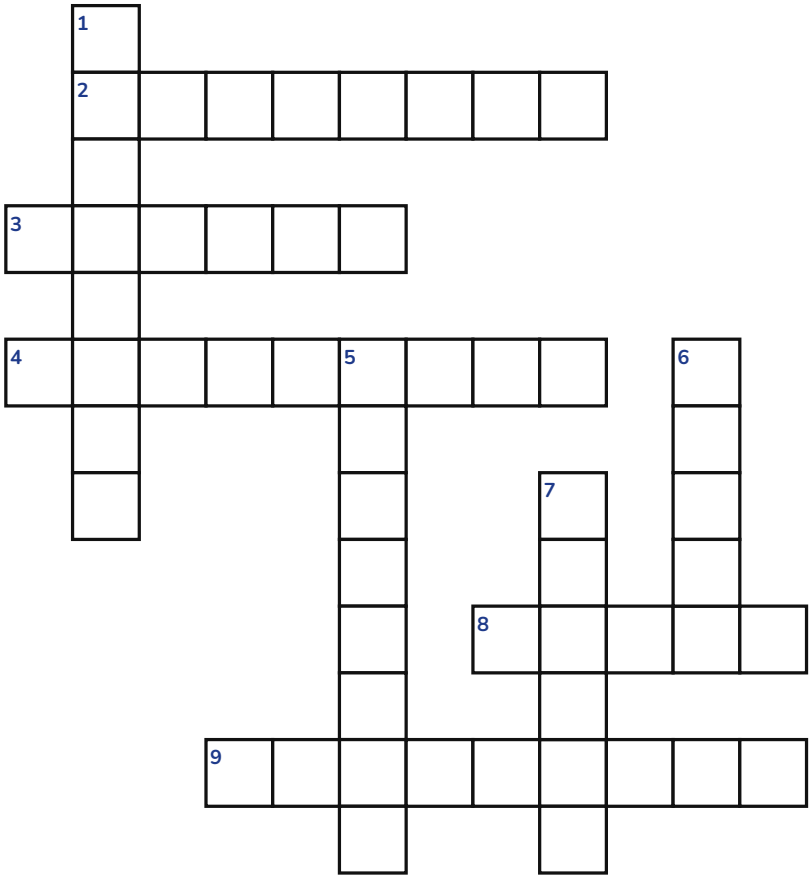
Little Jesus, you came for us
in a cold stable.
Thank you for being born for me.
I give you my heart as a gift:
make it gentle and joyful like yours.
Bless my family and all the children of the world,
especially those who are cold or sad.
Amen.

Christmas Crossword Ages 10-12

The Birth of Jesus According to St. Luke

Read the story of Jesus' birth in the Gospel according to Luke (Luke 2:1-20), then fill in the grid.

Name: _____



Across →

2. Caesar who ordered that the whole world should be enrolled.

3. "For today in the city of David a ... has been born for you..." (Luke 2:11)

4. City of David where Jesus is born.

8. He brings the shepherds good news of great joy.

9. They keep watch over their flock at night.

Down ↓

1. Town in Galilee that Joseph and Mary leave.

5. Joseph and Mary go to Bethlehem to be ...

6. "Glory to God in the highest and on earth ... to those on whom his favor rests." (Luke 2:14)

7. Mary lays Baby Jesus in it, since the inn has no room for them.

Answer Key: 2A AUGUSTUS · 3A SAVIOR · 4A BETHLEHEM · 8A ANGEL · 9A SHEPHERDS · 1D NAZARETH · 5D ENROLLED · 6D PEACE · 7D MANGER

Christmas | Coloring | Ages 4-8

The Shepherds Go to the Manger

The shepherds hurry to see the baby lying in the manger. Color them with their sheep.

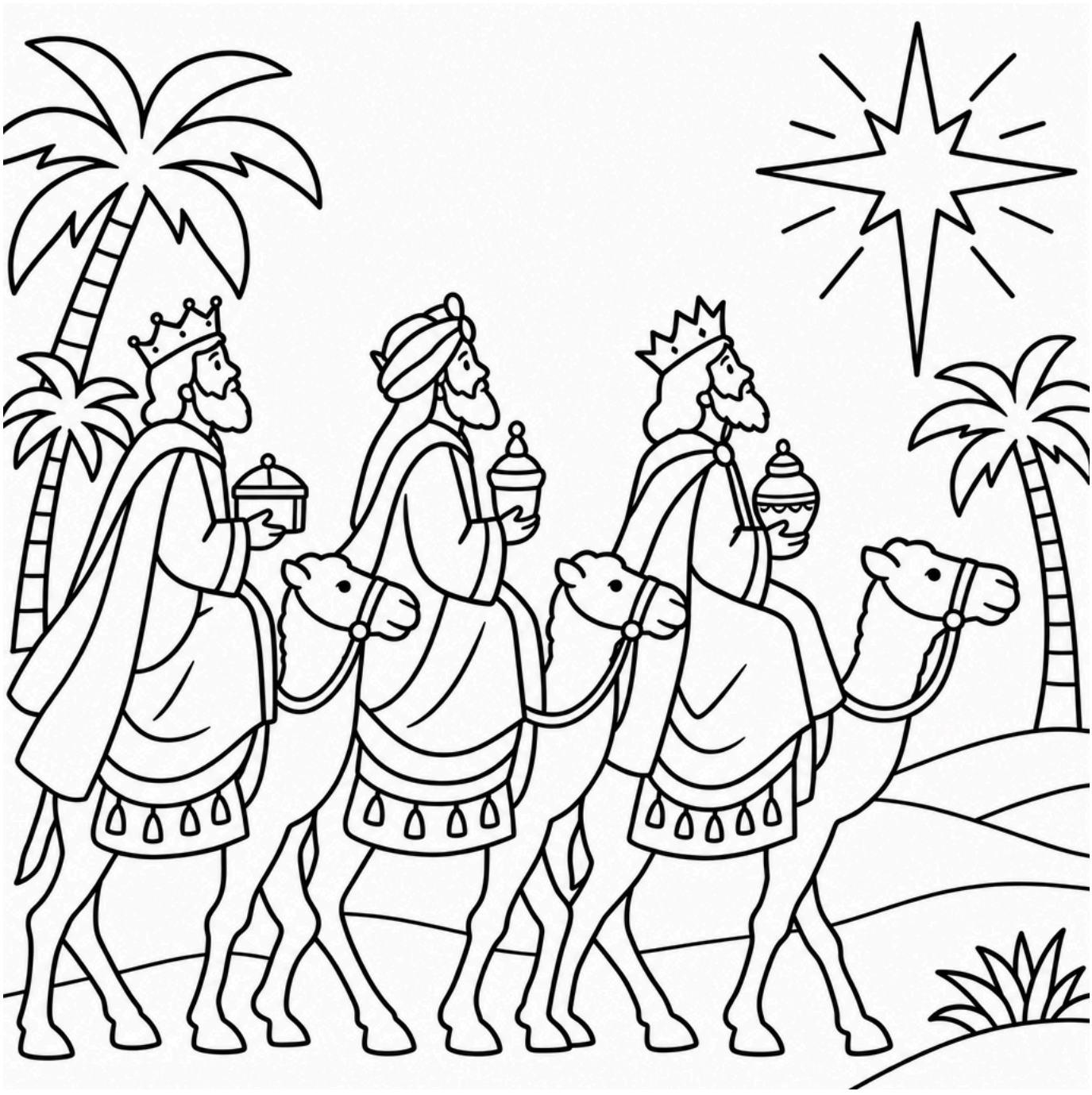
Name: _____

Epiphany Coloring Ages 4-8

The Wise Men Follow the Star

Wise Men from the East follow a star to worship the newborn king. Color them with their camels.

Name: _____

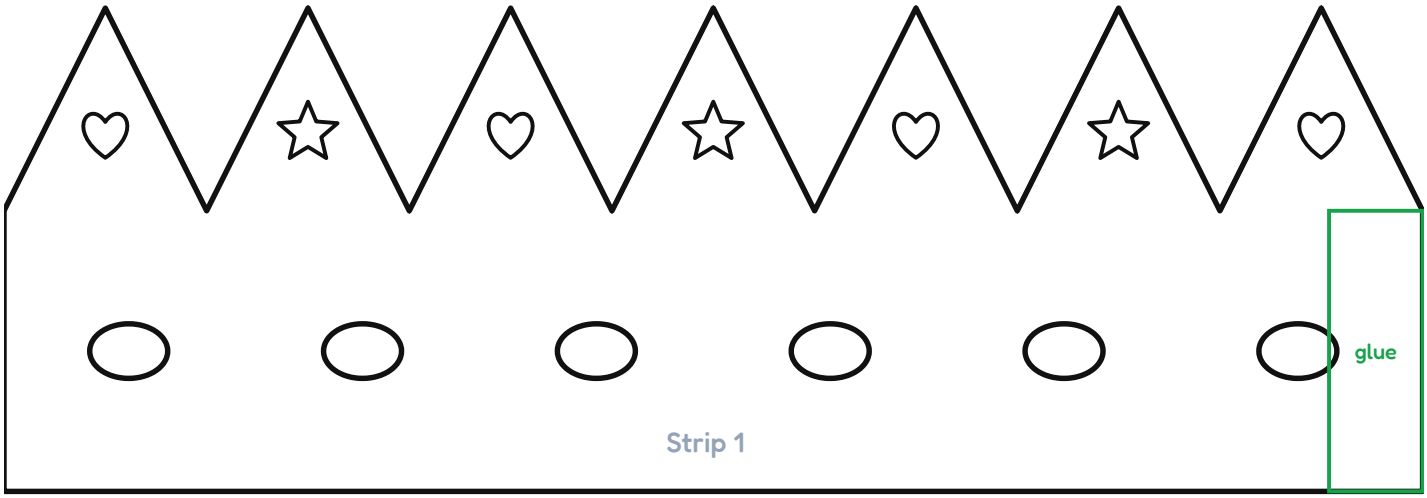


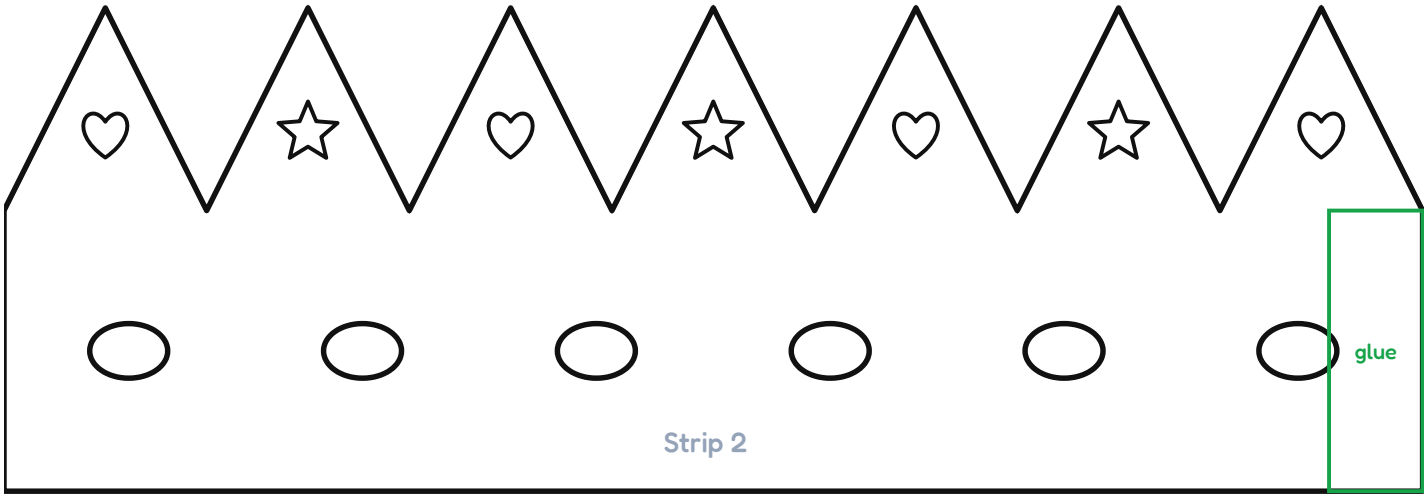
Epiphany Craft Ages 4-12

The Wise Men's Crown to Decorate

Color the two strips yellow or gold, and the jewels in all the colors you like. Cut them out and glue them end to end to fit your head.

Name: _____





1 Color and decorate the two strips.

2 Cut along the outline.

3 Glue Strip 2 onto the "glue" box of Strip 1, then close the crown around your head.

Epiphany Matching Ages 4-6

Match Each Wise Man to His Gift: Gold, Frankincense, and Myrrh

According to a beautiful tradition, the Wise Men have names. Match each Wise Man to his gift, then match the gift to what it means.

Name: _____

Melchior brings... ●	● myrrh: Jesus is truly a man who will give his life
Caspar brings... ●	● gold: Jesus is a king
Balthasar brings... ●	● frankincense: Jesus is God

Answer Key: Melchior: gold, Jesus is a king · Caspar: frankincense, Jesus is God · Balthasar: myrrh, Jesus is truly a man who will give his life

Epiphany Maze Ages 7-9

Follow the Star to Jesus

Help the Wise Men follow the star to the child Jesus. Trace the path without crossing the walls.

Name: _____

The Wise Men

Jesus

Epiphany · Game · Ages 7-12

The Wise Men Card Game: 20 Questions About Epiphany

Cut out the 20 cards and place them face down. Take turns drawing a card and answering. Right answer: keep the card! Whoever has the most cards wears the crown from page 34!

Name: _____

1 Who guides the Wise Men?	**2** Where do the Wise Men come from?	**3** How many gifts do they bring?	**4** Which king asks the Wise Men to come back and see him?
5 In which town do they find Jesus?	**6** Which three letters do some families chalk on their door at Epiphany?	**7** What does "Epiphany" mean?	**8** What are the Wise Men's names in the tradition?
9 Which gift says that Jesus is a king?	**10** Which gift says that Jesus is God?	**11** Which gift points to his Passion?	**12** What do the Wise Men do when they see Jesus?
13 Which way do they go home?	**14** Who warns them in a dream?	**15** Who is with the child?	**16** In which Gospel do we read this story?
17 What does a king wear on his head?	**18** Did Jesus come only for the people of Israel?	**19** Are the Wise Men rich or poor?	**20** Which animal often carries the Wise Men?

Answer Key: 1 a star · 2 the East · 3 three · 4 Herod · 5 Bethlehem · 6 C + M + B · 7 showing, revealing · 8 Caspar, Melchior, Balthasar · 9 gold · 10 frankincense · 11 myrrh · 12 they worship him · 13 by another way · 14 God · 15 Mary, his mother · 16 Matthew · 17 a crown · 18 no, for all peoples · 19 rich · 20 the camel

Epiphany · Riddles · Ages 7-12

Why Gold, Frankincense, and Myrrh?

Read each riddle and write the answer. They will help you understand the gifts of the Wise Men.

Name: _____

1. I shine, I am precious, and people give me to kings. What am I?

   _____

2. I make sweet-smelling smoke that rises to heaven, like prayer. What am I?

   _____

3. I am a bitter perfume that was used to prepare the bodies of the dead. What am I?

   _____

4. In the United States, I am celebrated on the Sunday between January 2 and January 8. What am I?

   _____

5. I was jealous of the new king and wanted to kill him. Who am I?

   _____

6. I am the mother of the king the Wise Men worship. Who am I?

   _____

Answer Key: 1 gold · 2 frankincense · 3 myrrh · 4 the Epiphany · 5 King Herod · 6 Mary

Presentation of the Lord (February 2) Coloring Ages 4-8

Mary and Joseph Present Jesus in the Temple

Forty days after Christmas, Mary and Joseph present Jesus in the Temple. Old Simeon takes him in his arms: he recognizes the Savior! Color the scene.

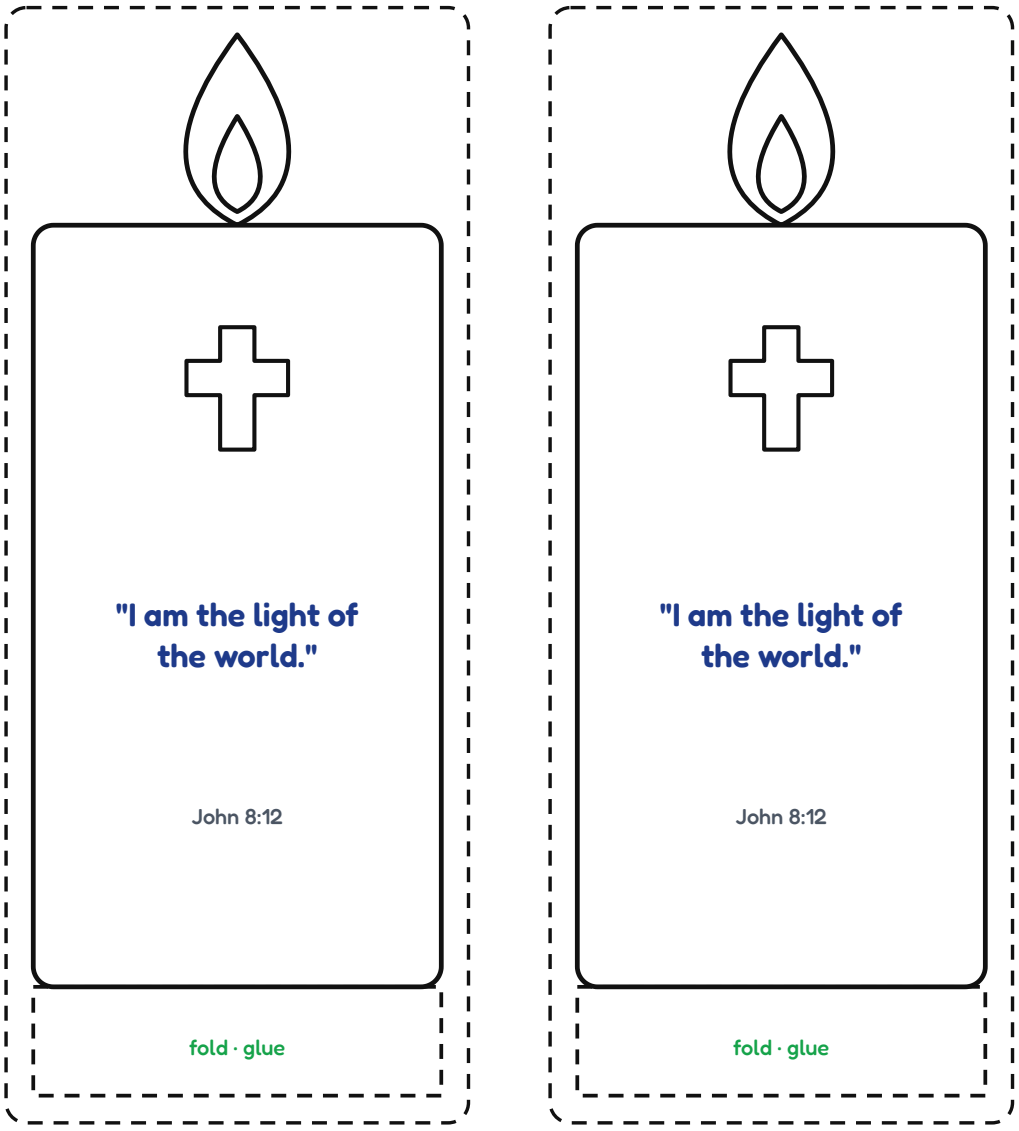
Name: _____

Presentation of the Lord (February 2) Craft Ages 4-12

My Candle for Candlemas: Jesus, the Light of the World

On February 2, candles are blessed at Mass: Jesus is the light of the world. Color your two candles, cut them out, and fold the bottom so they can stand up.

Name: _____



1 Color the flame yellow and orange.

2 Cut along the dotted lines.

3 Fold the bottom strip and glue it into a circle: your candle stands up!

Presentation of the Lord (February 2) Prayer Ages 7-12

The Canticle of Simeon Explained to Kids

When Simeon holds Baby Jesus in his arms, he thanks God. The Church sings his prayer every night.

Name: _____

"Now, Master, you may let your servant go
in peace, according to your word,
for my eyes have seen your salvation,
which you prepared in sight of all the peoples,
a light for revelation to the Gentiles,
and glory for your people Israel."

Luke 2:29-32

What This Prayer Means

- Simeon waited his whole life for the Savior God had promised. He is happy: at last he has seen Jesus!
- "Your salvation" is Jesus: he comes to save all people.
- "A light" is Jesus too: he shines for all the nations, like a candle in the night.

Your Turn to Pray

At night, before you go to sleep, you can say: "Thank you, Lord, for this day. I saw your light in..." and finish the sentence.

Presentation of the Lord (February 2) | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Words of the Presentation in the Temple

Find the 12 words of the Presentation of Jesus in the Temple in the grid.

Name: _____

G	T	T	Y	C	P	K	H	E	C	Y	C	G
C	U	T	P	J	R	U	F	U	S	E	W	D
T	R	E	S	E	E	S	I	M	E	O	N	L
S	T	M	I	R	S	B	B	I	J	R	L	N
K	L	P	I	U	E	W	L	V	O	D	L	W
N	E	L	A	S	N	K	E	O	S	M	I	V
C	D	E	I	A	T	D	S	F	E	N	G	R
U	O	H	T	L	A	F	S	F	P	C	H	M
F	V	W	S	E	T	I	I	E	H	A	T	A
U	E	B	S	M	I	H	N	R	B	N	Y	R
A	S	N	P	O	O	V	G	I	E	D	N	Y
R	N	L	B	M	N	L	I	N	K	L	I	Y
W	M	A	J	E	S	U	S	G	R	E	D	V

- ☐ Temple
- ☐ Simeon
- ☐ offering
- ☐ light
- ☐ candle
- ☐ presentation
- ☐ turtledoves
- ☐ Jerusalem
- ☐ Mary
- ☐ Joseph
- ☐ Jesus
- ☐ blessing

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Presentation of the Lord (February 2) Game Ages 4-8

True or False: The Presentation of the Lord

For each sentence, check "True" or "False."

Name: _____

1. The Presentation of the Lord is celebrated on February 2. True False
2. This feast celebrates the birth of Jesus. True False
3. It comes forty days after Christmas. True False
4. On this day, Mary and Joseph present Jesus in the Temple in Jerusalem. True False
5. Old Simeon does not recognize Jesus. True False
6. On this feast, candles are blessed at Mass. True False
7. This day is also called "Candlemas" because of the candles. True False
8. The prophetess Anna also thanks God and speaks about the child. True False
9. Joseph and Mary offer a lamb in the Temple. True False

Did you know? Mary and Joseph offer two turtledoves: the offering of families who could not afford a lamb.

Answer Key: 1 true · 2 false · 3 true · 4 true · 5 false · 6 true · 7 true · 8 true · 9 false

Lent Craft Ages 4-12

The Lenten Path: 40 Steps to Easter

Lent lasts forty days. Each evening, if you made an effort to love God and others, color one stone of the path. At the end of the path: the joy of Easter!

Name: _____

1 Ashes
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10
11
12
13
14
15
16
17
18
19
20
21
22
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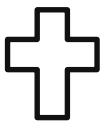


Easter!

Lent Calendar Ages 7-12

My Lenten Calendar: One Small Effort a Day

One small effort a day during the forty days of Lent. When you have made the day's effort, color its box.

Name: _____

1 I pray in the morning	**2** I share my snack	**3** I say thank you	**4** I turn off screens tonight	**5** I help without grumbling
6 I forgive	**7** I read the Gospel	**8** I clean my room	**9** I call a grandparent	**10** I give away a toy
11 I don't complain	**12** I comfort a friend	**13** I pray for peace	**14** I set the table	**15** I tell the truth
16 I smile at everyone	**17** I eat what's served without complaining	**18** I pray for the sick	**19** I listen to my parents	**20** I draw a picture for Jesus
21 I play with a child who is alone	**22** I do a favor for someone	**23** I say sorry	**24** I say an Our Father	**25** I put a coin in my giving box
26 I don't make fun of anyone	**27** I do my homework right away	**28** I thank God tonight	**29** I help with the dishes	**30** I visit an elderly person
31 I pray for my family	**32** I don't argue	**33** I give someone a compliment	**34** I share my games	**35** I go to Mass
36 I sing for God	**37** I get ready for Palm Sunday	**38** I offer up my efforts to Jesus	**39** I pray before the cross	**40** I get ready for Easter

Lent | Coloring | Ages 7-9

Ash Wednesday

Lent begins on Ash Wednesday. The priest traces a small cross of ashes on our foreheads and may say: "Repent, and believe in the gospel" (Mark 1:15). Color the scene.

Name: _____

Lent Coloring Ages 4-8

Jesus Prays for Forty Days in the Desert

Before beginning his mission, Jesus spends forty days in the desert. He prays to his Father and resists the tempter. Color Jesus praying.

Name: _____

Lent Prayer Ages 7-12

Pray, Give, and Fast: The Three Paths of Lent

During Lent, the Church invites us to take three paths to grow closer to God and to others.

Name: _____

1. Pray: I Talk to God

Every day, I take a little time to talk to Jesus, to thank him, and to place in his hands the people I love.

2. Give: I Think of Others

I give some of my time, my toys, or my allowance to people in need.

3. Fast: I Give Up Something I Like

I give up something I enjoy (a treat, screen time, a game...) to make more room for God in my heart.

Lord Jesus,
during these forty days,
teach me to pray with trust,
to share with joy,
and to make small efforts out of love for you.
Amen.

My prayer effort: .....

My giving effort: .....

My fasting effort: .....

Lent Game Ages 7-9

The Lenten Good Choices Game

For each situation, check what Jesus would like you to do.

Name: _____

1 Your little brother breaks your drawing by accident.

☐ I get really angry ☐ I forgive him and start again

2 A classmate is all alone at recess.

☐ I invite him to play ☐ I act like I don't see him

3 You have two cookies and your friend has none.

☐ I eat them both ☐ I give him one

4 Mom asks you to clean your room.

☐ I clean it without grumbling ☐ I say I'm too tired

5 You told a lie.

☐ I hide it ☐ I tell the truth and say I'm sorry

6 It's time for bedtime prayer.

☐ I spend a moment with Jesus ☐ I'd rather watch TV

7 Someone is making fun of a child in your class.

☐ I laugh with the others ☐ I stand up for the child

Answer Key: 1 | forgive him and start again · 2 | invite him to play · 3 | give him one · 4 | clean it without grumbling · 5 | tell the truth and say I'm sorry · 6 | spend a moment with Jesus · 7 | stand up for the child

Lent | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Lenten Words

Find the 12 Lenten words in the grid.

Name: _____

V	K	M	R	T	B	U	D	R	D	T	F
I	R	I	V	H	G	I	V	I	N	G	A
O	B	P	T	F	O	R	G	I	V	E	S
L	E	K	A	F	A	S	T	I	N	G	Y
E	B	C	O	N	V	E	R	S	I	O	N
T	F	G	D	E	Y	E	F	F	O	R	T
K	D	G	F	G	B	E	A	P	E	D	D
L	E	C	O	F	V	N	S	R	A	A	F
U	S	O	R	G	B	M	H	A	S	F	S
L	E	N	T	T	M	F	E	Y	T	G	W
H	R	L	Y	O	G	R	S	E	E	F	T
K	T	D	G	A	L	P	W	R	R	K	Y

- ☐ Lent
- ☐ ashes
- ☐ forty
- ☐ desert
- ☐ prayer
- ☐ giving
- ☐ fasting
- ☐ forgive
- ☐ violet
- ☐ effort
- ☐ conversion
- ☐ Easter

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

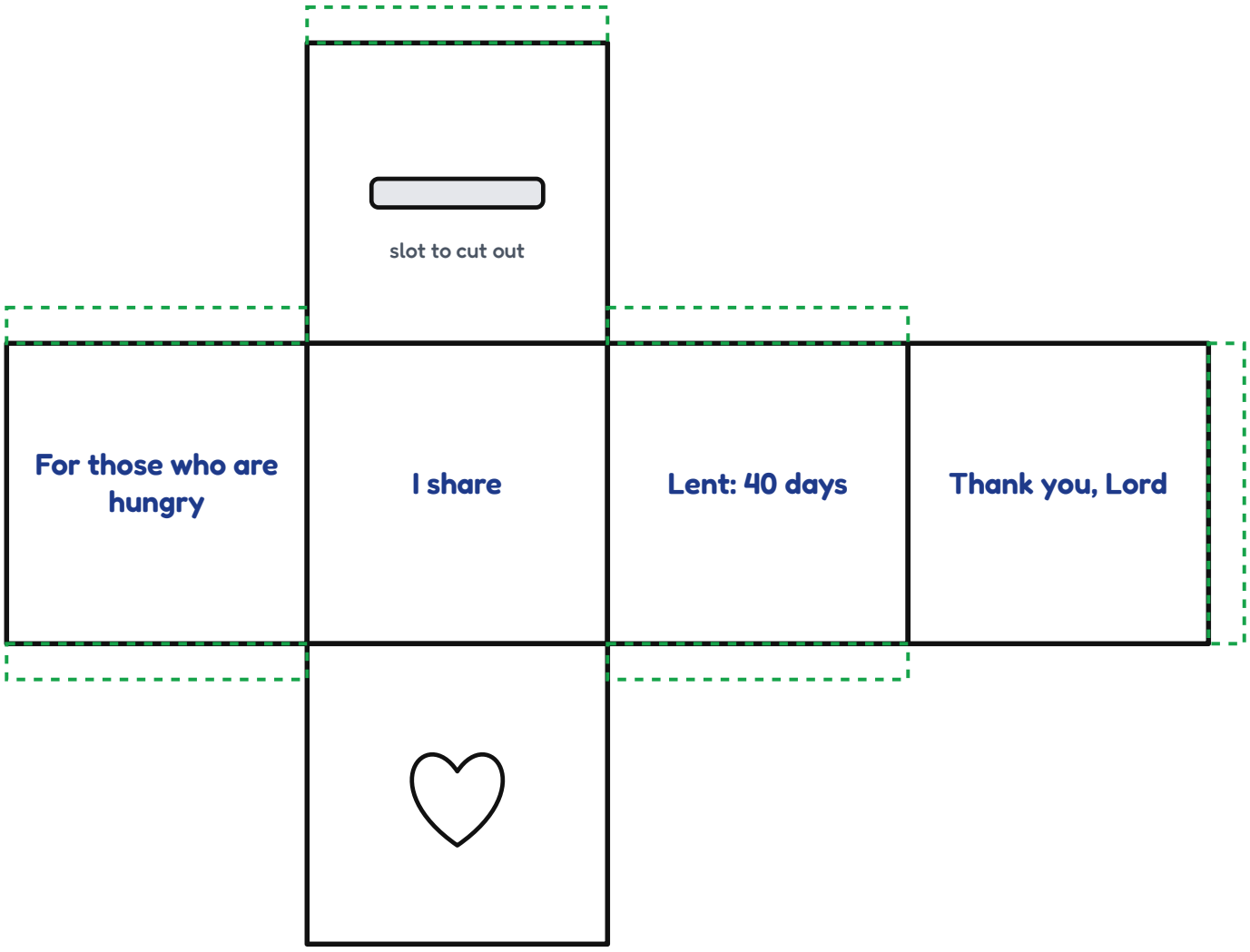
Lent Craft Ages 4-8

My Lenten Giving Box

During Lent, put a small coin in your giving box each time you give up a treat. At Easter, your family gives it all to help people who are poor, like the Lenten rice bowls many parishes collect.

Name: _____

You will need: scissors, glue, crayons, and a grown-up to cut the slot.



1 Color, then cut out the pattern, keeping the green tabs.

2 Ask a grown-up to cut the slot.

3 Fold on each line and glue the tabs to close the box.

Lent Riddles Ages 7-12

The Parables of Forgiveness: Who Am I?

Jesus tells parables to show how much God loves and forgives us. Guess who is speaking!

Name: _____

1. I had a hundred sheep. I lost one, and I left the others to look for it. Who am I?

   _____

2. I lost a silver coin. I swept the whole house until I found it. Who am I?

   _____

3. I asked for my share of the inheritance, went far away, and spent it all. Who am I?

   _____

4. I saw my son coming home from far away, ran to hug him, and threw a party. Who am I?

   _____

5. I always stayed and worked with my father, and I was jealous of the party for my brother. Who am I?

   _____

6. I climbed a tree to see Jesus, and he came to eat at my house. Who am I?

   _____

Answer Key: 1 the Good Shepherd · 2 the woman who lost a coin · 3 the younger son · 4 the father · 5 the older son · 6 Zacchaeus (not a parable: a real meeting!)

Lent | Coloring | Ages 4-8

The Prodigal Son Comes Home to His Father

The son comes home to his father. His father runs to him and hugs him: God always forgives us! Color the scene.

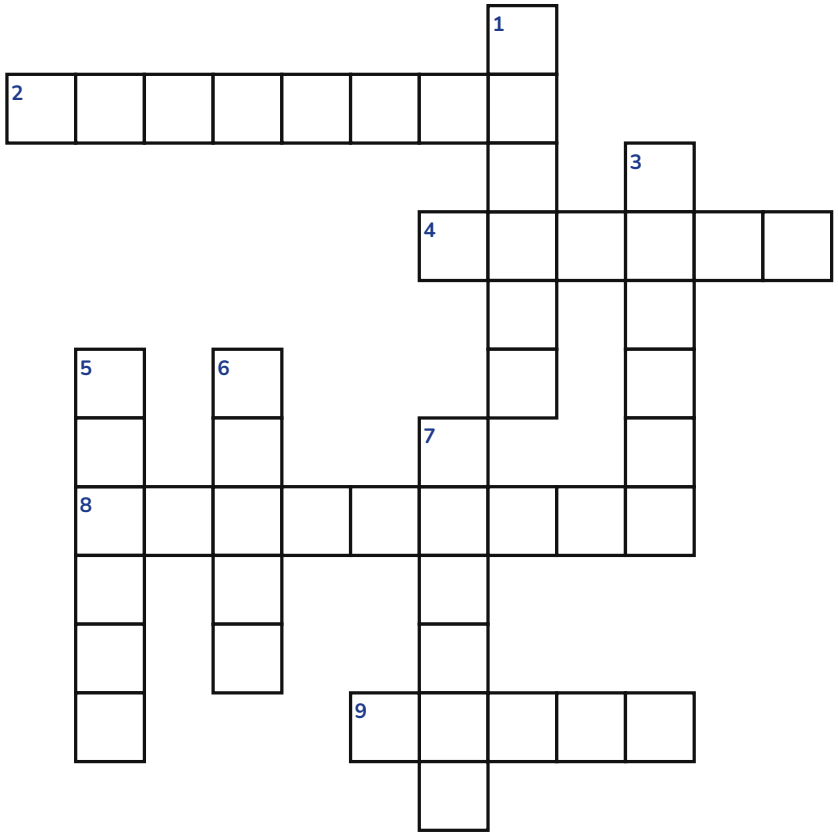
Name: _____

Lent · Crossword · Ages 10-12

Jesus' Forty Days in the Desert

Read the story of Jesus' temptations (Matthew 4:1-11), then fill in the grid.

Name: _____



Across →

2. From a very high ..., the devil shows him all the kingdoms of the world.

4. Place where the Spirit leads Jesus.

8. To answer the devil, Jesus quotes the Word of God, the ...

9. The one who tempts Jesus.

Down ↓

1. After the temptations, they come and serve Jesus.

3. The devil takes Jesus to the top of the ...

5. Jesus did not eat during those days: he ...

6. Number of days and nights Jesus spends there.

7. What the devil wants Jesus to turn into bread.

Answer Key: 2A MOUNTAIN · 4A DESERT · 8A SCRIPTURE · 9A DEVIL · 1D ANGELS · 3D TEMPLE · 5D FASTED · 6D FORTY · 7D STONES

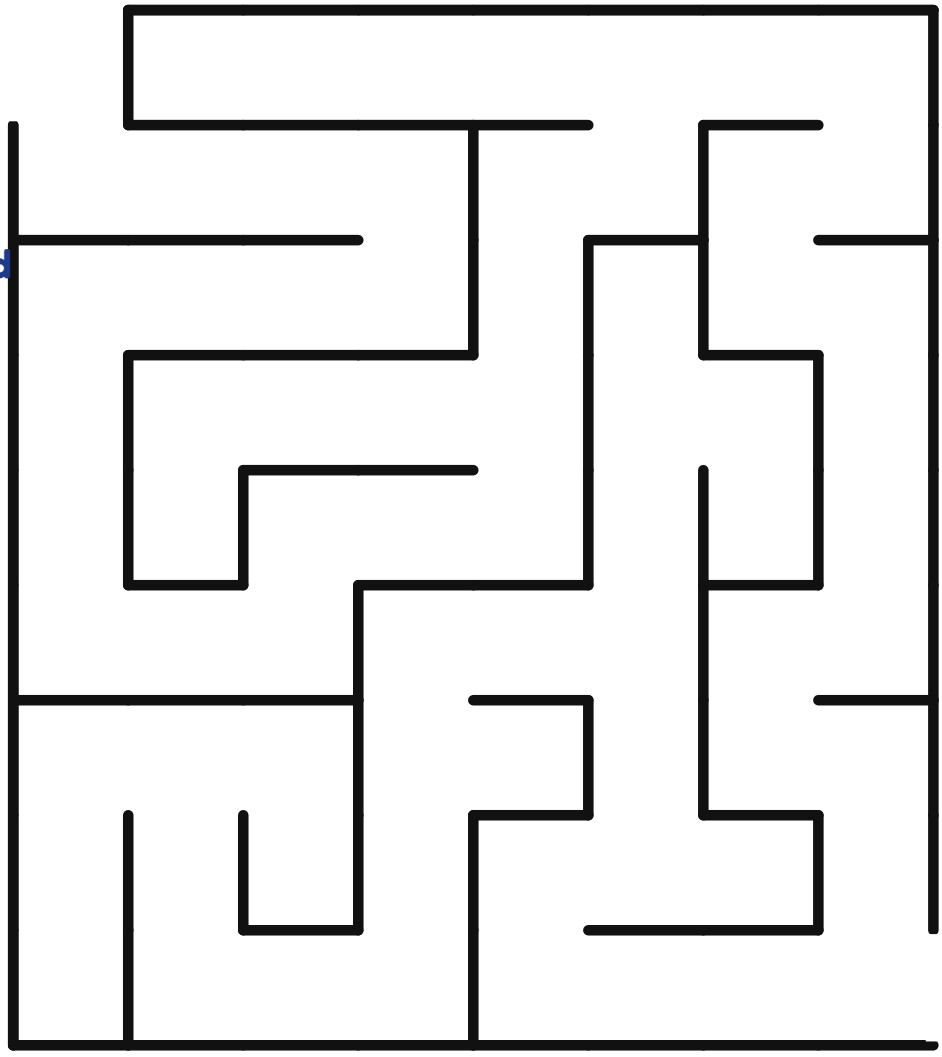
Lent Maze Ages 4-6

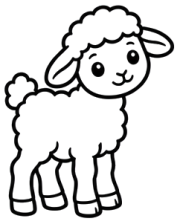
The Good Shepherd Finds His Sheep

A sheep is lost. Help the Good Shepherd find it: trace the path with your pencil.

Name: _____

The shepherd





The sheep

Lent Prayer Ages 10-12

My Examination of Conscience to Prepare for Confession

Before you receive God's forgiveness, take a quiet moment. Read each question and answer it in your heart.

Name: _____

With God

- Did I take time to pray and to thank God?
- Did I respect God's name?
- Did I go to Mass on Sunday?

With Others

- Did I obey my parents?
- Did I tell lies, make fun of others, or say hurtful words?
- Was I jealous, or did I take something that wasn't mine?
- Did I refuse to forgive or to share?

With Myself

- Did I take care of my body, my schoolwork, and my things?
- Was I lazy about doing good?

Lord Jesus, you know my heart.
I am sorry for the wrong I have done and the good I have not done.
Forgive me and help me to love better. Amen.

Then you can go to Confession (the sacrament of Reconciliation): God forgives you and gives you his peace.

Lent Prayer Ages 7-12

The Children's Stations of the Cross (1): Stations 1-7

The Stations of the Cross follow Jesus step by step, from his condemnation to the tomb. We pray them especially on Fridays in Lent and on Good Friday.

Name: _____

At each station, look at the cross, read the title, then say the short prayer.

We adore you, O Christ, and we bless you.
Because by your holy cross you have redeemed the world.

Say this at the start of each station

1. Jesus is condemned to death.
Jesus, when I am blamed unfairly, help me stay gentle.

2. Jesus takes up his cross.
Jesus, help me carry my troubles with courage.

3. Jesus falls the first time.
Jesus, when I fall, help me get back up.

4. Jesus meets his mother.
Mary, stay close to me when I am sad.

5. Simon of Cyrene helps Jesus carry the cross.
Jesus, teach me to help those who are tired.

6. Veronica wipes the face of Jesus.
Jesus, give me a heart that notices those who suffer.

7. Jesus falls the second time.
Jesus, when I keep making the same mistakes, don't let me fall.

Lent Prayer Ages 7-12

The Children's Stations of the Cross (2): Stations 8-14

Here are the other seven Stations of the Cross. Take your time at each station: Jesus walks with you.

Name: _____

Keep walking with Jesus all the way to the tomb.

We adore you, O Christ, and we bless you.
Because by your holy cross you have redeemed the world.

Say this at the start of each station

8. Jesus meets the women of Jerusalem.
Jesus, even in your pain you think of others: teach me to do the same.

9. Jesus falls the third time.
Jesus, give me the strength never to give up.

10. Jesus is stripped of his garments.
Jesus, help me respect every person.

11. Jesus is nailed to the cross.
Jesus, you forgive those who hurt you: help me forgive.

12. Jesus dies on the cross.
Jesus, thank you for giving your life out of love for us.

13. Jesus is taken down from the cross.
Mary, you hold your Son in your arms: comfort all who are crying.

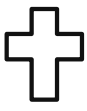
14. Jesus is laid in the tomb.
Jesus, I wait with trust for Easter morning.

Lent Coloring Ages 7-12

The Stations of the Cross in 14 Boxes to Draw and Color

In each box, draw the station of the cross, then color it. The pages before this one can help you.

Name: _____

1 Jesus is condemned to death	**2** Jesus takes up his cross	**3** Jesus falls the first time	**4** Jesus meets his mother
5 Simon of Cyrene helps Jesus	**6** Veronica wipes the face of Jesus	**7** Jesus falls the second time	**8** Jesus meets the women
9 Jesus falls the third time	**10** Jesus is stripped of his garments	**11** Jesus is nailed to the cross	**12** Jesus dies on the cross
13 Jesus is taken down from the cross	**14** Jesus is laid in the tomb	 Jesus gave his life out of love.	On Easter morning, he is alive!

Palm Sunday | Coloring | Ages 4-8

Jesus Enters Jerusalem

Jesus enters Jerusalem on a little donkey. The crowd waves branches and welcomes him like a king. Color the scene.

Name: _____

"Hosanna to the Son of David; blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord..."

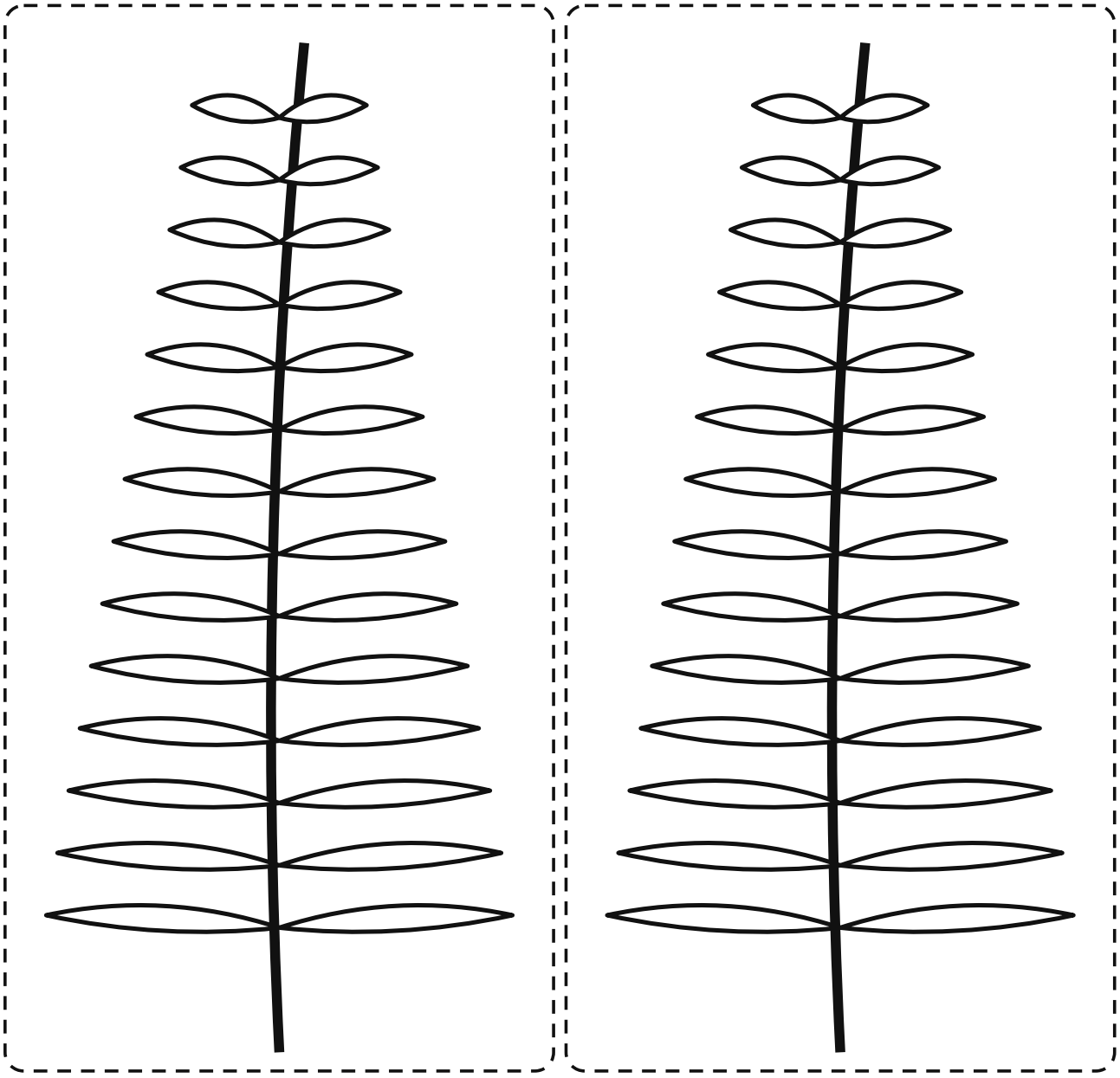
Matthew 21:9

Palm Sunday | Craft | Ages 4-12

My Palm Branch to Make

Color the two palm branches green, cut them out, and glue them to a stick or a drinking straw. On Palm Sunday, wave your palm to welcome Jesus!

Name: _____



1 Color the leaves light green and dark green.

2 Cut along the dotted lines.

3 Glue your palm to a stick and bring it to Palm Sunday Mass.

Palm Sunday | Game | Ages 7-9

Put Jesus' Entry Into Jerusalem in Order

The steps of Jesus' entry into Jerusalem are mixed up. Write a number from 1 to 6 in each box to put them in order (Matthew 21:1-11).

Name: _____

- ☐ **A.** Everyone cries out "Hosanna" to welcome Jesus.
- ☐ **B.** Jesus sends two disciples to bring a donkey and her colt.
- ☐ **C.** The crowd spreads cloaks and branches on the road.
- ☐ **D.** The disciples bring the animals and lay their cloaks on them.
- ☐ **E.** Jesus enters Jerusalem, and the whole city asks who he is.
- ☐ **F.** Jesus sits on the donkey.

Answer Key: order B – D – F – C – A – E

Palm Sunday | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Hosanna! Palm Sunday Words

Find the 12 Palm Sunday words in the grid.

Name: _____

K	M	V	B	P	A	L	M	S	F	A	M
B	L	E	S	S	E	D	H	U	Y	H	U
F	C	H	K	Y	N	T	W	K	C	J	L
V	O	O	N	F	W	P	T	P	T	E	C
D	L	S	P	N	L	F	I	Y	U	R	R
O	T	A	K	S	I	K	B	O	E	U	O
N	W	N	B	R	A	N	C	H	E	S	W
K	G	N	C	L	O	A	K	S	R	A	D
E	T	A	H	Y	U	W	O	W	S	L	S
Y	U	G	T	K	I	N	G	C	F	E	G
R	C	I	L	P	R	O	A	D	E	M	M
E	E	S	H	D	A	V	I	D	I	O	W

- ☐ Hosanna
- ☐ palms
- ☐ donkey
- ☐ cloaks
- ☐ Jerusalem
- ☐ crowd
- ☐ branches
- ☐ king
- ☐ David
- ☐ blessed
- ☐ road
- ☐ colt

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Palm Sunday Skit Ages 7-12

A Short Skit: "Hosanna to the Son of David!"

A short skit to act out in a group (5 minutes). Characters: the narrator, Jesus, two disciples, a child, and the crowd (everyone else, holding branches).

Props: a chair for the donkey, coats or scarves, paper branches.

Narrator — Jesus and his friends are coming near Jerusalem. The great feast of Passover will soon begin.

Jesus — Go into the village. You will find a donkey and her colt there. Bring them to me.

Disciple 1 — And if someone asks us why?

Jesus — Just tell them that the Lord needs them.

The two disciples come back with the "donkey" and lay their coats on it. Jesus sits down.

Disciple 2 — Look! Everyone is coming out of the city to see Jesus!

Child — Mom, who is that man on the donkey? He looks so kind!

Narrator — The crowd spreads cloaks on the road. Others cut branches from the trees.

Crowd — "Hosanna to the Son of David; blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord; hosanna in the highest."

Child — Is he a king? But he has no horse and no army...

Disciple 1 — He is a king of peace. He comes with a gentle and humble heart.

Narrator — And when Jesus enters Jerusalem, the whole city is shaken and asks, "Who is this?"

Crowd — "This is Jesus the prophet, from Nazareth in Galilee."

Everyone waves their branches together and sings a "Hosanna" the parish knows.

After the skit, ask the children: "How can we welcome Jesus today, like the crowd in Jerusalem?"

Palm Sunday | Riddles | Ages 4-8

Palm Sunday Riddles

Read each riddle and write the answer.

Name: _____

1. I am a small animal. Jesus sat on me to enter Jerusalem. Who am I?

   _____

2. People wave me to celebrate Jesus. I am blessed on the Sunday before Easter. What am I?

   _____

3. I am a shout of joy the crowd cries out to Jesus. What am I?

   _____

4. I am the great city Jesus enters as a king. What am I?

   _____

5. People spread me on the road for Jesus, like a carpet. What am I?

   _____

6. I am the Sunday that begins Holy Week. What am I?

   _____

Answer Key: 1 the donkey (the colt) · 2 the palm (the branch) · 3 Hosanna! · 4 Jerusalem · 5 a cloak · 6 Palm Sunday

Holy Week | Coloring | Ages 7-9

Jesus Washes His Disciples' Feet

On Holy Thursday, Jesus washes his disciples' feet. He shows them that to love is to serve. Color the scene.

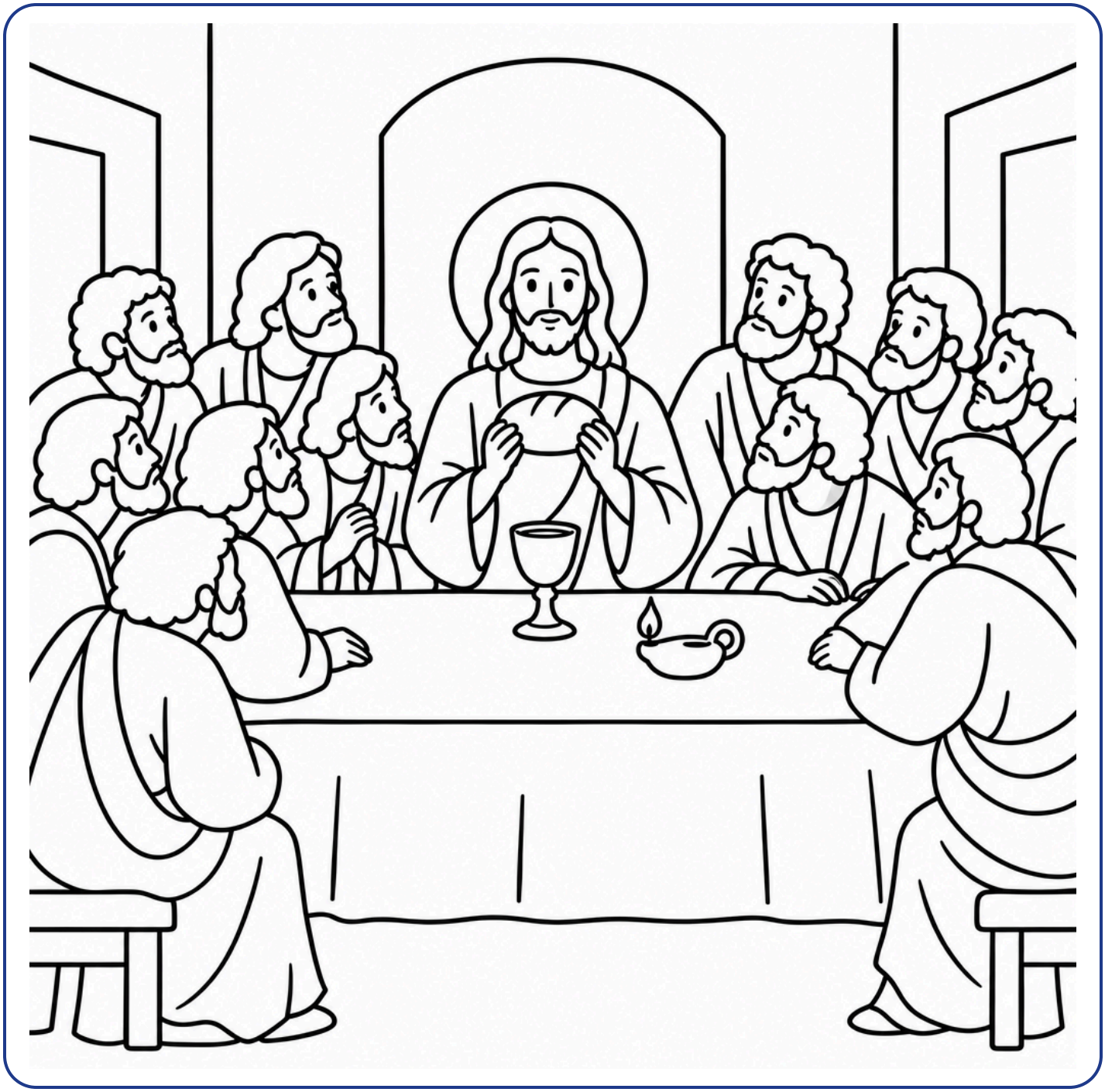
Name: _____

Holy Week | Coloring | Ages 4-8

The Last Supper

At his last meal, Jesus takes the bread and the wine and gives them to his apostles: it is the first Mass. Color the table of the Last Supper.

Name: _____



Holy Week | Matching | Ages 7-9

Match Each Day of Holy Week to Its Story

Match each day of Holy Week to what we celebrate on that day.

Name: _____

Palm Sunday ●	● Jesus dies on the cross.
Holy Thursday ●	● Jesus is risen: Alleluia!
Good Friday ●	● Jesus enters Jerusalem, welcomed by the crowd.
Holy Saturday ●	● Silence and waiting; at night, the Easter Vigil.
Easter Sunday ●	● Jesus' last meal and the washing of the feet.

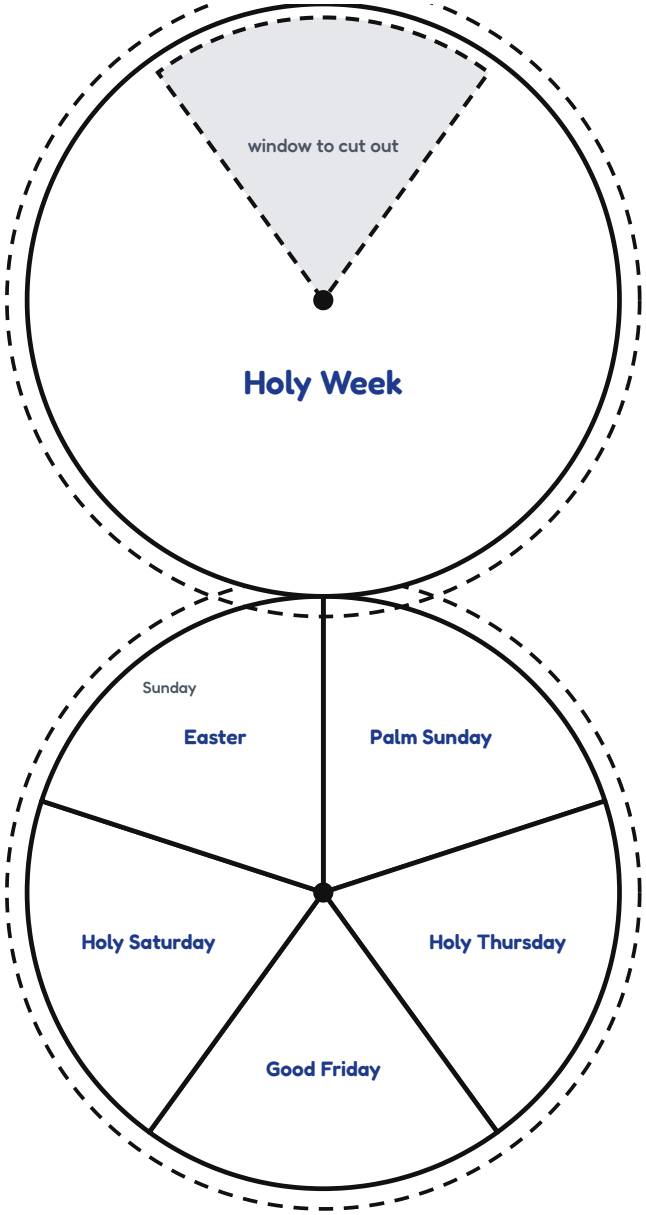
Answer Key: Palm Sunday: entry into Jerusalem · Holy Thursday: last meal · Good Friday: the cross · Holy Saturday: silence and vigil · Easter: Jesus is risen

Holy Week | Craft | Ages 7-12

The Holy Week Spinning Wheel

Color and cut out the two circles. Place the circle with the window on top of the other and join them in the center with a brass fastener. Turn it to follow Jesus day by day.

Name: _____



1 In each section, draw a symbol: a palm, bread, a cross, a tomb, a sun.

2 Cut out the two circles and the window (with a grown-up).

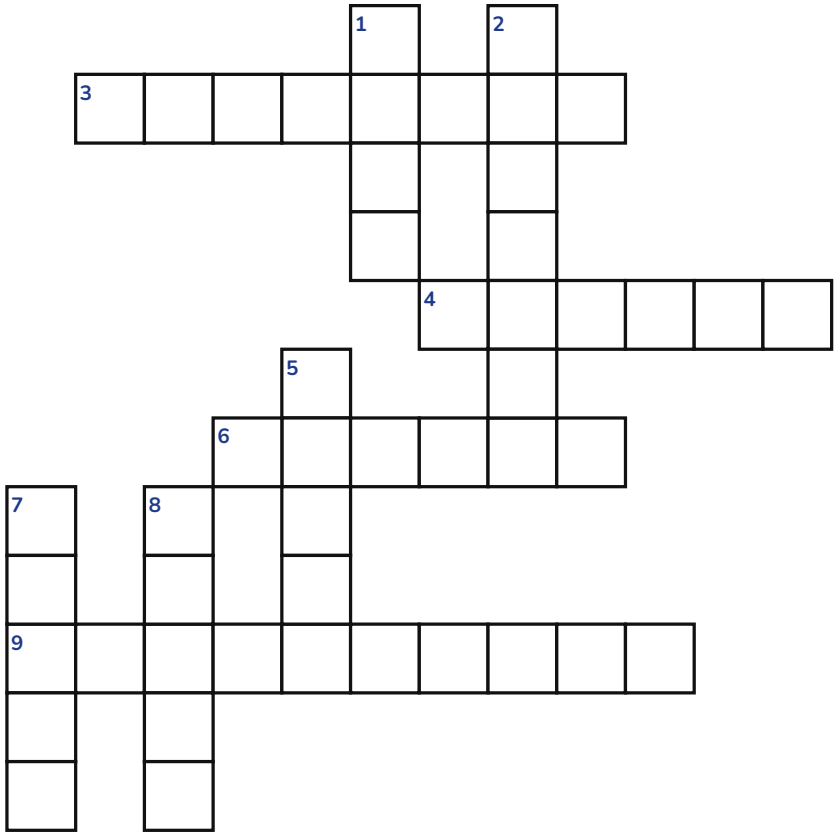
3 Join them in the center and turn!

Holy Week · Crossword · Ages 10-12

Holy Thursday, Good Friday, Holy Saturday

These three days lead us to Easter. Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

3. Hill where Jesus is crucified, also called Calvary.

4. Roman governor who condemns Jesus.

6. The Last … is Jesus' last meal with his apostles.

9. Garden where Jesus prays before he is arrested.

Down ↓

1. Joseph of Arimathea lays the body of Jesus there.

2. Cup in which Jesus shares the wine.

5. Apostle who betrays Jesus.

7. On Holy Saturday night, we celebrate the Easter …

8. Apostle who says three times that he does not know Jesus.

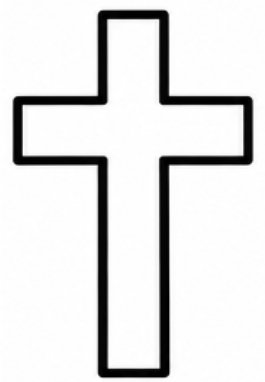
Answer Key: 3A GOLGOTHA · 4A PILATE · 6A SUPPER · 9A GETHSEMANE · 1D TOMB · 2D CHALICE · 5D JUDAS · 7D VIGIL · 8D PETER

Holy Week | Prayer | Ages 7-12

Praying Before the Cross on Good Friday

On Good Friday, we keep silent and look at the cross. Stand before a cross and pray quietly.

Name: _____



We adore you, O Christ, and we bless you.
Because by your holy cross you have redeemed the world.

Say this at the start of each station

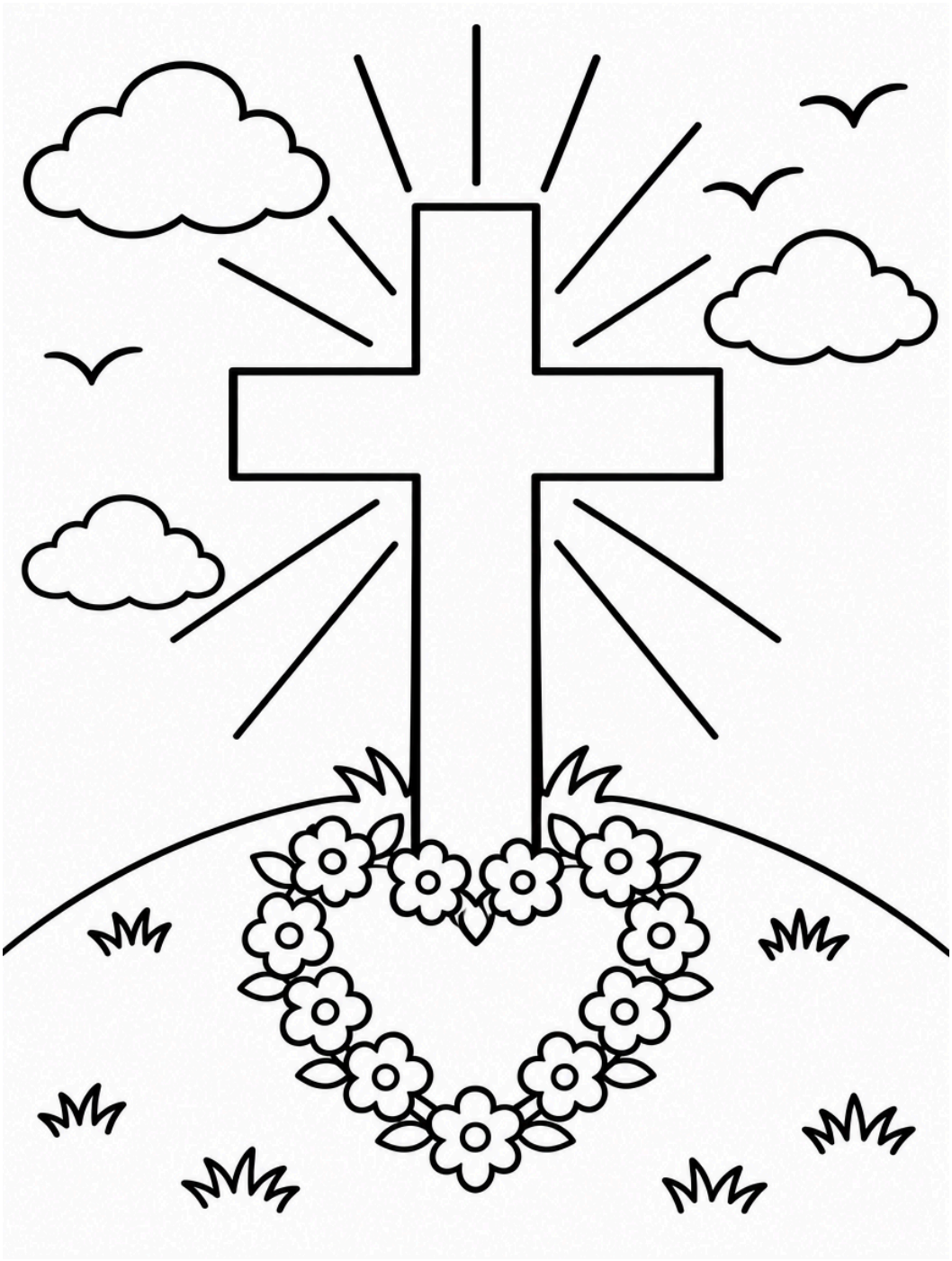
Lord Jesus,
you opened your arms on the cross
to welcome all people.
Thank you for loving me to the end.
I place in your hands those who suffer,
those who are sick or alone.
Help me to love as you love.
Amen.

Holy Week | Coloring | Ages 7-12

The Cross, Sign of Jesus' Love

On Good Friday, Jesus gave his life out of love for us. Color the cross and the flowers.

Name: _____



Holy Week | Game | Ages 7-9

Match Each Object to Its Story

Each object tells about a moment of Jesus' Passion. Match each object to its story.

Name: _____

The bread and the cup of wine ●	● The soldiers make fun of Jesus.
The towel and the basin ●	● Jesus washes the disciples' feet.
The thirty pieces of silver ●	● Jesus carries it to Golgotha.
The rooster ●	● What Judas is paid to betray Jesus.
The crown of thorns ●	● Jesus' last meal.
The cross ●	● It crows after Peter denies Jesus.

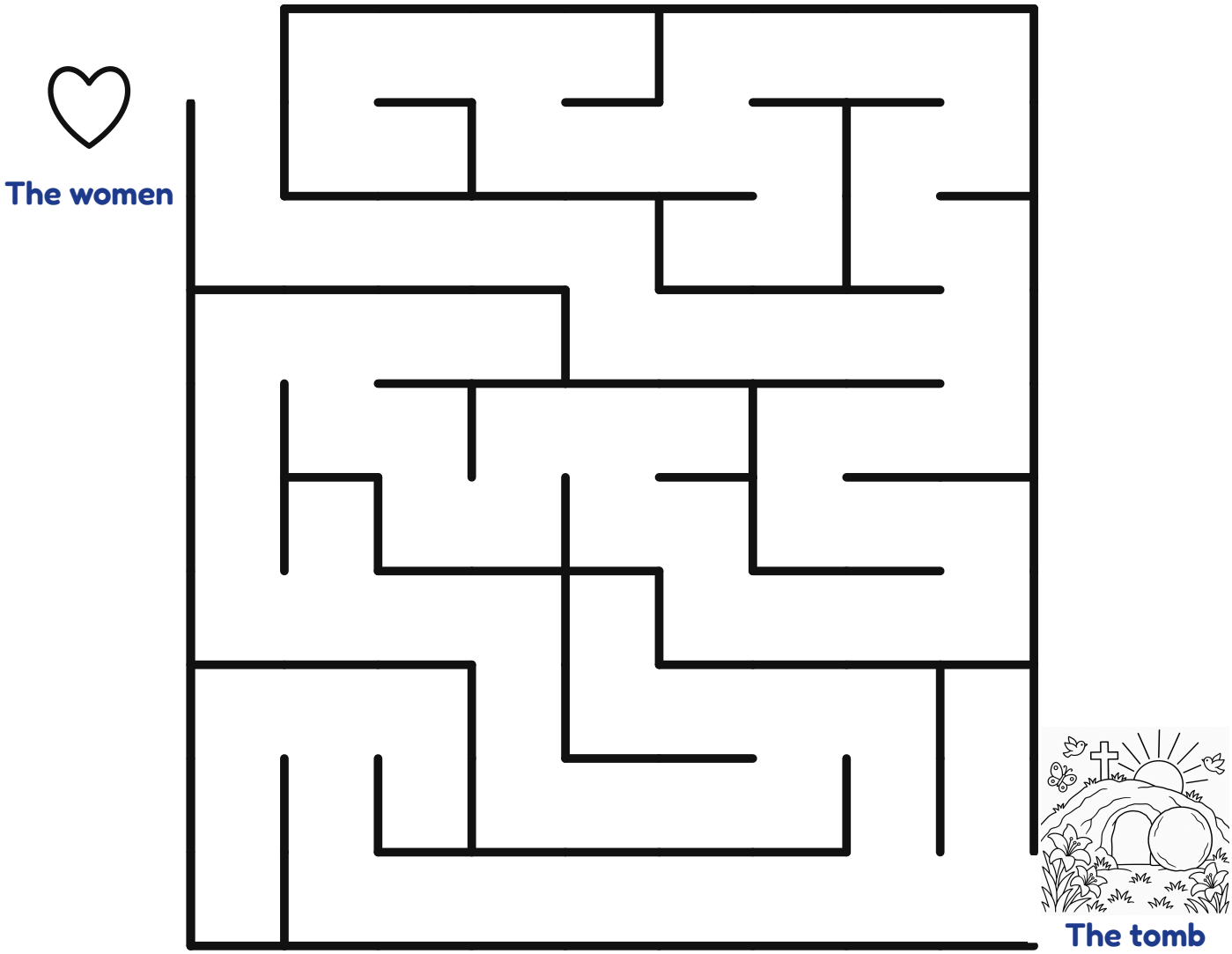
Answer Key: bread and wine: last meal · towel: washing of the feet · silver: Judas · rooster: Peter · crown: mocking · cross: Golgotha

Holy Week | Maze | Ages 4-8

The Holy Women Go to the Tomb

At sunrise, the holy women go to the tomb with spices. Trace their path: a surprise is waiting for them!

Name: _____

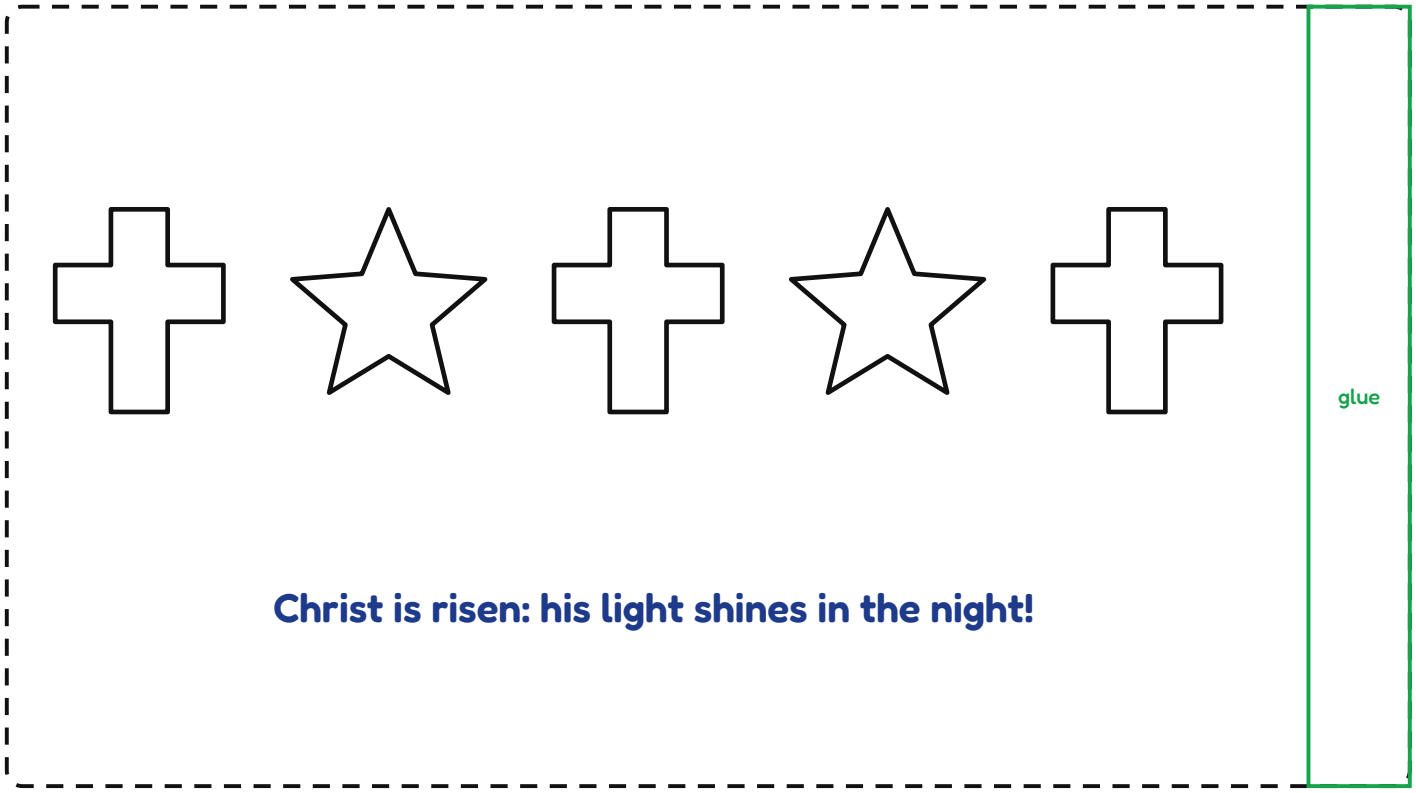


Holy Week | Craft | Ages 10-12

The Easter Vigil: Light in the Night

The Easter Vigil begins in the dark, then the light of the Paschal candle spreads. Make your own candle holder for the Vigil.

Name: _____



Cut out the crosses and stars with an adult's help.

1 Color the strip with bright colors.

2 Cut out the strip, then the crosses and stars with a grown-up.

3 Roll the strip, glue the tab, and put a battery-operated tea light inside.

Easter | Coloring | Ages 4-8

The Tomb Is Empty!

On Easter morning, the women find the stone rolled away and the tomb empty. Color the scene, then trace over the gray word.

Name: _____

"He is not here, but he has been raised."

Luke 24:6

Easter | Coloring | Ages 4-8

The Risen Jesus Appears to Mary Magdalene

Mary Magdalene is crying near the tomb. Someone calls her by name: it is Jesus, alive! Color their meeting.

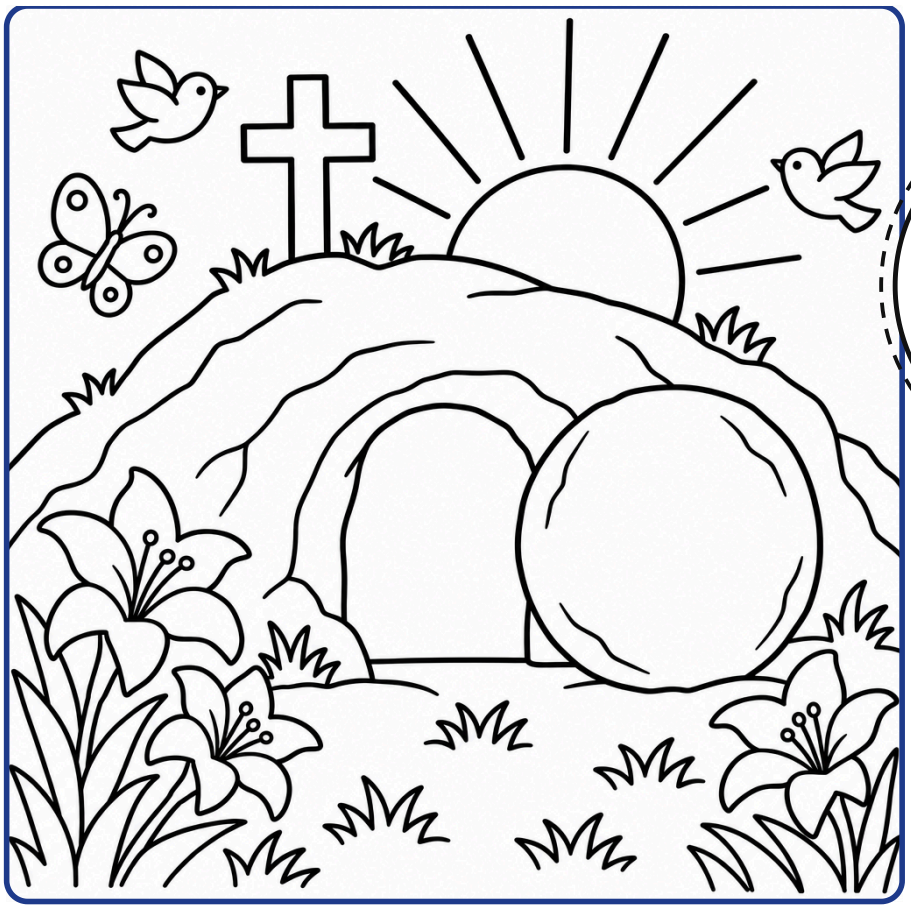
Name: _____

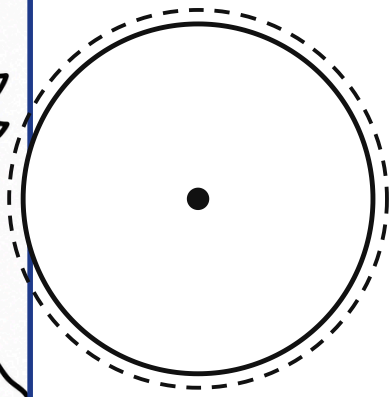
Easter | Cut-Out | Ages 4-12

The Easter Garden to Cut Out

Color the garden. Cut out the stone and attach it in front of the tomb with a brass fastener: roll it away to find the empty tomb! Draw the characters in the small boxes.

Name: _____





the stone

The women

The angel

Peter

John

1 Color the garden and draw the characters.

2 Cut out the stone and the four cards.

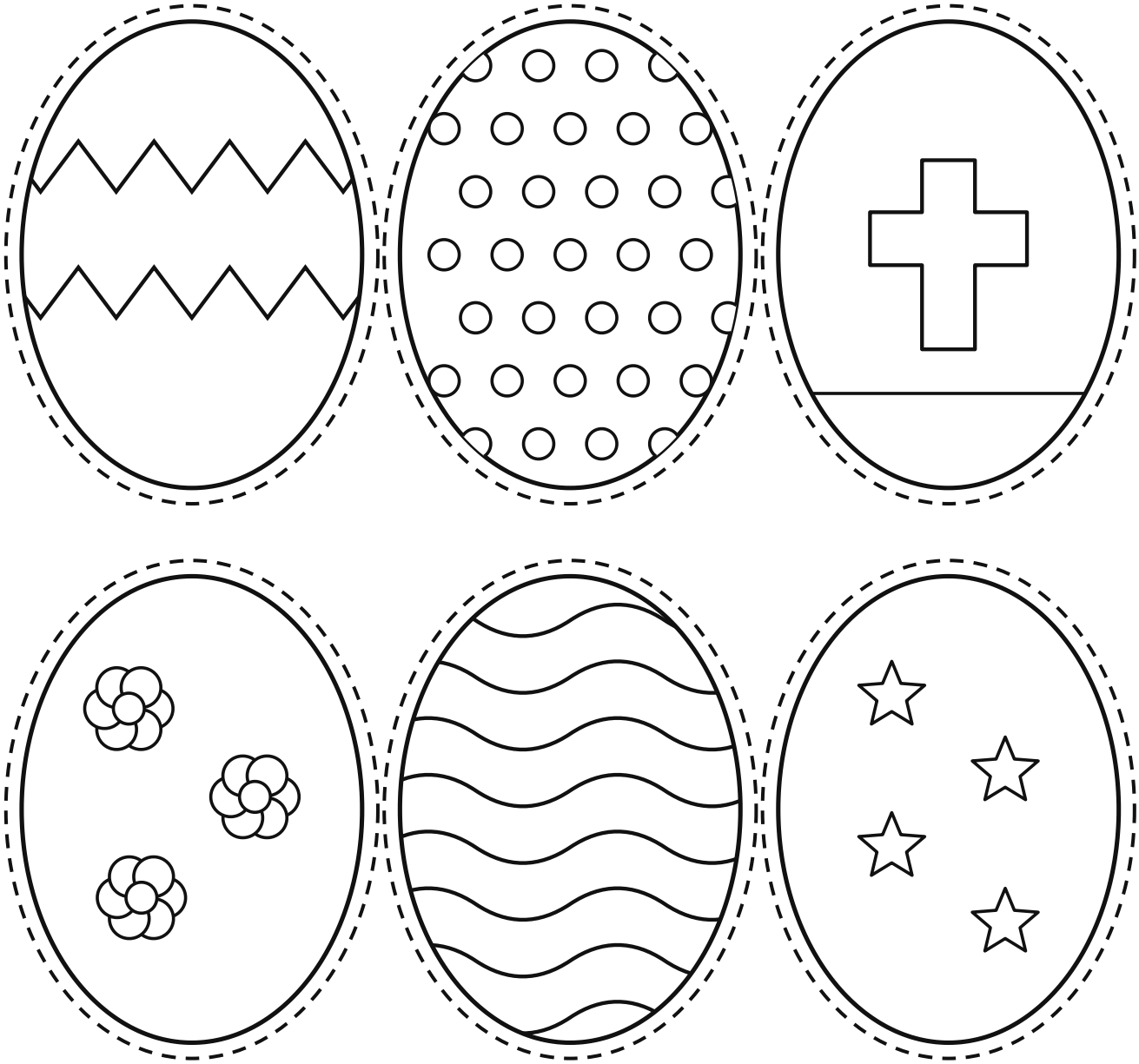
3 Attach the stone in front of the tomb and tell the story.

Easter | Craft | Ages 4-8

Easter Eggs to Decorate

An egg, with new life inside, reminds us of Jesus coming out of the tomb alive. Color each egg with bright colors, then cut them out to decorate your Easter table.

Name: _____



Tip: glue the eggs onto cardstock and punch a hole at the top to hang them on a branch.

Easter · Bingo · Ages 4-8

Easter Bingo

Each player takes a card. The leader reads a word: if you have it, cover it with a marker. The first one to fill a card shouts "Alleluia!"

Name: _____

Card 1		
candle	egg	John
stone	angel	cross
Mary Magdalene	light	Jesus

Card 2		
Jesus	Alleluia	lamb
light	cross	sun
lily	angel	stone

Card 3		
lamb	Alleluia	tomb
egg	cross	lily
Peter	garden	Jesus

Card 4		
tomb	lamb	garden
Jesus	egg	Peter
angel	sun	candle

Words to call: Jesus · cross · tomb · stone · angel · light · candle · Alleluia · egg · lily · sun · garden · Mary Magdalene · Peter · John · lamb

Easter | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Alleluia! Easter Words

Find the 12 Easter words in the grid.

Name: _____

G	N	W	P	J	O	Y	M	T	I	W	D
S	G	O	M	A	L	L	E	L	U	I	A
H	E	A	S	T	E	R	H	B	O	M	M
M	G	W	N	T	L	F	S	T	O	N	E
O	U	C	L	R	I	F	I	Y	A	T	K
R	G	A	G	R	F	A	V	C	N	Y	T
N	U	N	S	W	E	B	L	I	G	H	T
I	T	D	K	S	G	A	R	D	E	N	G
N	O	L	V	M	R	B	F	I	L	K	W
G	M	E	V	L	L	D	W	V	T	C	I
I	B	U	M	R	I	S	E	N	M	S	L
U	I	A	Y	E	P	T	F	Y	S	B	G

- ☐ Alleluia
- ☐ Easter
- ☐ risen
- ☐ tomb
- ☐ stone
- ☐ light
- ☐ candle
- ☐ life
- ☐ joy
- ☐ morning
- ☐ angel
- ☐ garden

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Easter · Riddles · Ages 7-9

Easter Riddles

Read each riddle and write the answer.

Name: _____

1. I am very heavy. I was rolled in front of the tomb, but on Easter morning I had already been rolled away! What am I?

   _____

2. I wear dazzling white clothes. I told the women: "He is not here." Who am I?

   _____

3. I ran to the tomb with Peter, and I got there first. Who am I?

   _____

4. I am the big candle lit during the Easter Vigil. What am I?

   _____

5. I am the word of joy we sing again at Easter. What am I?

   _____

6. Jesus is alive! How do we say he came back from death?

   _____

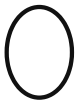
Answer Key: 1 the stone · 2 the angel · 3 John · 4 the Paschal candle · 5 Alleluia · 6 he is risen

Easter Game Ages 7-12

The Easter Egg Hunt With Questions

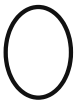
Cut out the 12 question eggs and hide them around the house or the yard. For each egg you find, read the question and answer it to win a point (or a piece of chocolate!).

Name: _____



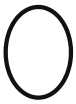
1

On what day does Jesus rise?



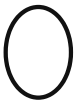
2

Who finds the empty tomb first?



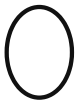
3

What does the angel say to the women?



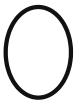
4

Which apostle wants to touch Jesus' wounds?



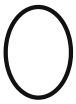
5

How many days does Easter Time last?



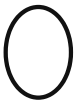
6

What color does the priest wear at Easter?



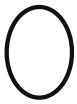
7

Which animal is a symbol of Jesus at Easter?



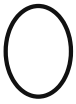
8

Toward which village do the two disciples walk?



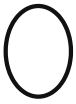
9

What does Jesus do so they recognize him at Emmaus?



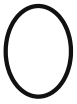
10

Which big candle do we light?



11

Which feast comes 50 days after Easter?



12

What do we sing again at Easter?

Answer Key: 1 Sunday · 2 the women · 3 He is not here, but he has been raised · 4 Thomas · 5 50 days · 6 white · 7 the lamb · 8 Emmaus · 9 he breaks the bread · 10 the Paschal candle · 11 Pentecost · 12 Alleluia

Easter Prayer Ages 4-12

My Easter Morning Prayer

On Easter morning, when you wake up, say this joyful prayer. You can sing it to any tune you like!

Name: _____

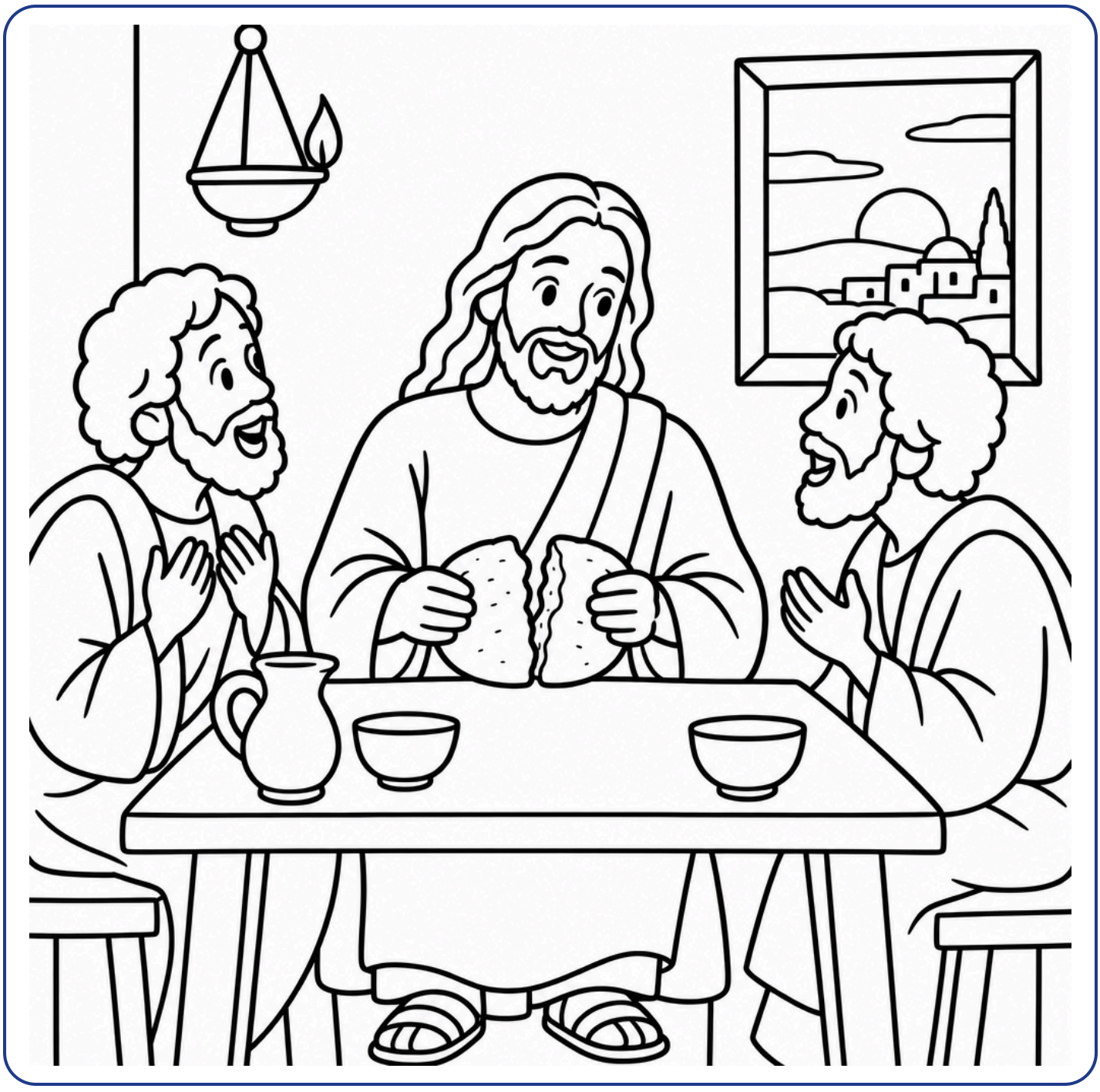
Alleluia! Jesus is alive!
The stone is rolled away, the tomb is empty.
Thank you, Lord, for this happy morning.
Let your light shine in my home,
at my school, and in my heart.
Help me bring your joy to everyone I meet.
Alleluia! Amen.

Easter | Coloring | Ages 7-9

The Disciples on the Road to Emmaus

Two disciples walk toward Emmaus with a stranger. In the evening, he breaks the bread: their eyes are opened: it is Jesus! Color the scene.

Name: _____

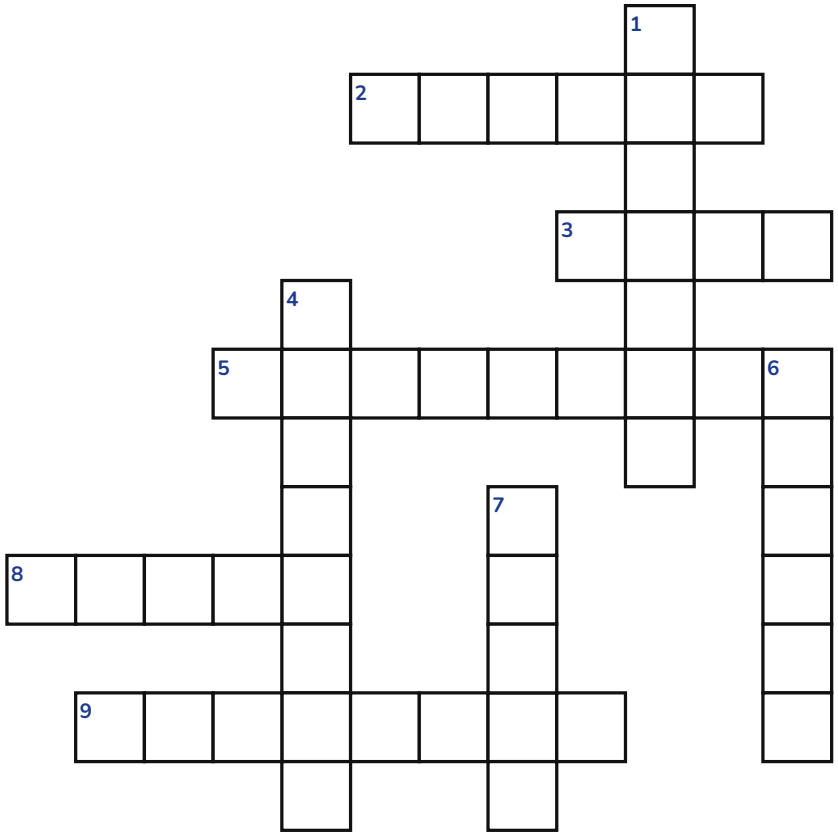


Easter · Crossword · Ages 10-12

The Appearances of the Risen Jesus

After his Resurrection, Jesus appears several times to his friends. Fill in the grid.

Name: _____



Across →

2. Apostle who wants to see and touch in order to believe.

3. Thanks to Jesus, the net is full of ...

5. Mary ... is the first to see the risen Jesus.

8. Jesus says to the apostles: "... be with you."

9. Sea where Jesus appears to the disciples who are fishing.

Down ↓

1. Region where Jesus tells his disciples to meet him.

4. At first she thinks Jesus is the ...

6. Village toward which two disciples are walking.

7. At Emmaus, they recognize Jesus when he breaks the ...

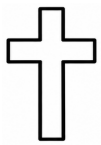
Answer Key: 2A THOMAS · 3A FISH · 5A MAGDALENE · 8A PEACE · 9A TIBERIAS · 1D GALILEE · 4D GARDENER · 6D EMMAUS · 7D BREAD

Easter Matching Ages 4-6

Match the Easter Symbols

Match each Easter symbol to what it means.

Name: _____



- Jesus is the Lamb of God.
- Jesus is alive: the tomb is empty!
- Jesus is the light of the world.
- Jesus gave his life out of love.

Answer Key: candle: the light · cross: he gave his life · lamb: the Lamb of God · tomb: Jesus is alive

Easter · Game · Ages 10-12

Thomas, the Apostle Who Wanted to See: True or False

Read the story of Thomas (John 20:19-29) and check "True" or "False."

Name: _____

1. Thomas is one of the Twelve Apostles. — True / False
2. Thomas is with the others when Jesus comes the first time. — True / False
3. Thomas says he will not believe unless he sees and touches the marks of the nails. — True / False
4. Jesus comes back a week later. — True / False
5. Jesus gets angry with Thomas and goes away. — True / False
6. Jesus invites Thomas to touch his hands and his side. — True / False
7. Thomas says: "My Lord and my God!" — True / False
8. Jesus says: "Blessed are those who have not seen and have believed." — True / False

And you? You have not seen Jesus, but you can believe in him: Jesus is talking about you when he says "blessed"!

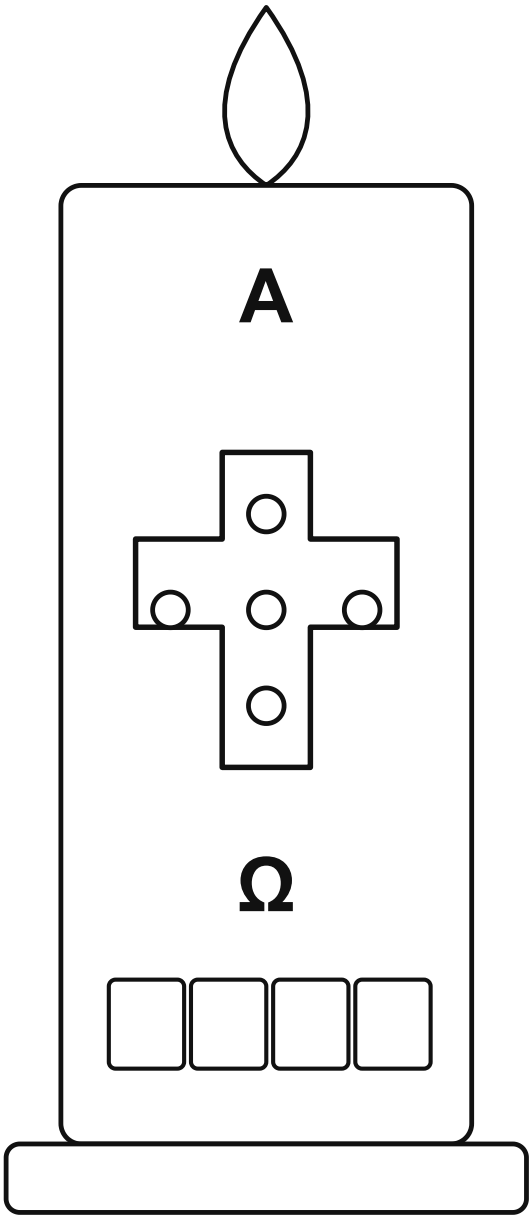
Answer Key: 1 true · 2 false · 3 true · 4 true · 5 false · 6 true · 7 true · 8 true

Easter Craft Ages 7-12

The Paschal Candle to Decorate

Decorate your Paschal candle like the one in your church: color the cross, the five grains of incense (the five wounds of Jesus), the Alpha (A, the beginning), and the Omega (Ω, the end). Write the year in the four boxes.

Name: _____



The Paschal candle is lit at the Easter Vigil: it reminds us that the risen Jesus is our light.

Ascension | Coloring | Ages 4-8

Jesus Ascends Into Heaven

Forty days after Easter, Jesus ascends into heaven as his apostles watch. He promises to stay with them forever. Color the scene.

Name: _____

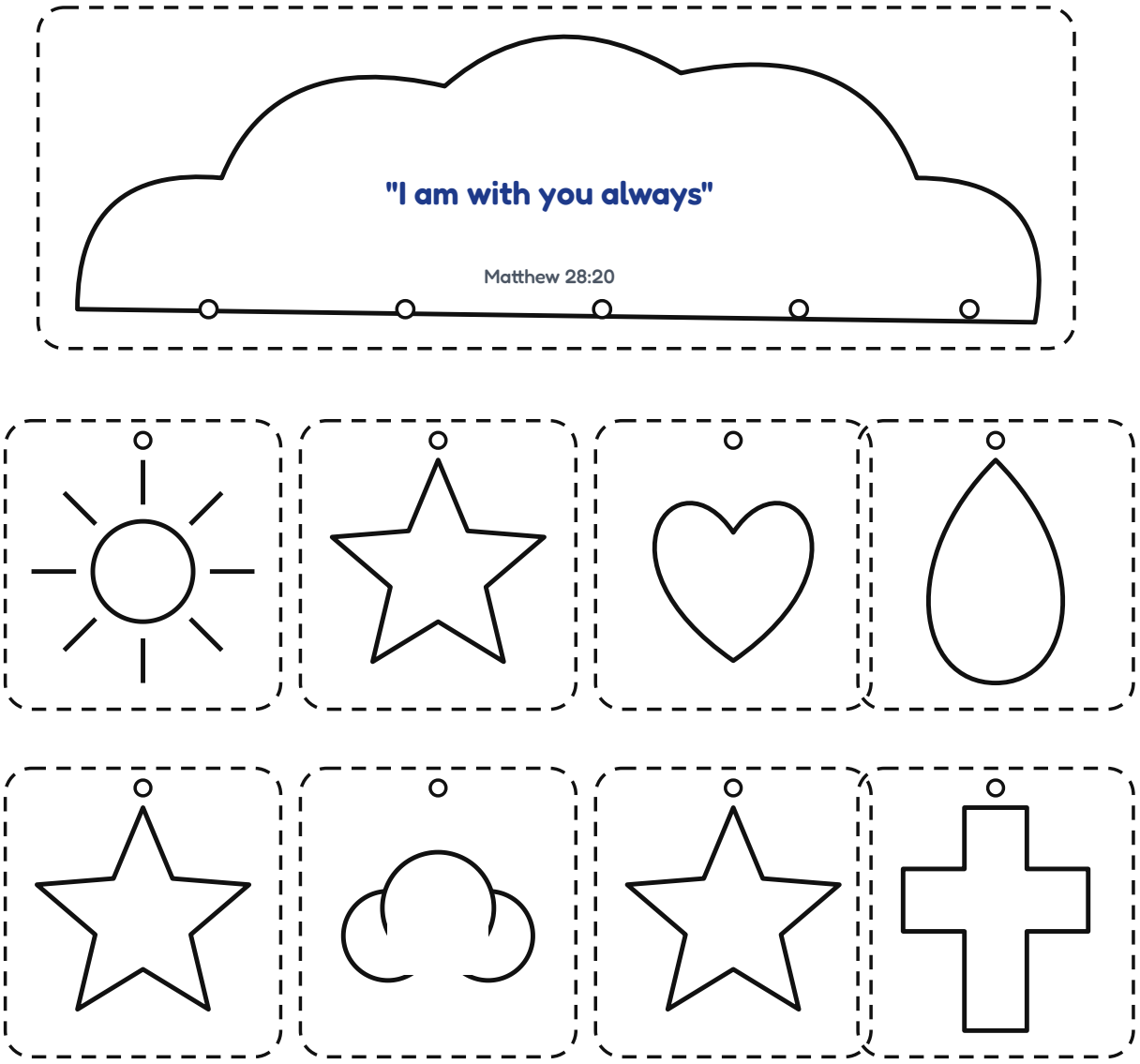
"And behold, I am with you always, until the end of the age."
Matthew 28:20

Ascension | Craft | Ages 7-12

The Ascension Mobile

Color and cut out the cloud and the eight small pieces. Hang them under the cloud with strings of different lengths: your mobile reminds you that Jesus is always with you.

Name: _____



1 Color all the pieces.

2 Cut them out and ask a grown-up to punch the little holes.

3 Tie each piece to the cloud with a string.

Ascension | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Ascension Words

Find the 12 Ascension words in the grid.

Name: _____

M	H	T	W	W	M	L	C	L	O	U	D
L	D	T	P	S	M	S	N	U	T	L	W
A	G	G	T	O	H	E	A	V	E	N	W
P	A	S	C	E	N	D	G	U	F	B	E
O	U	M	I	S	S	I	O	N	S	Y	G
S	C	B	L	E	S	S	P	B	P	F	K
T	C	D	A	S	C	E	N	S	I	O	N
L	N	D	A	Y	S	P	W	R	R	R	Y
E	U	F	V	E	K	W	P	R	I	T	A
S	K	C	I	R	N	L	F	H	T	Y	N
S	W	I	T	N	E	S	S	E	S	W	T
P	R	O	M	I	S	E	D	D	I	Y	T

- ☐ Ascension
- ☐ heaven
- ☐ cloud
- ☐ ascend
- ☐ apostles
- ☐ bless
- ☐ forty
- ☐ days
- ☐ mission
- ☐ witnesses
- ☐ promise
- ☐ Spirit

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Ascension · Game · Ages 7-12

Forty Days After Easter: True or False?

Check "True" or "False." You can read the beginning of the Acts of the Apostles (Acts 1:1-11).

Name: _____

1. The Ascension comes forty days after Easter. True False

2. In most dioceses of the United States, the Ascension is celebrated on the following Sunday. True False

3. Jesus ascends into heaven in front of his apostles. True False

4. A cloud hides Jesus from their sight. True False

5. Jesus promises to send the Holy Spirit. True False

6. After the Ascension, Jesus leaves us all alone. True False

7. Two men dressed in white speak to the apostles. True False

8. The apostles are to be Jesus' witnesses to the ends of the earth. True False

Answer Key: 1 true · 2 true · 3 true · 4 true · 5 true · 6 false · 7 true · 8 true

Ascension Prayer Ages 7-12

"I Am With You Always"

Before he ascends into heaven, Jesus makes a promise to his friends. It is for you too.

Name: _____

> **"And behold, I am with you always, until the end of the age."**
>
> Matthew 28:20

What This Means

Jesus does not go far away from us: he is with his Father, and he stays with us in a new way, through the Holy Spirit, through his Word, at Mass, and when we love one another.

My Prayer

Lord Jesus, you ascended into heaven,
but you stay with me every day.
When I am afraid, I remember your promise.
Make me your witness at school, at home, and everywhere.
Amen.

Your Turn!

Write one place where you can be a witness for Jesus this week: .....

Pentecost | Coloring | Ages 4-8

The Holy Spirit Comes Down on the Apostles

On the day of Pentecost, the apostles are gathered with Mary. A strong wind blows and tongues of fire rest on them: it is the Holy Spirit! Color the scene.

Name: _____

Pentecost Craft Ages 4-12

The Pentecost Dove to Hang

The dove is a symbol of the Holy Spirit. Color it white and gold, cut it out, and hang it near your window.

Name: _____

1 Color the dove and add little flames around it.

2 Cut along the frame, then around the bird.

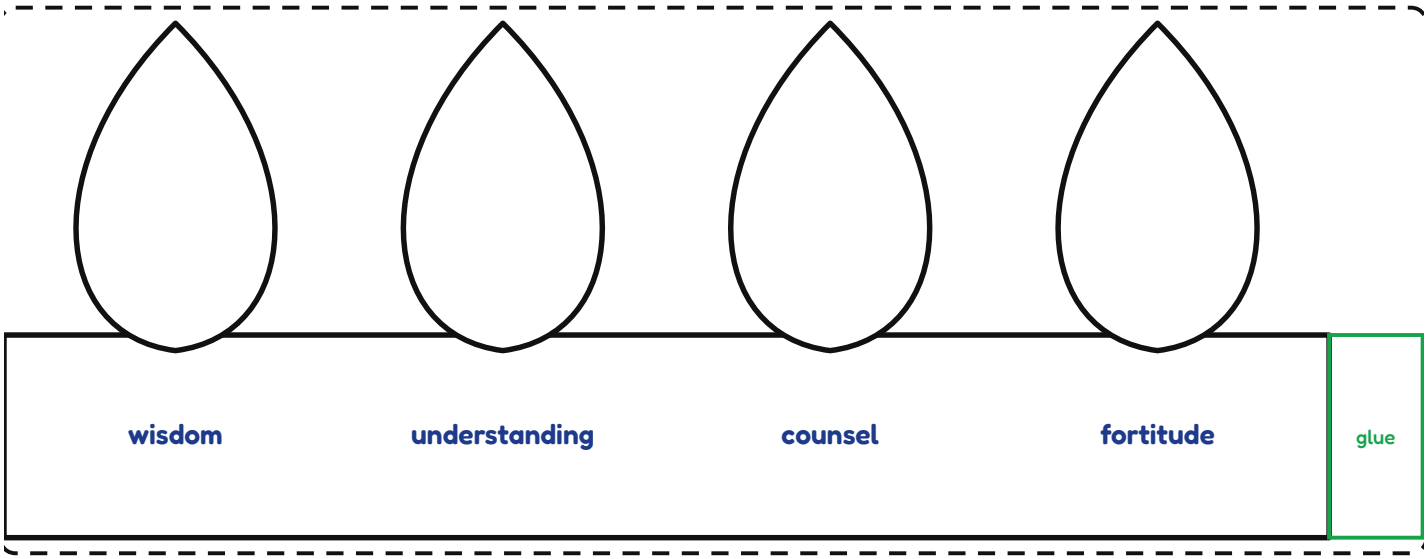
3 Punch a small hole and thread a string through it to hang it.

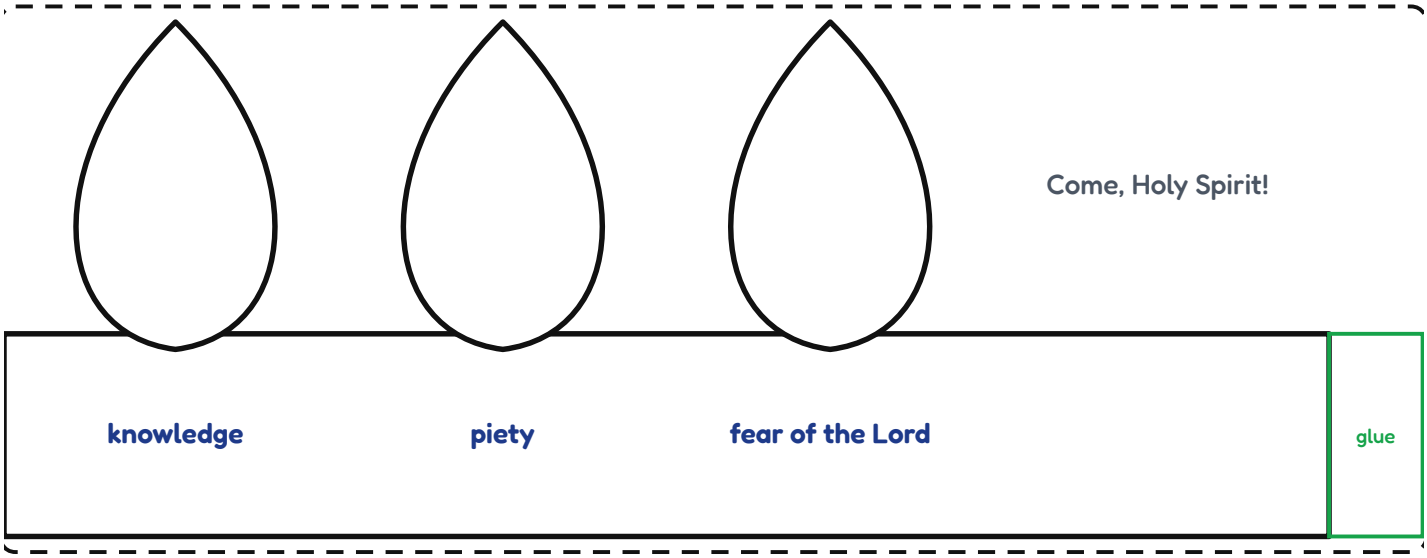
Pentecost Craft Ages 7-12

The Crown of the Seven Gifts

The seven gifts of the Holy Spirit are like seven flames. Color each flame, cut out the two strips, and glue them together to make a crown.

Name: _____





1 Color the seven flames yellow, orange, and red.

2 Cut out the two strips.

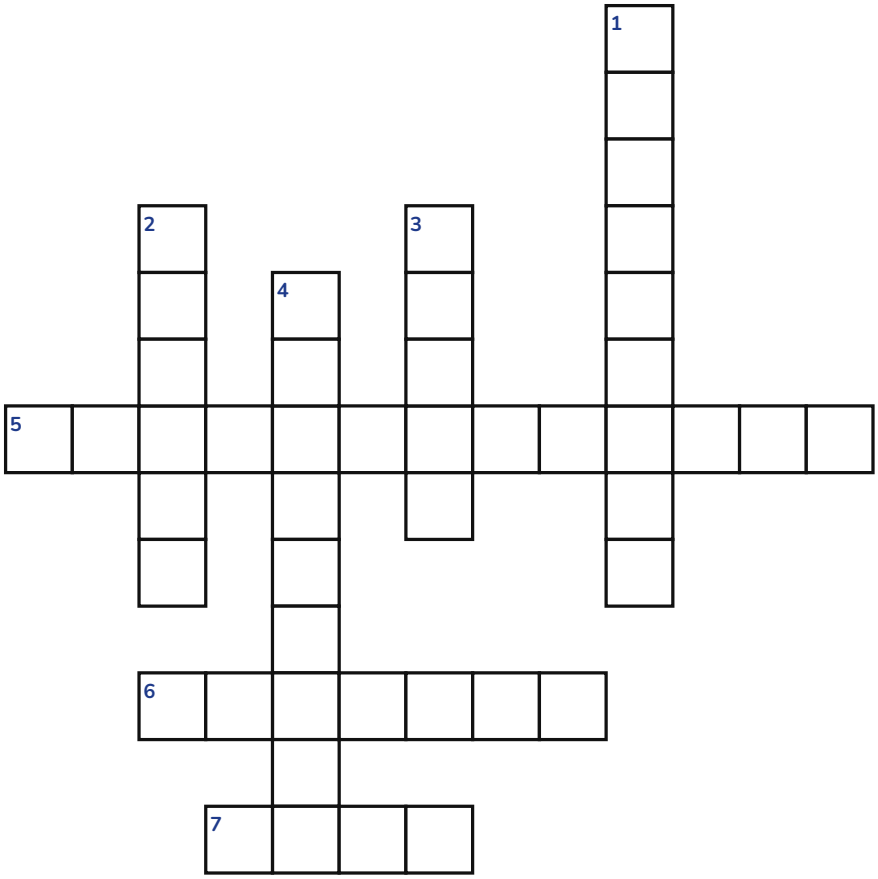
3 Glue them end to end and close the crown to fit your head.

Pentecost · Crossword · Ages 10-12

The Seven Gifts of the Holy Spirit

The seven gifts of the Holy Spirit help us live as children of God. Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

5. It helps us understand God's Word better.

6. It helps us make good choices.

7. ... of the Lord: deep respect and love that never wants to offend God.

Down ↓

1. It helps us see God in the beauty of creation.

2. It helps us see everything the way God sees it.

3. It helps us pray to God with trust, as our Father.

4. It gives us the courage to do good, even when it is hard.

Answer Key: 5A UNDERSTANDING · 6A COUNSEL · 7A FEAR · 1D KNOWLEDGE · 2D WISDOM · 3D PIETY · 4D FORTITUDE

Pentecost | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Pentecost Words

Find the 12 Pentecost words in the grid.

Name: _____

M	R	M	L	A	A	L	T	D	O	V	E
A	R	O	G	H	W	S	P	I	R	I	T
C	F	I	F	T	Y	R	M	Y	F	M	W
A	W	G	I	F	T	S	P	N	P	M	O
F	I	O	A	E	C	M	H	D	S	L	F
I	N	P	E	N	T	E	C	O	S	T	P
N	D	P	F	N	F	B	H	L	W	K	C
M	N	O	T	O	N	G	U	E	S	H	H
A	W	S	H	S	I	C	U	M	K	R	U
R	Y	M	H	O	L	Y	B	G	N	L	R
Y	Y	A	P	O	S	T	L	E	S	G	C
I	U	F	I	R	E	C	Y	K	K	L	H

- ☐ Pentecost
- ☐ Spirit
- ☐ holy
- ☐ fire
- ☐ wind
- ☐ dove
- ☐ tongues
- ☐ apostles
- ☐ Mary
- ☐ Church
- ☐ fifty
- ☐ gifts

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Pentecost · Game · Ages 7-9

Wind, Fire, Dove: The Symbols of the Holy Spirit

The Bible and the Church use pictures to speak about the Holy Spirit. Match each symbol to its sentence.

Name: _____

The wind	It comes down on Jesus at his baptism.
The fire	You cannot see it, but you can feel its strength.
The dove	It marks the forehead of those being confirmed.
The water	It gives new life at Baptism.
The oil (sacred chrism)	It warms, gives light, and spreads without going out.

Answer Key: wind: its strength · fire: it warms and gives light · dove: Jesus' baptism · water: new life of Baptism · oil: Confirmation

Pentecost Prayer Ages 7-12

Come, Holy Spirit!

Each morning in the days before Pentecost, call on the Holy Spirit with this prayer.

Name: _____

Come, Holy Spirit!
Blow on me like the wind,
warm my heart like fire,
give me peace like the dove.
Make me brave to speak about Jesus,
gentle with others,
and joyful in all I do.
Amen.

Pentecost · Bingo · Ages 7-12

Fruits of the Holy Spirit Bingo

The Church names twelve fruits of the Holy Spirit: what grows in our lives when we let him work in us (CCC 1832). Play bingo with your friends.

Name: _____

Card 1		
joy	gentleness	charity
generosity	goodness	faithfulness
self-control	kindness	patience

Card 2		
kindness	self-control	patience
gentleness	joy	chastity
faithfulness	goodness	generosity

Card 3		
faithfulness	peace	generosity
charity	modesty	kindness
chastity	self-control	gentleness

Card 4		
kindness	patience	joy
charity	gentleness	modesty
goodness	peace	faithfulness

Words to call: charity · joy · peace · patience · kindness · goodness · generosity · gentleness · faithfulness · modesty · self-control · chastity

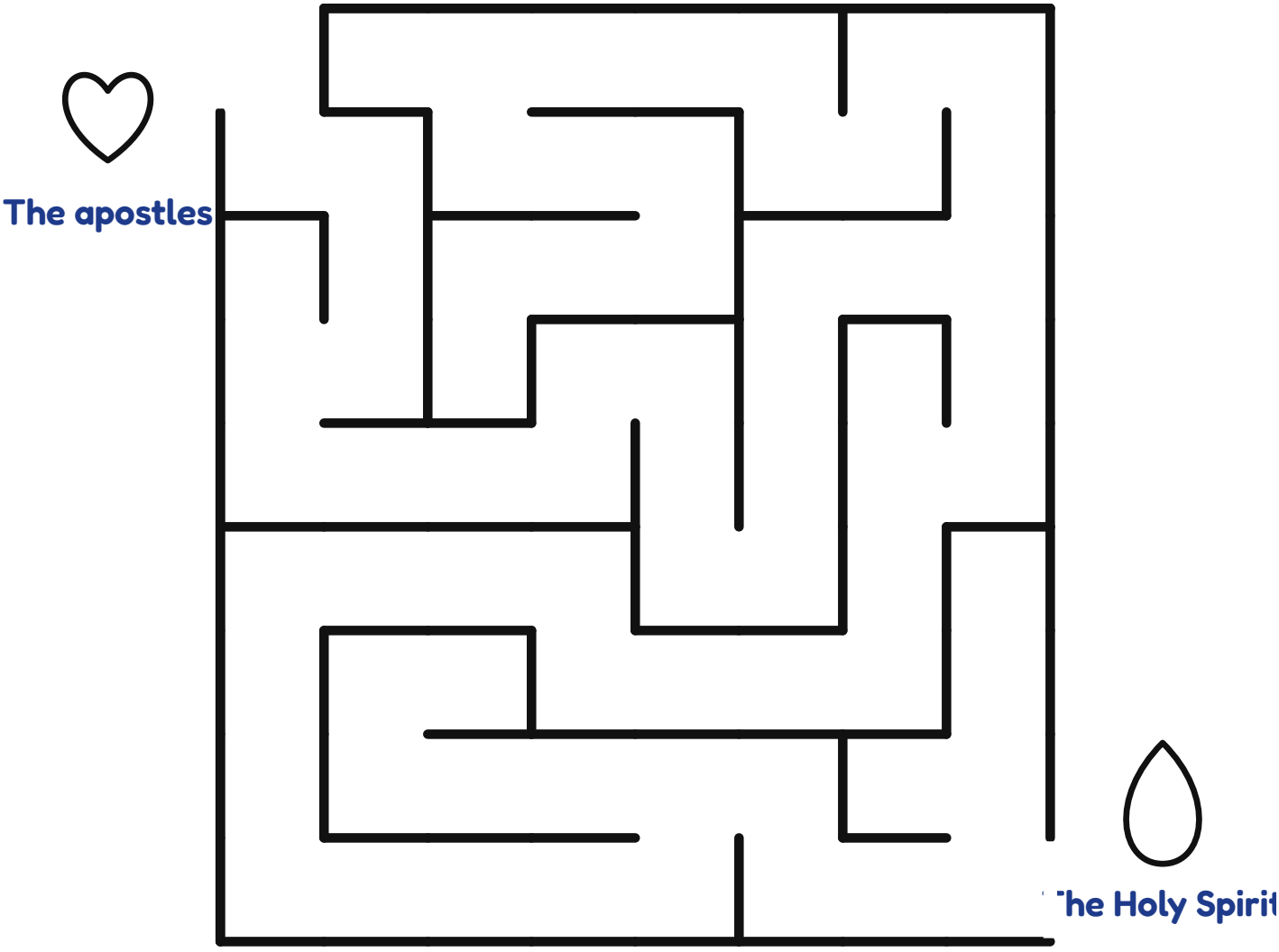
For younger kids: generosity means giving gladly; self-control means saying no to what is wrong; modesty means not showing off.

Pentecost | Maze | Ages 4-6

Follow the Flames of Pentecost

The apostles are waiting for the Holy Spirit, whom Jesus promised. Trace the path to the flame, then color the flame red and yellow.

Name: _____



Corpus Christi | Coloring | Ages 7-12

The Corpus Christi Monstrance

On the feast of Corpus Christi, the priest carries the consecrated Host in the monstrance, and everyone follows in procession: Jesus is truly present! Color the monstrance gold.

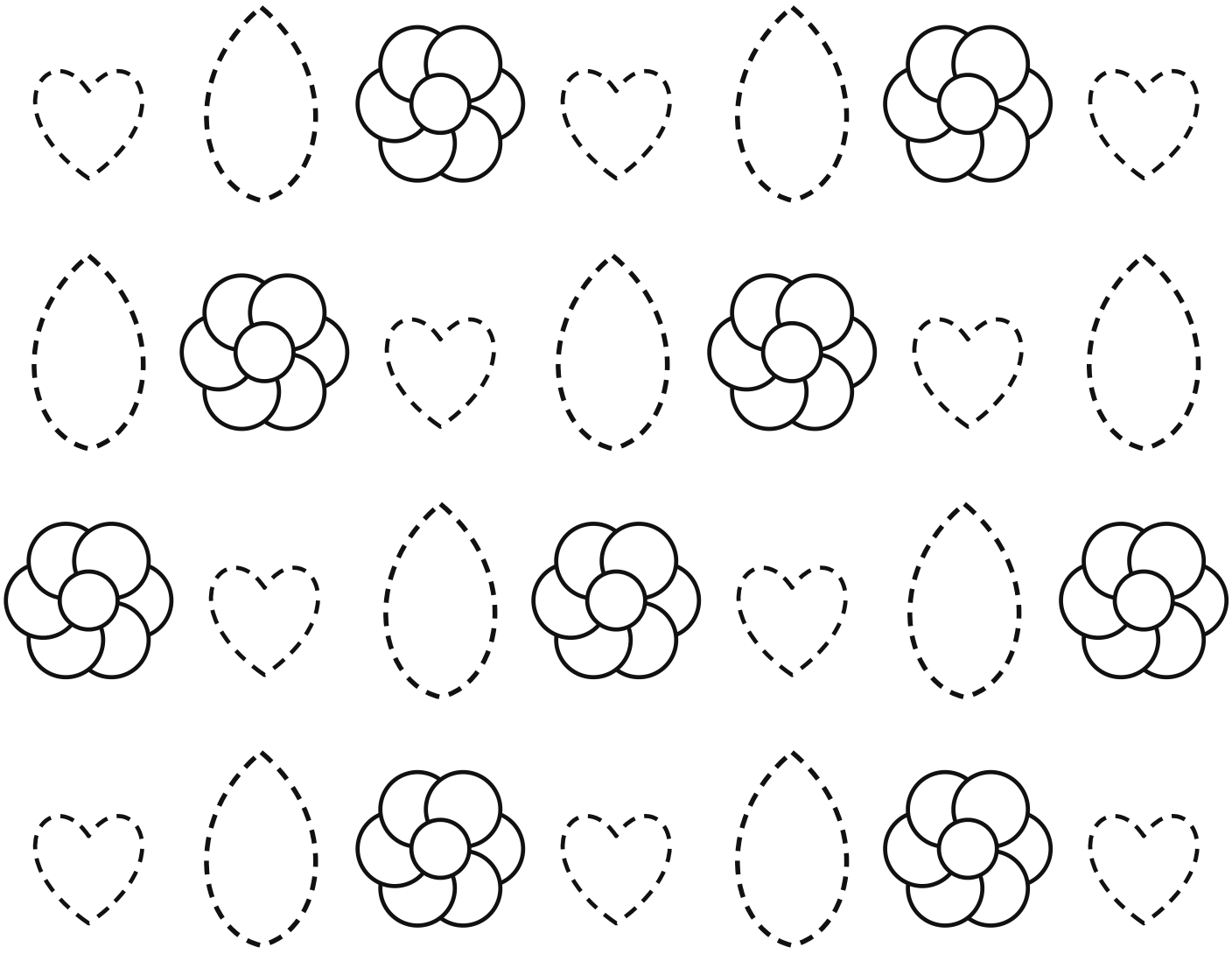
Name: _____

Corpus Christi | Craft | Ages 4-12

Petals for the Procession

In some Corpus Christi processions, children scatter flower petals in front of the Blessed Sacrament to honor Jesus. Color the paper petals in every color and cut them out.

Name: _____



Keep your petals in a small basket. On the day of the procession, scatter them gently in front of the monstrance, without running and in silence.

Corpus Christi | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Eucharist Words

Find the 12 words of the Eucharist in the grid.

Name: _____

F	C	O	M	M	U	N	I	O	N	U	A	M
R	F	F	P	R	I	E	S	T	A	L	N	O
V	R	H	P	P	V	D	H	O	S	T	K	N
E	L	D	M	R	Y	F	D	P	P	G	I	S
U	C	A	D	O	R	A	T	I	O	N	E	T
C	H	Y	U	C	H	O	R	P	E	B	F	R
H	A	F	C	E	V	G	T	I	P	B	V	A
A	L	M	O	S	Y	O	K	E	R	R	B	N
R	I	A	I	S	K	P	S	C	K	E	G	C
I	C	S	W	I	N	E	A	H	D	A	C	E
S	E	S	I	O	S	E	Y	R	M	D	A	W
T	A	V	P	N	I	L	D	M	G	W	F	R
K	P	O	E	W	R	L	A	L	T	A	R	P

- ☐ Eucharist
- ☐ Host
- ☐ chalice
- ☐ bread
- ☐ wine
- ☐ altar
- ☐ Mass
- ☐ Communion
- ☐ priest
- ☐ monstrance
- ☐ procession
- ☐ adoration

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Corpus Christi | Prayer | Ages 7-12

My Prayer Before the Blessed Sacrament

When you pass in front of the tabernacle or look at the monstrance, you can genuflect and say this prayer.

Name: _____

Lord Jesus,
you are here, hidden in the Host,
truly present, as you were with your apostles.
I adore you and I thank you
for staying with us every day.
When I receive you at Mass,
make your love grow in me.
Amen.

Corpus Christi · Riddles · Ages 7-12

The Bread and the Wine: Who Am I?

These objects are used at Mass or at Adoration. Read each riddle and write the name of the object.

Name: _____

1. I am a very thin, round bread. After the consecration, I am the Body of Christ. What am I?

   _____

2. I am a precious cup. The priest pours the wine into me for Mass. What am I?

   _____

3. I am the big table of stone or wood where the priest celebrates Mass. What am I?

   _____

4. I am a vessel with a lid where the consecrated Hosts are kept. What am I?

   _____

5. I am a small locked cabinet with the sanctuary lamp burning beside me. What am I?

   _____

6. I look like a golden sun: I am carried in procession with the Host in my center. What am I?

   _____

Answer Key: 1 the Host · 2 the chalice · 3 the altar · 4 the ciborium · 5 the tabernacle · 6 the monstrance

Assumption (August 15) Coloring Ages 4-8

Mary Is Taken Up Into Heaven

At the end of her life on earth, Mary is taken up into heaven, body and soul. The angels go with her. Color Mary in white and blue.

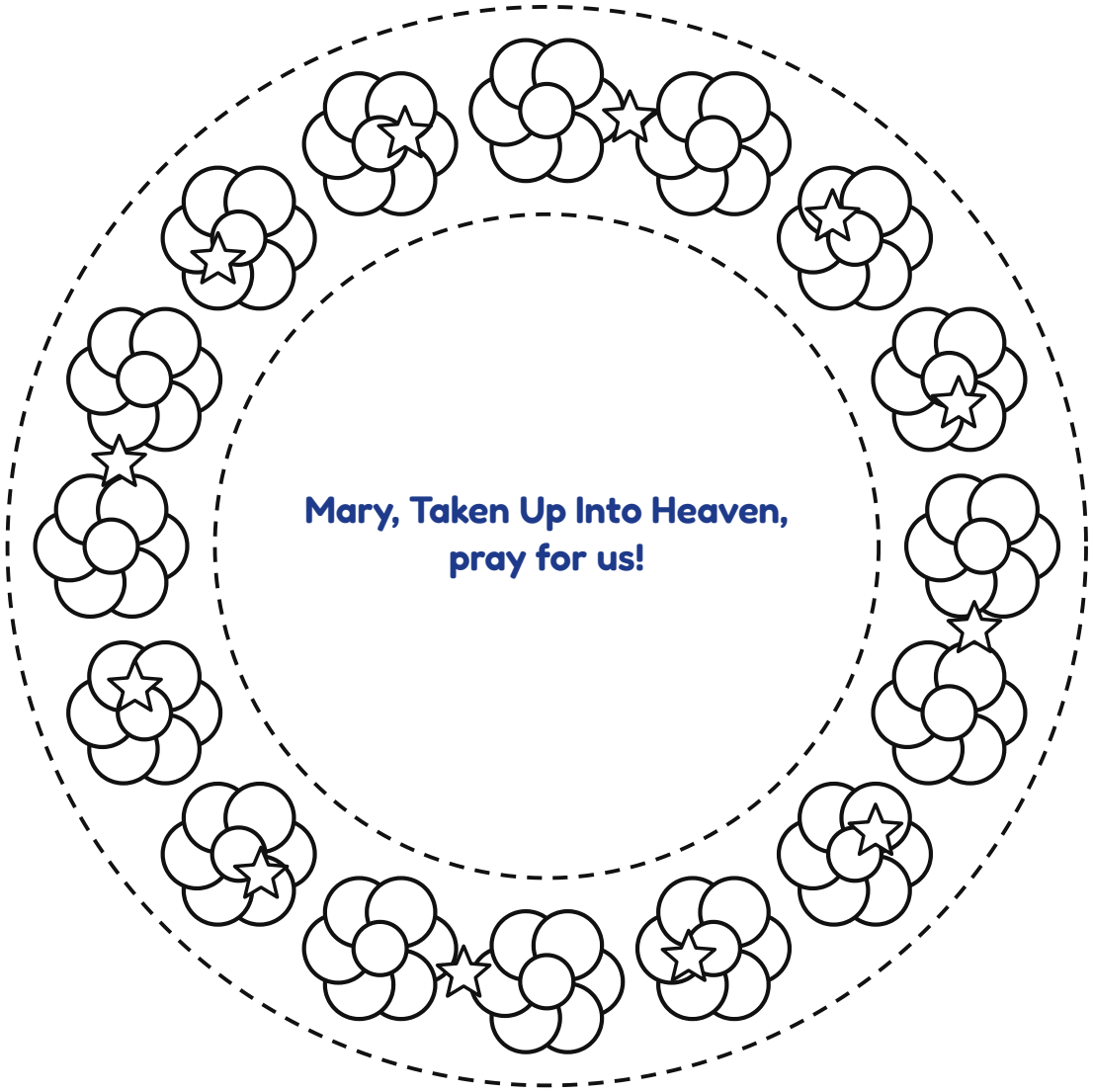
Name: _____

Assumption (August 15) Craft Ages 7-12

The Flower Crown for August 15

On August 15, we celebrate Mary, taken up into heaven. Color the flowers and the stars, then cut out the crown to offer it to Mary (in front of a statue or a picture of her).

Name: _____



1 Color the flowers in every color and the stars yellow.

2 Cut around the outside, then the circle in the middle.

3 Place your crown near a picture of Mary.

Assumption (August 15) Prayer Ages 4-12

The Hail Mary in Pictures

Here is the prayer we say most often to Mary. Read it slowly, then see what each line means.

Name: _____

Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with you;
blessed are you among women,
and blessed is the fruit of your womb, Jesus.
Holy Mary, Mother of God,
pray for us sinners
now and at the hour of our death.
Amen.

Line by Line

- "Hail Mary, full of grace": these words come from the greeting of the angel Gabriel when he visits Mary.
- "blessed are you among women": these words come from her cousin Elizabeth at the Visitation.
- "Holy Mary, Mother of God": Mary is the mother of Jesus, the Son of God.
- "pray for us": we ask Mary to speak to God for us, now and all our life.

Color the picture and learn the prayer by heart, one line each day.

Assumption (August 15) | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Assumption Words

Find the 12 Assumption words in the grid.

Name: _____

U	A	W	G	L	O	R	Y	Q	A	U	I
F	K	W	P	B	W	M	A	U	S	O	Y
E	C	W	P	H	M	H	N	E	S	I	V
A	W	A	R	E	V	I	G	E	U	M	I
S	T	U	O	A	B	M	E	N	M	R	R
T	Y	G	C	V	E	O	L	T	P	H	G
L	S	U	E	E	R	T	S	K	T	D	I
E	I	S	S	N	D	H	T	P	I	K	N
F	U	T	S	D	O	E	A	A	O	Y	W
V	A	O	I	B	E	R	R	O	N	N	P
R	S	M	O	T	D	H	S	R	A	R	K
A	Y	D	N	F	I	O	M	A	R	Y	V

- ☐ Assumption
- ☐ Mary
- ☐ heaven
- ☐ August
- ☐ queen
- ☐ glory
- ☐ mother
- ☐ stars
- ☐ angels
- ☐ procession
- ☐ feast
- ☐ Virgin

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Assumption (August 15) Game Ages 7-12

August 15: True or False

Check "True" or "False" to learn all about the feast of August 15.

Name: _____

1. The Assumption is celebrated on August 15. True False
2. Mary is taken up into heaven, body and soul. True False
3. The Assumption is the same feast as the Ascension. True False
4. In 1950, Pope Pius XII proclaimed that Mary was taken up into heaven, body and soul. True False
5. Mary goes up to heaven by her own power. True False
6. In the United States, August 15 is a holy day of obligation (except when it falls on a Saturday or a Monday). True False
7. Mary, under the title of the Immaculate Conception, is the patroness of the United States. True False
8. Many parishes celebrate this day with a Mass in Mary's honor. True False

Careful: at the Ascension, Jesus goes up to heaven by his own power. At the Assumption, Mary is taken up into heaven by God.

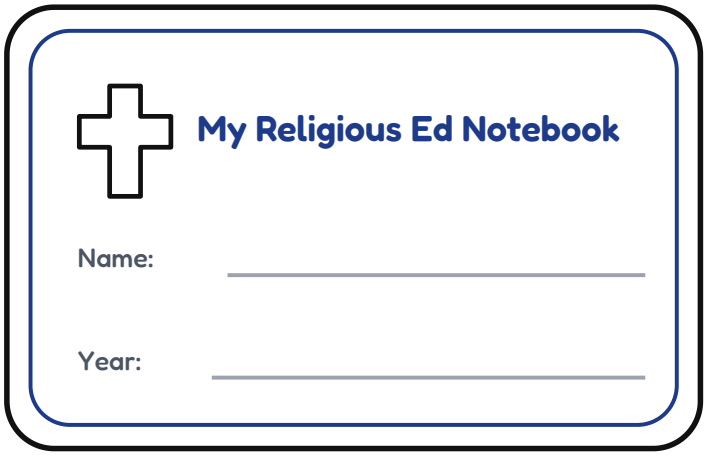
Answer Key: 1 true · 2 true · 3 false · 4 true · 5 false · 6 true · 7 true · 8 true

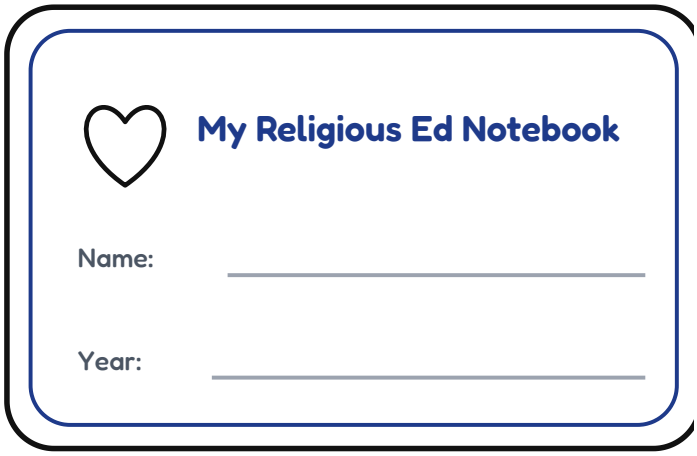
Back to Religious Ed | Craft | Ages 4-12

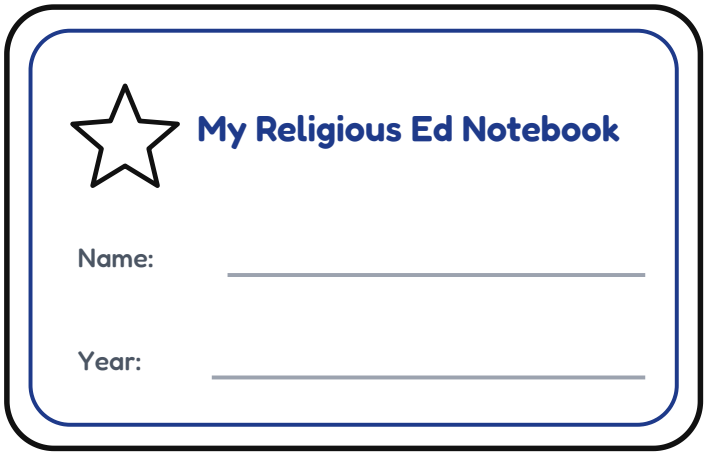
My Religious Ed Notebook Labels

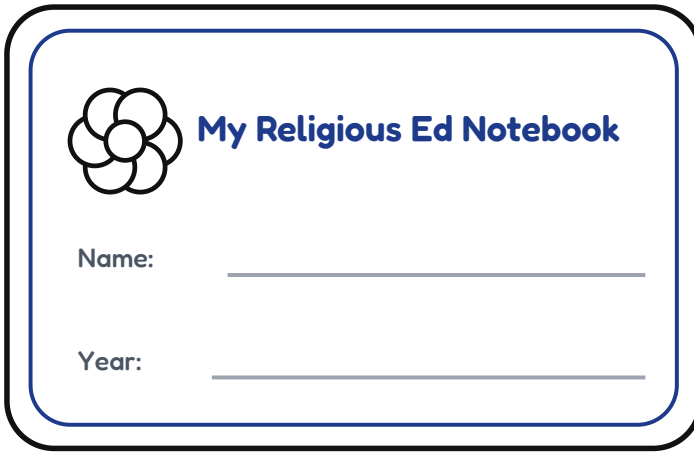
Color the labels, write your name and the year, then cut them out. Stick one on your notebook and give the others to your friends from religious ed.

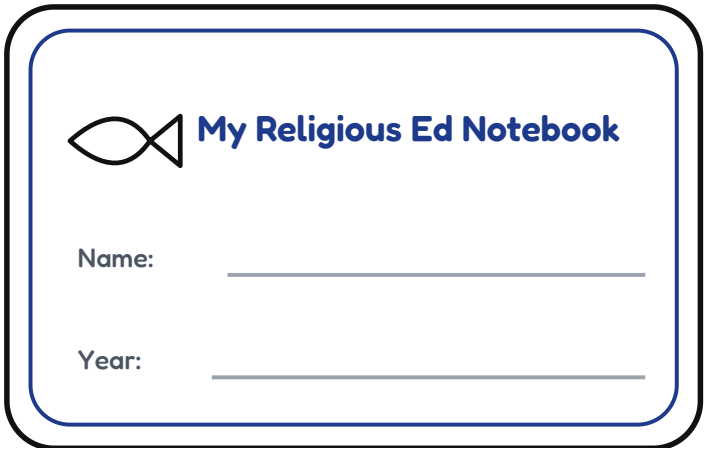
Name: _____

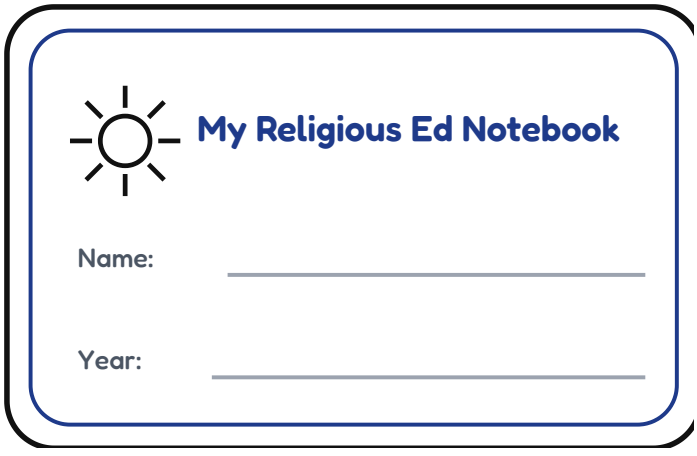












Back to Religious Ed | Game | Ages 7-12

Welcome to Religious Ed: The Name Game

Three short games for the first session, when the children don't know each other yet. Time: 15 to 20 minutes.

1. The Name Ball (Ages 4-12)

The children stand in a circle. Whoever has the ball says their name and tosses it to someone else. In the second round, say the name of the person you are tossing the ball to. In the third round, add something you like: "Lily, who loves chocolate!"

2. My Name, My Saint (Ages 7-12)

Each child says their name and, if they know it, the saint who has the same name or their patron saint. The catechist helps those who don't know and writes down the feast days, to celebrate them together during the year.

3. The Friendship Web (Ages 7-12)

With a ball of yarn: whoever holds the yarn says the name of the person they toss it to and one good quality of that person, while holding on to the end of the yarn. At the end, a big web links the whole group.

End with a short prayer: "Lord Jesus, you know each of us by name. Bless our group and teach us to love one another as brothers and sisters. Amen."

You will need: a soft ball, a ball of yarn, a sheet of paper to write down the saints' feast days.

Back to Religious Ed | Coloring | Ages 4-8

Jesus Welcomes the Children

People bring their children to Jesus. The disciples want to send them away, but Jesus welcomes them. Color Jesus and the children.

Name: _____

"Let the children come to me; do not prevent them, for the kingdom of God belongs to such as these."

Mark 10:14

Back to Religious Ed | Prayer | Ages 4-12

My Prayer for the New Religious Ed Year

To start the religious ed year well, say this prayer with your group or your family.

Name: _____

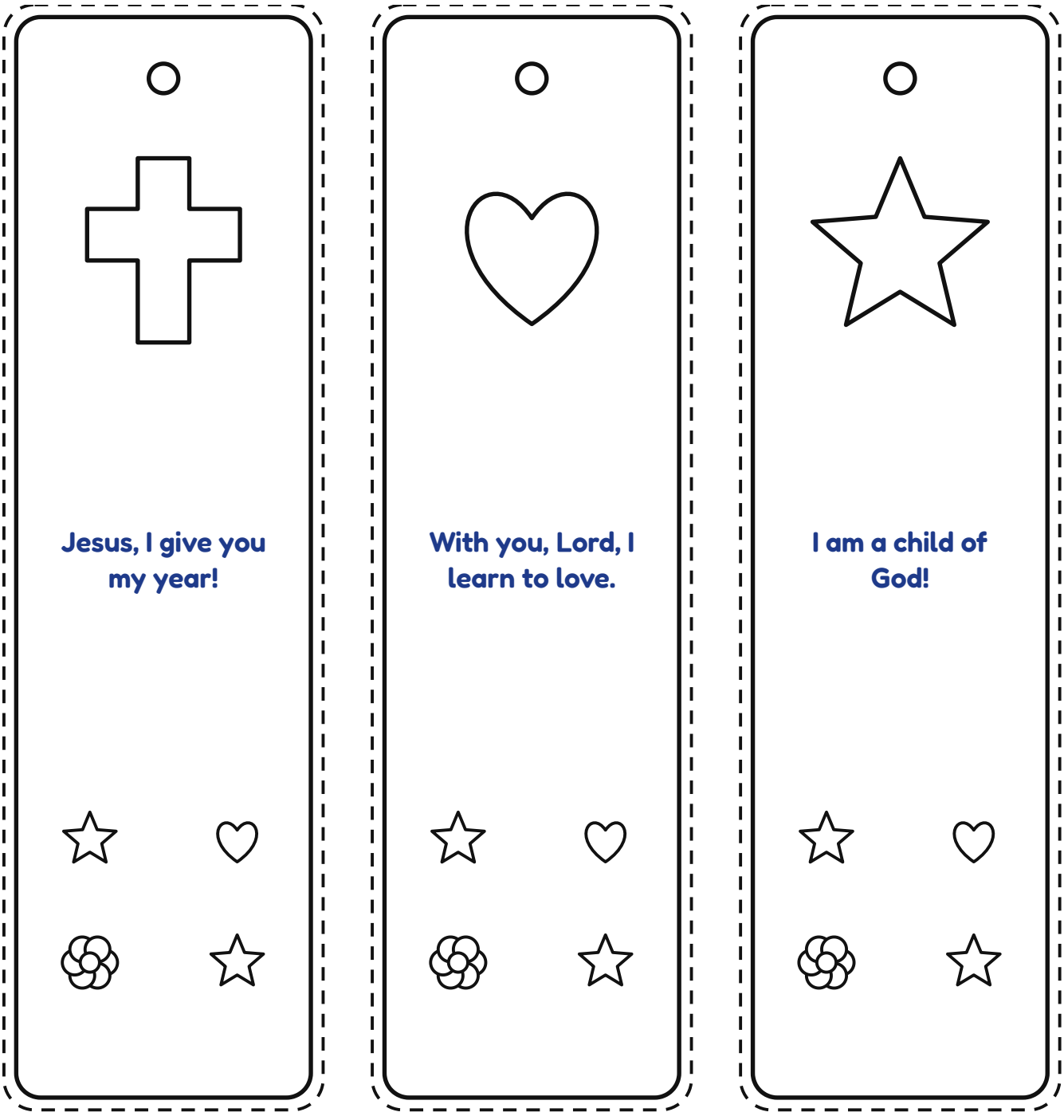
Lord Jesus,
a new year is beginning.
I place in your hands my new friends,
my catechists, and my family.
Open my ears to listen to your Word,
open my heart to learn to love,
and open my hands to share.
Walk with me all through the year.
Amen.

Back to Religious Ed | Craft | Ages 7-12

My Religious Ed Bookmarks

Color your three bookmarks, cut them out, and slip them into your Bible and your religious ed notebook. You can punch a hole at the top and add a ribbon.

Name: _____



Back to Religious Ed | Game | Ages 4-8

All About Me

Fill in your page so your catechist and your group can get to know you better.

Name: _____

My name is:

I am ___ years old and I am in ___ grade.

My patron saint:

My favorite prayer:

What I like to do:

What I would like to learn in religious ed:

Draw yourself here, with the things you love.

Back to Religious Ed | Word Search | Ages 7-9

Religious Ed Words

Find the 12 religious ed words in the grid.

Name: _____

A	S	H	D	S	U	W	V	D	T	I	M
G	O	G	G	R	A	M	V	M	F	C	J
S	N	V	U	P	R	B	H	C	R	R	E
W	G	D	F	C	B	O	S	H	I	O	S
F	V	E	I	P	I	C	H	U	E	S	U
B	R	B	P	R	A	Y	E	R	N	S	S
A	I	F	G	M	A	S	S	C	D	K	H
P	I	A	O	H	H	H	D	H	S	D	D
T	V	I	D	L	B	I	B	L	E	T	C
I	R	T	B	S	S	H	A	R	I	N	G
S	U	H	F	K	R	R	U	G	E	V	G
M	Y	K	F	P	T	H	F	F	Y	W	M

- ☐ Bible
- ☐ prayer
- ☐ Jesus
- ☐ Church
- ☐ friends
- ☐ Baptism
- ☐ Mass
- ☐ cross
- ☐ sharing
- ☐ song
- ☐ God
- ☐ faith

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Back to Religious Ed | Craft | Ages 7-12

Our Class Promise

Read each sentence together, check the ones you choose, and add your own ideas. Then everyone signs the promise.

Name: _____

In Our Religious Ed Class...

- ☐ We listen to the person who is speaking.
- ☐ We respect each other, even when we don't agree.
- ☐ We pray together at the beginning and at the end.
- ☐ We take care of the supplies and the room.
- ☐ We welcome new friends with a smile.
- ☐ We forgive when someone has hurt us.
- ☐ We share our ideas and our questions.
- ☐ We arrive on time.

Our Own Ideas

_____

_____

Our Signatures

All Saints' Day | Coloring | Ages 4-8

All the Saints in Heaven

On All Saints' Day, we celebrate all the saints: the ones we know and all the others who are with God. Color the great family of heaven!

Name: _____

All Saints' Day | Cut-Out | Ages 7-12

Saint Cards to Cut Out

Cut out the nine saint cards. Draw each saint in the small frame and keep the cards in a box: you can pick one each day and pray with that saint.

Name: _____

St. Thérèse of Lisieux Feast day: October 1 She found her "little way": doing small things with great love.	**St. Francis of Assisi** Feast day: October 4 He loved the poor and praised God for all of creation.	**St. Kateri Tekakwitha** Feast day: July 14 The "Lily of the Mohawks," the first Native American saint.
St. Bernadette Lourdes, France The Virgin Mary appeared to her at Lourdes in 1858.	**St. Martin of Tours** Feast day: November 11 He shared his cloak with a poor man who was cold.	**St. Vincent de Paul** Feast day: September 27 He devoted his life to the poor and to abandoned children.
St. John Vianney Feast day: August 4 The holy Curé of Ars spent hours praying and hearing confessions.	**St. Nicholas** Feast day: December 6 A very generous bishop who protected children.	**St. Elizabeth Ann Seton** Feast day: January 4 The first saint born in the United States; she started Catholic schools.

All Saints' Day · Bingo · Ages 7-12

Saints Bingo

Each player takes a card. The leader calls out the name of a saint and reads one sentence about their life: if you have that saint, cover it with a marker. The first one to fill a card shouts "All Saints!"

Name: _____

Card 1		
Vincent de Paul	Martin	Paul
Francis	Elizabeth Ann Seton	Nicholas
Kateri	Joseph	Thérèse

Card 2		
Bernadette	Peter	Nicholas
John the Baptist	Francis	Paul
Kateri	Thérèse	Martin

Card 3		
Peter	Elizabeth Ann Seton	Thérèse
Martin	Bernadette	Paul
Vincent de Paul	Joseph	Nicholas

Card 4		
Nicholas	Bernadette	Elizabeth Ann Seton
Martin	Kateri	Paul
Francis	Joseph	Peter

Words to call: Thérèse · Francis · Kateri · Bernadette · Martin · Nicholas · Elizabeth Ann Seton · Joseph · Peter · Paul · Vincent de Paul · John the Baptist

All Saints' Day | Riddles | Ages 7-12

Guess Which Saint I Am

Read each riddle and write the name of the saint.

Name: _____

1. I was a Roman soldier. I cut my cloak in two for a poor man who was cold. Who am I?

   _____

2. I was a Carmelite nun in Lisieux, France. I wanted to do small things with great love. Who am I?

   _____

3. I was a young Mohawk woman. People call me the "Lily of the Mohawks." Who am I?

   _____

4. I left everything to live in poverty. I called the sun "Brother Sun" and the moon "Sister Moon." Who am I?

   _____

5. I was the bishop of Myra. My feast is December 6, and I love children. Who am I?

   _____

6. The beautiful Lady appeared to me in the grotto of Massabielle, at Lourdes. Who am I?

   _____

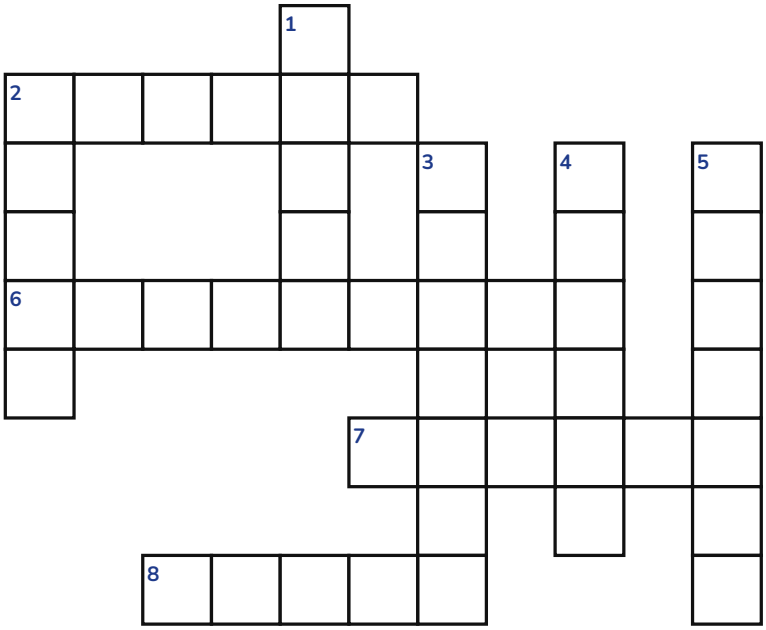
Answer Key: 1 St. Martin · 2 St. Thérèse of Lisieux · 3 St. Kateri Tekakwitha · 4 St. Francis of Assisi · 5 St. Nicholas · 6 St. Bernadette

All Saints' Day | Crossword | Ages 10-12

Saints of America

Many saints lived in the Americas! Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

2. St. ... of Molokai, who cared for people with leprosy in Hawaii (May 10).

6. Our Lady of ..., Patroness of the Americas (December 12).

7. St. ... Tekakwitha, the "Lily of the Mohawks" (July 14).

8. St. Elizabeth Ann ..., the first saint born in the United States (January 4).

Down ↓

1. St. Junípero ..., Franciscan missionary (July 1).

2. St. Juan ..., to whom Our Lady of Guadalupe appeared (December 9).

3. St. John ..., bishop of Philadelphia (January 5).

4. St. Katharine ..., who opened schools for Black and Native American children (March 3).

5. Mother ..., patron saint of immigrants (November 13).

Answer Key: 2A DAMIEN · 6A GUADALUPE · 7A KATERI · 8A SETON · 1D SERRA · 2D DIEGO · 3D NEUMANN · 4D DREXEL · 5D CABRINI

All Saints' Day | Craft | Ages 4-12

My Patron Saint and Me

Your patron saint often has the same name as you and prays for you. Do some detective work with a grown-up, then fill in your page!

Name: _____

My name:

My patron saint:

Their feast day:

What I know about their life:

How I can be like them:

Draw your patron saint, with you beside them.

All Saints' Day | Prayer | Ages 7-12

All Souls' Day: Praying for Our Loved Ones Who Have Died

On November 2, All Souls' Day, the day after All Saints' Day, the Church prays for all who have died. We can visit the cemetery, bring flowers, and pray.

Name: _____

We believe that death is not the end: Jesus is risen, and he promises us life with God. We pray for those who have died, so that God may welcome them into his light.

Lord Jesus,
I place in your hands the people I love who have died.
Welcome them close to you, in your peace and your light.
Comfort those who are sad.
And keep us all together in your love,
until the day we are all with you.
Amen.

The People I Pray For

_____

_____

_____

You can light a candle at church or at home while you think of them.

All Saints' Day | Word Search | Ages 7-9

All Saints' Day Words

Find the 12 All Saints' Day words in the grid.

Name: _____

E	M	S	A	I	N	T	S	M	O	M	M
W	D	E	P	A	R	T	E	D	M	N	A
L	W	O	O	H	E	A	V	E	N	E	I
F	V	P	N	D	N	N	A	H	A	L	O
U	E	N	K	N	O	V	E	M	B	E	R
R	K	S	O	H	P	Y	D	P	A	G	B
K	B	E	A	T	I	T	U	D	E	S	G
J	O	Y	B	E	C	M	G	L	O	R	Y
C	T	P	H	O	L	I	N	E	S	S	K
S	F	F	I	M	A	R	T	Y	R	S	P
L	I	G	H	T	S	P	R	A	Y	E	R
A	A	I	A	E	W	U	W	V	D	O	P

- ☐ saints
- ☐ heaven
- ☐ holiness
- ☐ halo
- ☐ Beatitudes
- ☐ martyrs
- ☐ prayer
- ☐ departed
- ☐ November
- ☐ light
- ☐ joy
- ☐ glory

Words run left to right or top to bottom.

Marian Feasts | Coloring | Ages 4-8

The Immaculate Conception (December 8)

On December 8, we celebrate the Immaculate Conception: from the first moment of her life, Mary was kept free from original sin. It is the patronal feast of the United States and a holy day of obligation! Color Mary.

Name: _____

Marian Feasts | Coloring | Ages 4-8

The Annunciation (March 25)

On March 25, nine months before Christmas, we celebrate the Annunciation: Mary says yes to God. (In 2027, the feast moves to April 5, because March 25 is Holy Thursday.) Color the scene.

Name: _____

"Behold, I am the handmaid of the Lord. May it be done to me according to your word."

Luke 1:38

Marian Feasts | Coloring | Ages 7-12

Our Lady of Lourdes and St. Bernadette (February 11)

On February 11, we celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes. In 1858, the Virgin Mary appeared eighteen times to Bernadette in the grotto of Massabielle. Color the grotto.

Name: _____

Marian Feasts | Craft | Ages 4-12

A Prayer Corner for Mary in May

May is the month of Mary, when many parishes and schools hold a May crowning. Make a little prayer corner in your room: color the picture, glue it onto cardstock, and place a flower and a candle next to it.

Name: _____

You will need: scissors, glue, cardstock, and some flowers or a battery-operated tea light.

1 Color the picture of Mary.

2 Glue it onto cardstock and cut it out.

3 Fold a strip of cardstock behind it so it stands up, and pray there every evening in May.

Marian Feasts | Coloring | Ages 7-9

The Visitation: Mary Visits Elizabeth (May 31)

On May 31, we celebrate the Visitation: Mary hurries to help her cousin Elizabeth, who is also expecting a baby. Color their meeting.

Name: _____

"Most blessed are you among women, and blessed is the fruit of your womb."

Luke 1:42

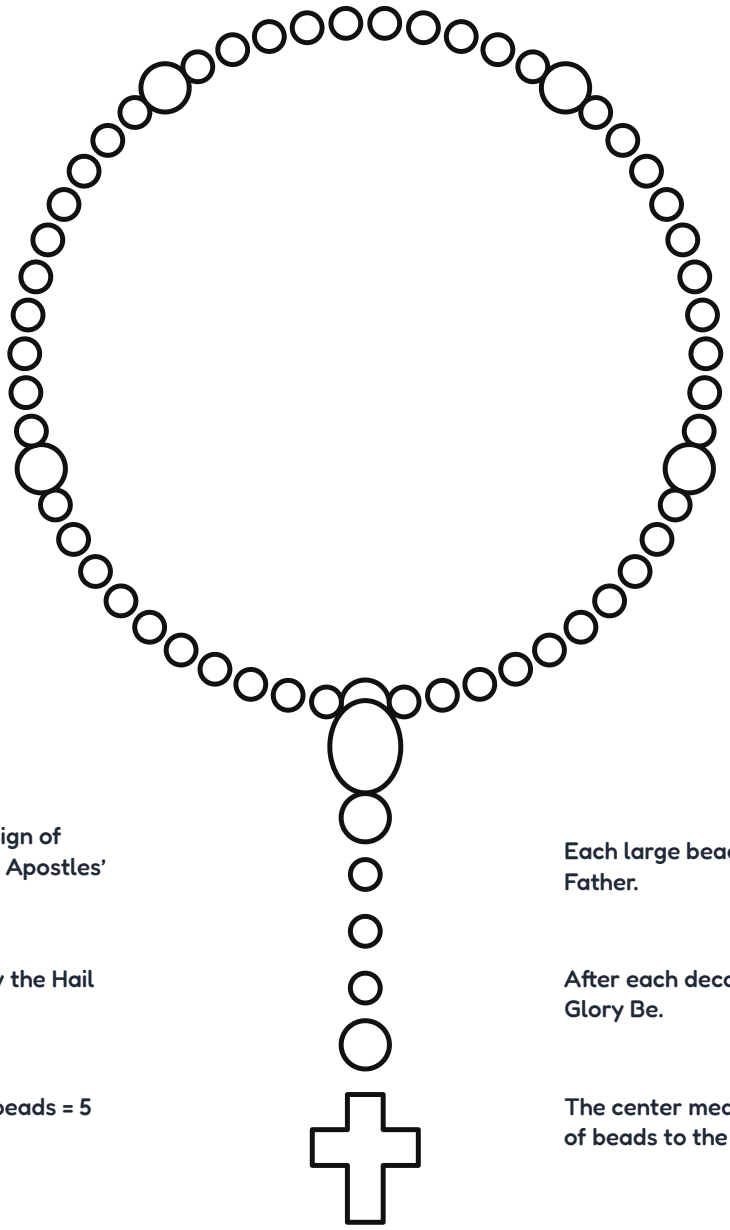
Marian Feasts | Craft | Ages 7-12

My Rosary to Make (October, Month of the Rosary)

October is the month of the rosary. Make your own rosary with beads, following this diagram, or color it and learn how to pray it.

Name: _____

You will need: 59 beads (53 small and 6 large), a cross, a medal, and a strong string.



The cross: I make the Sign of the Cross and pray the Apostles' Creed.

Each small bead: I pray the Hail Mary.

5 decades of 10 small beads = 5 mysteries.

Each large bead: I pray the Our Father.

After each decade: I pray the Glory Be.

The center medal joins the loop of beads to the tail.

Marian Feasts | Prayer | Ages 7-12

The Joyful Mysteries of the Rosary

The rosary helps us think about the life of Jesus with Mary. The Joyful Mysteries are prayed on Mondays and Saturdays.

Name: _____

1. The Annunciation
The angel Gabriel tells Mary she will be the mother of Jesus.
I ask for the grace of saying yes to God.

2. The Visitation
Mary goes to help her cousin Elizabeth.
I ask for the grace of loving and serving others.

3. The Nativity
Jesus is born in the stable in Bethlehem.
I ask for the grace of being humble and poor in spirit.

4. The Presentation in the Temple
Mary and Joseph offer Jesus to God.
I ask for the grace of obeying God.

5. The Finding of Jesus in the Temple
After three days, Mary and Joseph find Jesus among the teachers.
I ask for the grace of always looking for Jesus.

How to Pray a Decade

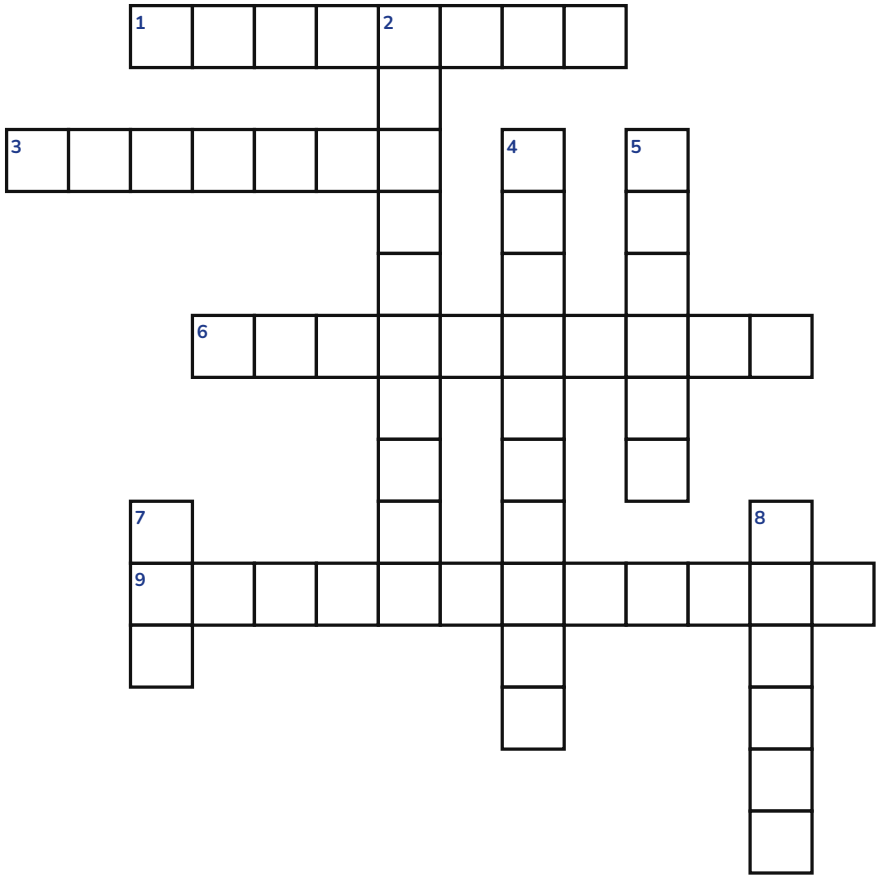
I announce the mystery, then I pray one Our Father, ten Hail Marys, and one Glory Be.

Marian Feasts · Crossword · Ages 10-12

Mary's Feasts Throughout the Year

All through the year, the Church celebrates the Virgin Mary. Fill in the grid.

Name: _____



Across →

1. The ... of the Blessed Virgin Mary, celebrated on September 8.

3. Our Lady of ..., celebrated on February 11.

6. The ... Conception, celebrated on December 8.

9. Feast of March 25: the angel visits Mary.

Down ↓

2. Feast of May 31: Mary visits Elizabeth.

4. Feast of August 15.

5. Our Lady of the ..., celebrated on October 7.

7. The month of Mary.

8. January 1: Mary, the Holy ... of God.

Answer Key: 1A NATIVITY · 3A LOURDES · 6A IMMACULATE · 9A ANNUNCIATION · 2D VISITATION · 4D ASSUMPTION · 5D ROSARY · 7D MAY · 8D MOTHER

Marian Feasts · Game · Ages 7-9

Put Mary's Feasts in Order: A Timeline to Build

Put Mary's feasts in order through the year, from January to December: write a number from 1 to 9 in each box. Then cut out the cards and glue them on a long strip to make your timeline.

Name: _____

- ☐ **A.** August 15 · The Assumption
- ☐ **B.** December 8 · The Immaculate Conception
- ☐ **C.** March 25 · The Annunciation
- ☐ **D.** September 8 · The Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary
- ☐ **E.** February 11 · Our Lady of Lourdes
- ☐ **F.** December 12 · Our Lady of Guadalupe
- ☐ **G.** May 31 · The Visitation
- ☐ **H.** January 1 · Mary, the Holy Mother of God
- ☐ **I.** October 7 · Our Lady of the Rosary

Answer Key: order H – E – C – G – A – D – I – B – F

Group Activities · Team Game · Ages 7-12

The Great Liturgical Year Quiz

Form two or three teams. Read each question out loud: the first team to raise a hand answers. Right answer: 1 point!

1 Which season begins the liturgical year?

☐Christmas ☐Advent ☐Lent

2 How many Sundays are there in Advent?

☐three ☐four ☐six

3 What color does the priest wear during Lent?

☐violet ☐green ☐red

4 On what day does Lent begin?

☐Palm Sunday ☐Ash Wednesday ☐Holy Thursday

5 How many days after Easter do we celebrate Pentecost?

☐forty ☐fifty ☐one hundred

6 Which feast do we celebrate on November 1?

☐All Saints' Day ☐the Assumption ☐the Epiphany

7 What do we celebrate at the Ascension?

☐the birth of Jesus ☐Jesus going up to heaven ☐the coming of the Holy Spirit

8 What is the color of Ordinary Time?

☐white ☐green ☐rose

9 Who comes to worship Jesus at the Epiphany?

☐the shepherds ☐the Wise Men ☐the apostles

10 Which feast of Mary falls on August 15?

☐the Assumption ☐the Annunciation ☐the Visitation

Answer Key: 1 Advent · 2 four · 3 violet · 4 Ash Wednesday · 5 fifty · 6 All Saints' Day · 7 Jesus going up to heaven · 8 green · 9 the Wise Men · 10 the Assumption

Group Activities | Team Game | Ages 4-8

The Liturgical Colors Game (Cards to Hold Up)

Each child colors and cuts out the six cards. The leader calls out a feast or a season ("Christmas!", "Good Friday!"): everyone holds up the right color as fast as they can.

GREEN Ordinary Time The color of hope and of life that grows.	**VIOLET** Advent and Lent The color of waiting and getting ready.	**WHITE** Christmas, Easter, feasts of Christ, of Mary, and of the saints The color of joy and light.
RED Palm Sunday, Good Friday, Pentecost, martyrs The color of the fire of the Spirit and the blood of the martyrs.	**ROSE** Third Sunday of Advent and Fourth Sunday of Lent The color of joy in the middle of waiting.	**GOLD** Great feasts (can replace white) The color of the biggest feast days.

Examples to call out: Christmas, Ash Wednesday, Pentecost, All Saints' Day, Third Sunday of Advent, a Sunday in September, Palm Sunday, the Assumption, Easter, the feast of Saints Peter and Paul.

Group Activities | Team Game | Ages 7-12

The Feast Day Relay Race

A relay race to learn the order of the liturgical year. For 8 to 20 children, in a room or outside. Time: 20 minutes.

Getting Ready

Write each season or feast on a sheet of paper (two sets, one for each team): Advent, Christmas, Epiphany, Presentation of the Lord, Lent, Palm Sunday, Holy Week, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost, Corpus Christi, Assumption, All Saints. Mix up each set at the far end of the room.

How to Play

1. The teams line up at the start.
2. At the signal, the first player of each line runs to get a sheet and comes back to put it on the floor, on the team's line.
3. The next player goes: they can bring back a new sheet or move a sheet already on the floor to fix the order.
4. When all the sheets are in the order of the year, the whole team sits down and shouts "Alleluia!"

To Finish

Check the order together and ask about each feast: "What do we celebrate that day? What color does the priest wear?"

For younger kids (ages 4-6): use only Advent, Christmas, Lent, Easter, and Pentecost, with a drawing on each sheet.

Group Activities · Team Game · Ages 7-12

Draw and Guess: 40 Bible Cards

Cut out the 40 cards. A team draws a card: one player draws on the board, without talking or writing, while the team has one minute to guess.

1 · Noah's ark	**2** · a rainbow	**3** · a star	**4** · the Nativity scene	**5** · a donkey
6 · a sheep	**7** · a crown	**8** · a palm branch	**9** · a cross	**10** · a fish
11 · a dove	**12** · a candle	**13** · an angel	**14** · a shepherd	**15** · a well
16 · a boat	**17** · a fishing net	**18** · loaves of bread	**19** · a lamp	**20** · a church
21 · a bell	**22** · a chalice	**23** · a rosary	**24** · a Bible	**25** · a snake
26 · an apple	**27** · the tomb	**28** · a stone	**29** · a rooster	**30** · a mountain
31 · the sea parting	**32** · a big fish	**33** · a tower	**34** · a king	**35** · a harp
36 · a sling	**37** · a giant	**38** · a fig tree	**39** · a treasure	**40** · a house on rock

Group Activities | Team Game | Ages 7-12

Bible Charades: 30 Cards

Cut out the 30 cards. A child draws a card and acts out the scene without talking. The first one to guess wins the card... and acts out the next one!

1 Noah builds the ark	**2** David and his sling	**3** Jonah and the big fish	**4** Moses parts the sea	**5** Zacchaeus climbs the tree
6 The Good Samaritan helps the injured man	**7** Peter walks on the water	**8** The Wise Men follow the star	**9** The shepherds sleep near their sheep	**10** Jesus calms the storm
11 The miraculous catch of fish	**12** Jesus washes his disciples' feet	**13** The Prodigal Son comes home	**14** The shepherd looks for his sheep	**15** St. Martin shares his cloak
16 Mary rocks Baby Jesus	**17** Joseph works with wood	**18** Jesus rides in on a donkey	**19** Thomas touches Jesus' hands	**20** Tongues of fire at Pentecost
21 Bartimaeus can see again	**22** Jesus feeds the five thousand	**23** The woman looks for her coin	**24** The disciples walk to Emmaus	**25** John baptizes Jesus
26 Adam and Eve pick the fruit	**27** Abraham counts the stars	**28** Daniel in the lions' den	**29** The sower sows his seed	**30** A child says bedtime prayers

Group Activities · Team Game · Ages 10-12

Treasure Hunt in the Church

Explore your parish church in teams of 3 or 4, with a grown-up. Before you start, remind everyone that the church is a place of prayer: we walk and speak quietly.

Find These in the Church (Check Them Off)

- ☐ the altar
- ☐ the ambo (where the Word is read)
- ☐ the Paschal candle
- ☐ the Stations of the Cross (14 stations)
- ☐ the confessional
- ☐ a cross or a crucifix
- ☐ the tabernacle and the sanctuary lamp
- ☐ the baptismal font
- ☐ a statue of the Virgin Mary
- ☐ a stained-glass window or painting of a saint
- ☐ the holy water font
- ☐ the bell (or the bell tower)

Mystery Questions

1. What is the name of the patron saint of your church?
2. How many Stations of the Cross are there?
3. What color is the altar cloth? And the priest's vestments this Sunday?
4. Where does the priest or the deacon read the Gospel?
5. What do we do with the holy water when we come in?

The Treasure

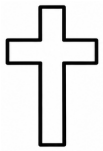
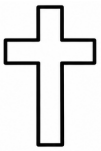
At the end, gather in front of the tabernacle: the real treasure of the church is Jesus, present in the Eucharist. End with a moment of silence and an Our Father.

Expected answers: 14 stations · the Gospel is read at the ambo · with holy water, we make the Sign of the Cross to remember our Baptism.

Group Activities | Team Game | Ages 4-8

The Feast Day Memory Game (Pairs to Cut Out)

Glue the page onto cardstock, then color and cut out the 16 cards. Place them face down: take turns turning over two cards. A pair? Keep it and say which feast the symbol reminds you of!

the dove	the candle	 the cross	the chalice
the rosary	the fish	the lamb	the Bible
the Bible	the lamb	the fish	the rosary
the chalice	 the cross	the candle	the dove

Group Activities · Bingo · Ages 4-12

The Great Liturgical Year Bingo (Six Cards)

Six cards to play in a big group. The leader reads a word and asks a question ("What color is this season?"); those who have the word cover it with a marker.

Card 1		
star	palm	candle
Christmas	Palm Sunday	Easter
Nativity scene	All Saints	Epiphany

Card 2		
dove	candle	Ascension
Easter	Advent	cross
palm	Palm Sunday	crown

Card 3		
Advent	Alleluia	All Saints
Lent	Pentecost	star
Ascension	Christmas	dove

Card 4		
Alleluia	All Saints	Epiphany
Advent	Nativity scene	dove
Easter	Palm Sunday	star

Card 5		
Lent	Christmas	Nativity scene
star	palm	Assumption
Palm Sunday	All Saints	Epiphany

Card 6		
Alleluia	crown	Palm Sunday
Epiphany	candle	star
Easter	dove	Nativity scene

Words to call: Advent · Christmas · Epiphany · Lent · Palm Sunday · Easter · Ascension · Pentecost · All Saints · Assumption · Nativity scene · candle · palm · dove · cross · crown · star · Alleluia

Group Activities | Team Game | Ages 7-12

The Liturgical Year Board Game (Giant Board)

If you can, enlarge the board to 11 × 17 in. Each player rolls one die to move. Before you follow a feast-day square's instruction, say what we celebrate that day.

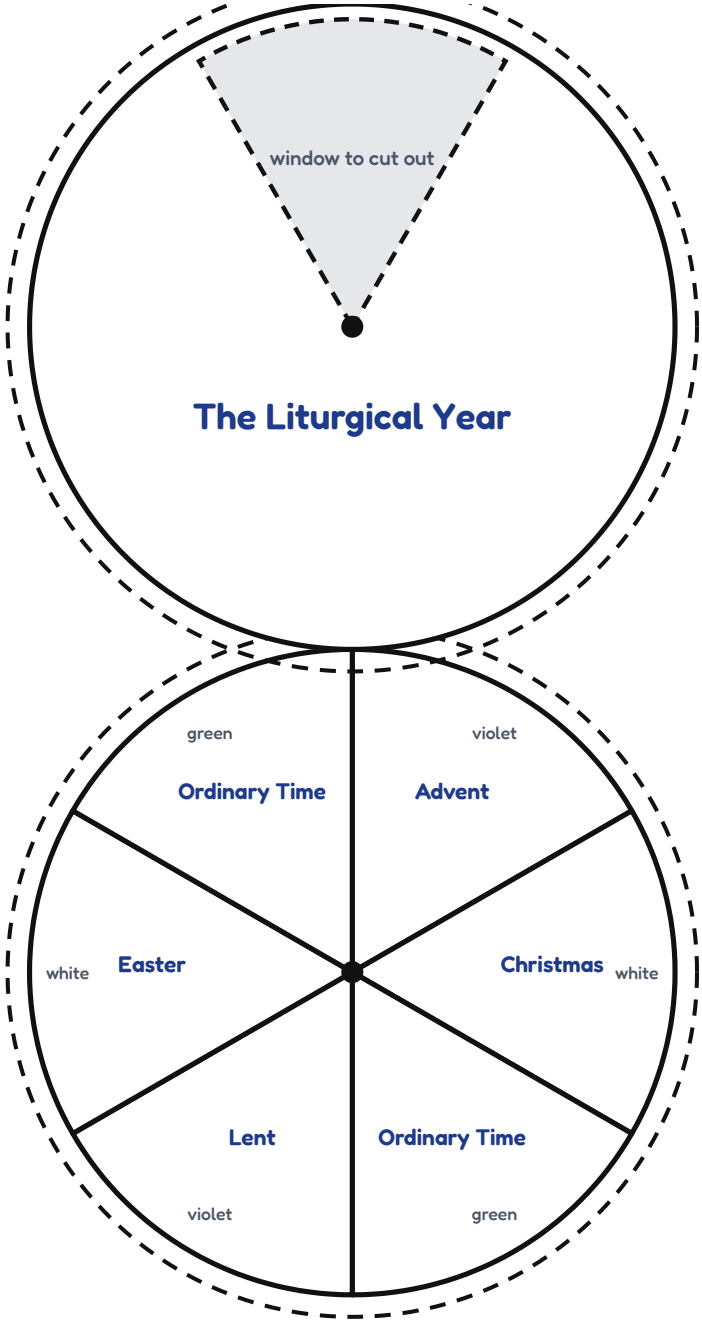
1 Start: Advent	**2**	**3** First Sunday of Advent: light a candle, move ahead 2	**4**	**5** Christmas: roll again!	**6**
12	**11** You forget Ash Wednesday: go back 2	**10**	**9** Presentation of the Lord: roll again	**8**	**7** You follow the Wise Men's star: move ahead 3
13 The Lenten desert: lose a turn	**14**	**15** Palm Sunday: move ahead 2	**16**	**17** You fall asleep in Gethsemane: go back 3	**18**
24 Pentecost: the wind pushes you, move ahead 2	**23**	**22** Ascension: move ahead 3	**21**	**20**	**19** Easter! Alleluia: roll again
25	**26**	**27** Corpus Christi: roll again	**28**	**29** You skip Sunday Mass: go back 2	**30**
36 Christ the King: the end of the year!	**35** All Saints: move ahead 1	**34**	**33** Back to religious ed: roll again	**32**	**31** Assumption: move ahead 2

Blue squares: good news. Yellow squares: watch out! The liturgical year ends with the feast of Christ the King, on the last Sunday before Advent.

Group Activities | Craft | Ages 4-12

The Liturgical Year Wheel to Make Together

Each child colors each section of the wheel with the color of the liturgical season, then you join the two circles with a brass fastener. Turn the wheel each week to see where we are in the year.



1 Color each section with the color shown.

2 Cut out the two circles and the window.

3 Join them in the center with a brass fastener.

Group Activities | Skit | Ages 7-12

A Christmas Skit: "No Room for Them"

A Christmas skit (6 minutes). Characters: the narrator, Mary, Joseph, three innkeepers, the angel, two shepherds. Props: three cardboard doors and a stable.

Narrator — The emperor orders everyone to be enrolled in the town of their ancestors. Joseph and Mary set out for Bethlehem. Mary is expecting a baby.

Joseph — Hang in there, Mary, we're almost there! I'll knock on this door.

He knocks. The first innkeeper opens the door.

Innkeeper 1 — We're full! The town is crowded with people because of the census. Try down the road.

Innkeeper 2 — Not a single room, I'm sorry. Even the attic is full!

Mary — Joseph, I'm so tired... The baby will be born soon.

Innkeeper 3 — I have no more rooms... but there is a stable behind the house. You can stay there, with the donkey and the ox.

Joseph — Thank you, my friend! God bless you.

Mary and Joseph settle in the stable. Mary lays a baby doll in the manger.

Narrator — That night, Jesus is born. In the fields, shepherds are keeping watch over their flocks.

Angel — "Do not be afraid; for behold, I proclaim to you good news of great joy... For today in the city of David a savior has been born for you... you will find an infant wrapped in swaddling clothes and lying in a manger."

Shepherd 1 — Let's go to Bethlehem and see what has happened!

Shepherd 2 — Look, it's true! The Savior of the world is a tiny baby.

Everyone — Glory to God! Merry Christmas!

After the skit: "The innkeeper made room for Jesus. And what about us? How can we make room for him in our hearts?"

Group Activities | Skit | Ages 7-12

An Easter Skit: "Easter Morning"

An Easter skit (5 minutes). Characters: the narrator, Mary Magdalene, two women, the angel, Peter, John, Jesus. Props: a cardboard tomb and a big stone rolled to the side.

Narrator — It is the first day of the week, very early in the morning. The women go to the tomb with spices.

Woman 1 — "Who will roll back the stone for us from the entrance to the tomb?"

Woman 2 — Look... the stone has already been rolled away!

Angel — "Why do you seek the living one among the dead? He is not here, but he has been raised."

Mary Magdalene — Quick! Let's go tell the apostles!

The women run to Peter and John.

Mary Magdalene — Peter, John! The tomb is empty!

John — Let's run there!

(They run to the tomb.)

John — I got here first... the burial cloths are lying here.

Peter — It's true! Jesus said he would rise on the third day.

Mary Magdalene stays alone near the tomb, crying. Jesus comes close to her.

Jesus — Mary!

Mary Magdalene — Rabbouni! Teacher! It's you!

Jesus — "...go to my brothers and tell them, 'I am going to my Father and your Father, to my God and your God.'"

Everyone — Christ is risen! Alleluia!

After the skit: ask the children whom they will tell about the joy of Easter this week.

Group Activities | Skit | Ages 7-12

A Pentecost Skit: "The Wind and the Fire"

A Pentecost skit (5 minutes). Characters: the narrator, Mary, Peter, three apostles, visitors from faraway lands. Props: paper flames, a fan or paper fans.

Narrator — Fifty days after Easter, the apostles are gathered with Mary in the house. They are praying and waiting for the Spirit, whom Jesus promised.

Apostle 1 — I'm a little afraid to go outside. What will people say?

Mary — Let's trust him. Jesus promised us the Holy Spirit. Let us pray together.

Make the sound of wind with fans or by blowing. A paper flame is placed above each apostle's head.

Apostle 2 — What a strong wind! And look: flames over our heads!

Apostle 3 — I'm not afraid anymore! I want to tell everyone about Jesus!

Narrator — The apostles go outside. In the street there are people from many countries.

Visitor 1 — These men are from Galilee... but I hear them speaking my language!

Visitor 2 — Me too! They are speaking about the mighty acts of God!

Peter — Listen, everyone! God raised this Jesus; of this we are all witnesses. Come and be baptized, and the Holy Spirit will fill you too!

Narrator — That day, about three thousand people are baptized. The Church is born!

Everyone — Come, Holy Spirit!

After the skit: "What language can we use to tell people about God's love? The language of a smile, of sharing, of forgiveness..."

Group Activities | Skit | Ages 10-12

A Skit: St. Francis and the Wolf of Gubbio

A short skit based on a beautiful story from the life of Saint Francis of Assisi (6 minutes). Characters: the narrator, Francis, the mayor of Gubbio, three townspeople, the wolf.

Narrator — A long time ago, in Italy, a wolf is terrifying the town of Gubbio. No one dares to go outside anymore.

Townsperson 1 — He attacked our sheep again last night!

Mayor — Close the gates! No one goes out without a weapon!

Francis — My friends, let me go and speak to him, in the name of the Lord.

Townsperson 2 — You're crazy, Francis! He'll eat you up!

Francis goes out. The wolf comes growling, then stops in front of him.

Francis — Brother Wolf, come here. In the name of Christ, do no more harm to anyone.

The wolf lies down at Francis' feet and lowers its head.

Francis — You were hungry, weren't you? If the people feed you, do you promise to live in peace with them?

The wolf puts its paw in Francis' hand.

Townsperson 3 — Unbelievable! The wolf is as gentle as a lamb!

Mayor — We will give you food every day, Brother Wolf.

Narrator — The wolf lives in peace in the town. When it dies, all the townspeople are sad.

After the skit: "What frightens us, like the wolf of Gubbio? How can we make peace, like Francis?"